

The Speculative Logic

in Its Main Outlines

by

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These main outlines are to be regarded as a fragment of a philosophical methodology, the first part of which was to contain the Logic with a prefatory Introduction. The necessity of having a printed guide for the oral lectures has hastened the publication. The remaining fascicles will follow as the course of lectures announced in the Lecture Catalogue advances.

Copenhagen, 10 November 1841.

R. Nielsen.

[1]

Chapter One.

Being.

A. Quality.

a) Pure Being.

§ 11.

Being, Nothing, Becoming.

Being is the most comprehensive and precisely for that reason the most contentless of all positive determinations; as such it has nothing for its limit. In virtue of this delimitation, being and nothing must exclude each other, but precisely for that reason also determine each other, i.e. be posited as each other's predicates. This double contradiction, with which each of the terms is burdened, is sublated in becoming, which contains the infinite alternation of both. The copula "is", which, hidden or overt, expresses the connection between every subject and its predicates, indicates, when we consider it more closely, that all determinately existent things, all concrete determinations, the essential as well as the unessential, have their common medium in being. Being, then, taken immediately, relates to everything as space relates to [2] sensible objects. If we think all objects away, then there remains only the empty place, pure space; so too, when we abstract from all the special determinations of determinate existence, we get pure being back. Insofar, then, as things coincide with being, they thereby coincide with one another; insofar as they, on the other hand, differ from one another, they fall outside pure being. Pure being, therefore, one must not think of as an image of fantasy; to seek it one need not stare into the blue air or down into the abyss of thoughts; it is not to be regarded as a conjured-up shape that only appears at a mystical midnight, but as a wholly simple moment of

determinate existence (momentum simplicissimum), which is everywhere equally near to us. Pure being runs through tree and stone as well as through consciousness and its thoughts; but the main thing is that the eye not be dazzled by the countless distinction-determinations of heterogeneous objects.

What we must hold fast here, then, is only this, that, however different things may otherwise be, it nevertheless holds of them all that they **are**.

Since there are now no distinction-determinations in pure being, and since the diversities, if as such they fall outside being, must be posited as non-being: all distinction must vanish. This vanishing has its positive and its negative form. From the positive side the relation presents itself thus, that being itself spreads out over all distinction-moments, assimilates them all to itself, since it is itself the primal element of which they are all formed; from the negative side, on the other hand, thus, that every distinction as such falls outside being and therefore ceases to be. If we thus speak of the being of A and of B, then they both seem each for itself to have one moment that is absorbed into being, and another, on the other hand, that falls outside [3] it. A we can then think of as divided into a and α , B into b and β ; if a and b now fall within being, then α and β fall outside. Since now a in its distinction from b actually exists, one must again be able to speak of the being of a and of b, and halve a and b anew; the remaining difference thereby shrinks to half, this half can again be halved, and so on to infinity, until being has extended its power over everything and conquered all distinction. In the negative form we see at once that, since a and b fall outside being, they are not at all; they are then annihilated; one posits and recognizes them in their nothing.

In its first form, then, the extension of being must be presented as: being + being + ...; in the latter, on the other hand, as being + nothing.

In both forms being is posited as unlimited. But the latter mode of expression is far more determinate than the first; for while the former merely indicates a thought-experiment, the latter presents the final result. **Being thus has nothing outside itself.**

But even the result thereby yielded is burdened with a great ambiguity, and one such as lies in language itself. The proposition: nothing limits being, can express: 1) that being exceeds all limits, that there is not anything that can set it barriers, that it is positively unlimited; 2) that nothing really can set being a barrier, that where nothingness comes to dominion, being must cease. Here, then, a definition of the unlimitedness of being is really given. Indeterminate being is thought in its whole

indeterminateness as such, i.e. its indeterminateness is posited as its determination. But in order to get some determination into being, which absorbs all determinations, [4] one must connect a determinate thought with the otherwise indeterminate nothing. Being, which sublates all distinction, thus cannot after all get the better of the most general distinction-moment, of negation as such, of non-being, or of nothing. **Being is then not nothing, and nothing not being.** But in its pure immediacy this distinction cannot hold its ground either. If one tries, e.g., to think being as the sum of all realities whose oppositions have been levelled out, thus as pure, solid, universal reality itself, then nothing is to be represented as the pure abyss of emptiness. Emptiness thus has its being alongside reality; but it is characteristic of empty being that it contains only itself, and the being of reality likewise contains only itself; reality and emptiness then cease here to be oppositions: we find nothing in being and being in nothing. The question: what is pure being, demands that being affirm itself through its other. Being thus here seeks its different determinations: $x + y + z$. If we could find these, then we could also define being. We have already found them; for it is evident that what is sought in $x + y + z$ must be distinction-moments, and since we now know that all distinction has vanished, we must put in their place: nothing + nothing + nothing. Since now nothing here quite generally denotes a missing distinction, nothing in this general form = nothing. Therefore: being comes through nothing to itself: **being is nothing**. The proposition: being is nothing, is the purest expression of the fundamental law that all unity as such is its own opposition, i.e. that opposition springs from unity itself. From the positive standpoint we can now say that pure being [5] here is on the point of restoring all the oppositions it formerly absorbed, although these cannot yet be characterized except by the common determination that they are everywhere to constitute the nothing of pure being. In positing its own nothing, being thereby gives all oppositions their specific being, and thereby posits itself as the **absolute** being. From the negative standpoint, on the other hand, the proposition expresses this, that pure being as such is a phantom, a contentless abstraction, and that true being must be sought in the oppositions from which we have abstracted, i.e. in the things that are. This thought consciousness holds fast with ease. When everything that is is taken away, nothing remains. Being stripped of everything that is, is then pure nothing. We can now also reverse the proposition and say: **nothing is pure being**. However negative pure nothing may be in all its shapes, it nevertheless shows itself everywhere as a being. The represented nothing is the empty place from which everything has been taken away; but if one now represented the place as taken

away, one would have to represent at the same time the place where the place had been. Nothing thus continues to present itself as the place that is, though empty, i.e. as the being whose concrete determinations have been removed, i.e. as pure being. This representation is also justified by strict thinking. Pure nothing, namely, is at home not in the world of sensibility but in that of thought. But the negative operation of thinking, which sublates all immediacy, cannot come to pure nothing except by negating immediacy in its most universal shape, i.e. pure being. Pure nothing is thus the reflex of pure being itself, transferred from the form of immediacy into that of [6] reflection.

Herewith we have arrived at two mutually contradictory propositions: a) being is not nothing (nothing is not being), and b) being is nothing (nothing is being). Since we can deny neither of these propositions, while the one nevertheless sublates the other, there is no other way out than to press the transition of each into the other.

When we began to think pure being, thought was driven over to the opposite extreme, pure nothing, and in the endeavor to hold this fast, it was led back again to being. Thought was thus really in movement, because its object was constantly moving; but it did not notice the movement as such. It therefore tried first, quite immediately, to grasp being as resting in itself, and when it came to nothing, it likewise believed it could hold this fast in its purity; now, on the other hand, it knows that it is not to settle down in either of the categories named. The new category, which elucidates the transition of being and nothing into each other, is **becoming**.

When thought is to hold fast the transition as such, it must move without interruption between the opposed terms; the thought of being cannot be absolutely simultaneous with the thought of nothing. In this oscillation the distinction of the two moments is preserved. Thus we now see that being must continually alternate with nothing; thus we have: being, nothing, being. But the movement still seems merely to belong to thought, while both the opposed terms rest quietly side by side.

The true transition is first recognized when we bring out the unity of the moments. Being is nothing; in positing itself, it posits its nothing; its transition into nothing [7] thus rests on its developing its hidden nothing; just as the transition of nothing into being follows solely from its having being in itself.

In the series of becoming, then, each of the opposed terms must be **doubled**: being (a), nothing (a) | nothing (b), being (b). For each of the terms contains both a posited and a not yet posited moment, when we present it objectively, or, taken from the subjective standpoint, an overt and a hidden side. If we thus begin with immediate

being (a), then it seems indeed at first glance only to want to posit itself being (a) = being (a), but if we consider it more closely, it at once turns its other side forward, namely its hidden nothing (a). In that nothing (a) comes forth, it thereby becomes itself posited, and can therefore, as nothing (b), become a new and immediate initial term, which, itself sprung from being (a), must now also posit its hidden being-moment, being (b). Although now being (a) is itself nothing (a), and nothing (a) again nothing (b) etc., there is nevertheless just as much a distinction between being (a) and nothing (a) as between nothing (a) and nothing (b); unity and distinction come and vanish to infinity: it is a restless unity in a restless distinction. Because of the opposition that constantly obtains between the overt and the hidden moment, it is by no means indifferent whether one begins with being as posited, so that it can posit its nothing, or with a posited nothing that is to posit its being.

The emergence of being from nothing is an **arising**; nothing, on the other hand, results from being through a **passing away**. But in consequence of the identity of [8] the moments every arising is again a passing away, and conversely. Becoming is thus a concept that really results from being and nothing. But in that all the moments of the concept are posited and developed, they thereby all come to be present. Being then no longer seeks its nothing, it already has it; nor does nothing pass over into being, for since it has posited its being, there is no transition to make. The restless unity of the moments thereby comes to rest: becoming is sublated.

b) Determinate Being.

§ 12.

Something, Other, Change.

In *determinate being*, i.e. the double being, nothing is posited with being and being with nothing. Being, which has sublated its nothing and integrated itself, thereby becomes something, while nothing, determined by its being, now also closes together with itself, and shows itself as *other*. Since it is the same being and the same nothing that have here doubled their unity and distinction, something is itself other, and other something: the truth lies in the *change* of both. Being, nothing and becoming we can now regard as the fundamental elements from which all subsequent logical categories develop; these now follow one another as ever more perfect expressions for specifications of positive being and of negation in their reciprocal transition, delimitation and reflection.

Being, which through its nothing delimits itself, is determinate being; the moments of this self-delimitation develop as follows: A) In becoming it was shown that nothing [9] came forth from being, just as being from nothing; we thereby obtain as the first term: being (a), nothing, being (b). Through the intervening nothing there arises a nuance of opposition between being (a) and being (b); for there is a distinction between the being that immediately precedes the negation and the being that results from the posited negation. We thus have here not simply being + being in the unlimited, as in § 11, where being in its untrue abstract immediacy was = being, and therefore also nothing; but being has here doubled itself: it is in determinate being that being first comes **to** being. B) Through the doubled being the moment of nothingness glimmers forth and vanishes. Nothing vanishes in determinate being: for the negation that separates being (a) from being (b) is here to denote only the distinction that underlies the mediated unity of the two moments. Nothing **thereby itself comes to nothing**. If we analyze the content of this pregnant proposition, it contains: α) that nothingness wholly ceases and is overcome by determinate being, β) that nothingness (negation) itself acquires determinate being, i.e. becomes a determinately existent nothing. This determinate being follows directly from § 11, where we saw that nothing, just because it was not being, had being in itself. The only way in which determinate being can get free of the hollow, empty nothing is that nothing itself is brought into determinate being. Just as being went together with itself through nothing, so now nothing (a) goes together through being (the negation of nothing) with nothing (b) and becomes one doubled in itself, i.e. a **determinately existent** nothing. C) Herewith determinate being itself has been reduplicated; it must therefore be more closely determined as: 1) determinate being [being (a) nothing, being (b)] delimited by 2) determinate being [nothing (a) being, nothing (b);] the first term is here to be regarded as the [10] thoroughgoing position; the second term, on the other hand, as the thought-through negation; the identity of both first constitutes the full, integrated **determinate being**, which can more determinately be posited as **determinate existence**.

In determinate existence each of the developed terms must now be thought for itself in one thought, seen in one view; thereby the determinately existent being is to be determined as **something**, the determinately existent nothing as **other**. For the development of something and other, being is our firm basis: abstract nothing has vanished; we have left only being's own positive oppositions. In something we meet an immediate **being**, but in its pure immediacy this is merely the first point of determinate existence, which at once refers to an **other** being. If this reference were

now continued to infinity, determinate existence would never come to be something; when, on the other hand, otherness is retorted, when it becomes a moment through which what is doubles and integrates itself, it acquires its proper limit, and is posited as determinately existent^{*)}. Just as the being reduplicated in determinate being has nothingness as a sublated moment, so the determinate something too now has the moment of otherness in it; but so long as other itself is not yet developed, something lacks full determinateness. Other is indeed precisely the true limit of something; if this is not fixed as such, then something itself flows away in the stream of determinate existence: **in order that something be able to maintain itself, other must become** [11] **something**. This thought contains a significant pregnancy; for it expresses: a) that other itself is to support the positive something, i.e. that something must posit its hidden other in order through this otherness to affirm itself. Thus the moments: something (a) (the beginning something), other (the determinate limit), something (b) (the something resulting from otherness), belong together in one single immediacy, in order to produce the determinate existence of something, or the full-born something; next (b) that other itself becomes something, that it holds itself in its otherness as such, and sustains its own determinate existence.

The determinate existence of other is determined by a further development of the determinately existent nothing. That other occupies the place of negation is evident at once from its belonging to thought and reflection. All the moments of mediation that are required in order to develop something must again be sublated; in something immediacy predominates; consciousness of any other whatever is pushed back, so that something may be seen in its own light. Otherness, on the other hand, presents itself at once in a double light; it does not testify straightforwardly about itself, but always takes account of the preceding something. Something must be the **first**, then follows the **other** (*secundum, from sequi*). But when other enters, it is really all over with something; other does indeed, in immediately positing itself, also become something; but this is surely **something** quite **other**.

The two opposed terms thus seem to keep quiet, each on its own side. Their mutual indifference stems from their closed-off being. Something is only itself, and therefore does not care about other. Other does indicate an exclusion of something; but since it does not itself lay claim to being everything, but only an other, this

^{*)}In sensation we take up a multiplicity of the moments of determinate existence; but owing to the constant vanishing of the one into the other, mere sensation never arrives at a determinate apprehension of something.

exclusion is no absolute displacement. Both are, so to speak, decent neighbors who [12] live in peace because each keeps to its own. The relation, however, cannot be sublated. Since that whereby something is integrated is precisely an other, and that whereby other sustains itself is a sublated something, they continually result from each other. Something is the anticipated other, and other the explicated something. Something thereby continually becomes other, and other something. That something is itself its other, and other itself its something, is comprehensible only in that the other that lies in something is at the same time the something that develops out of other. Thus something comes to delimit itself; it finds again only itself in every other, and posits its infinity.

But other is itself its something in that it has something for its other. In that something now comes forth at every point, other too recognizes everywhere its own otherness, and likewise delimits itself as the infinite. Thus determinate existence seems to get the better of nothing; but it will soon be shown that it is just as much nothing that has itself come to be, and thereby destroys positive determinate existence. As the more determinate expression of the relation, otherness everywhere gains the upper hand. The opposition cannot vanish without our sinking back down to abstract being. Something is indeed itself its other, but not tautologically. The truth is that something **changes**. Other is the determinate nothing of something, just as something is the positive nothing for other. The more sharply something delimits and excludes other in order to maintain itself, the more it brings about its own dissolution, since it is itself its other. Self-dissolution thus belongs to the concept of the determinately existent something. Likewise, when other has something for its other, the meaning is not that other immediately is = other; but conversely, that other is distinct from [13] other. In **change** the positive identity of something and other is reduced to being a moment of an infinite delimitation and breaking down of all limits: the abiding characteristic is thus finitude and transience.

Change is concrete becoming, though with the modification that, just as becoming most nearly denotes a coming-to-be whereby determinate existence is **introduced**, so change most nearly expresses a destruction in which determinate existence is **sublated**.

The movement of change is expressed in the following propositions: a) from something comes other; b) from nothing (i.e. from the determinate, determinately existent nothing, namely other) comes something, and finally c) from nothing comes nothing; for in change something and other are each other's reciprocal nothing, and precisely

for that reason each a nothing for itself. In change lies the infinite **annihilation** of determinate existence. It is no foreign power to which determinate existence here succumbs. Annihilation is its own innermost essence. It is therefore so far from being the case that true being should perish in the nothing of determinate existence, that it rather prepares its victory out of alteration and corruptibility themselves. What holds of every single moment in determinate existence, namely that it passes over into its other, must necessarily also hold of the whole of determinate existence itself; in its infinite alteration this constantly refers to its true nothing. But this nothing cannot in its positive determinateness be posited as the fragmentary being-for-other; for in this form it is precisely determinate existence itself. If determinate existence ended in such a nothing, it would thereby precisely go together with itself, conquer its whole
 [14] otherness, and become the opposite of what it had formerly been. The nothing in which determinate existence vanishes is precisely the most solid something, which has gone through and overcome every alteration (being-for-other), thus genuine being-for-itself.

c) Being-for-itself.

§ 13.

One, Many, Exclusion.

When determinate being has gone through and overcome every possible change, it determines itself as positive being-for-itself, i.e. as mediated quality. Since otherness has vanished, something posits itself as the indissoluble One, as the logical atom. Everything other is thus only a repetition of the One; otherness and opposition must therefore be sought in plurality. The One, infinitely identical with itself, splits itself into the *Many*. But since each of the Many is itself a One that displaces all others, while they are all absorbed by the One of unity, the self-contradiction of quality is herewith raised to the highest. The for-itself negation therefore expresses itself as an all-sided *exclusion*, which destroys every qualitative limit. The result of the self-development of determinate existence is the perfect identity of something and other. But such a being is no longer determinate being; for its criterion was precisely
 [15] a duality, a finite opposition between the two terms that are. From this it will be seen that the logical sublation of given oppositions is both their annihilation and their preservation. In determinate being the point was to find and posit otherness at all points; in being-for-itself, on the other hand, the point is to overcome it in all shapes,

and to show it as a moment in the closed self-affirmation. In determinate being all determinations were external and relative, because something and other constantly pointed to each other; in being-for-itself determinateness is absolute; here negation and delimitation no longer lie outside, but in that very thing which is for itself. But determinate existence with its moments is nonetheless preserved; for a) it is from these moments that all determinations in being-for-itself are formed. Although the whole infinity of all diversities and changes here sinks together into immediate unity, our being-for-itself is not on that account pure being. In pure being the distinctions were not yet logically posited; in being-for-itself they are posited as overcome. In order to think the identity of being-for-itself, one must first think the distinction of determinate being. b) it is so far from being the case that being-for-itself could immediately displace otherness, that it must rather, in order to identify it with itself, raise it to a for-itself other. Thereby being-for-itself itself gets determinate being. c) As being-for-itself goes together with itself through determinate being, and thus raises itself above determinate existence, this happens solely in that all the moments of determinate existence themselves, at every point, in every form, are raised to being-for-itself. All this will become more evident from what follows.

In being-for-itself we must now, in the first place, not seek “**something**”; for since the for-itself something has gone together with its other, it no longer deserves [16] this name; just as other too, which has identified something with itself, loses the character of otherness. — Still less can we begin here with the indefinite article’s **a**; for while it is true that “a” is a common determination for something and other, in this way being is common to all logical categories. “A” is wholly indifferent to the distinction that lies in something and other; if we do not have **a** something, then we have **an** other; the sublated distinction of both is on the other hand expressed determinately in the category “**One**”, as the real identity-category. Finitude, duality, has vanished, in that something and other merge into **One**. The unity in which something and other are here sublated must be regarded from a double side. Partly it is something that sublates other and makes itself “one” with it; partly it is conversely other that makes itself “one” with something. We therefore have at once a double One, namely One (a), which began from something, and One (b), which began from other. But since all distinction between something and other is overcome, it is from this standpoint wholly indifferent whether we begin with something or with other; both the terms named are then in truth One. Thus One (c) must express the unity of both. Had there now been the least opposition between One (a) and One (b), then One

(c) would thereby have vindicated for itself a meaning of its own as the higher unity that sublated both the preceding terms; but since these are **for themselves** identical, the last term stands wholly **for** itself, as a repetition of what is already given. The three ones are thus in and for themselves identical, which can be expressed by a new
 [17] term, One (d); thus the One produces itself to infinity. **One** is here set against **One**; but the opposition vanishes like a shadow; for One is - One. It is by its inexhaustible self-production that the One overcomes everything **other**.

The only form under which the opposition is still preserved must then be sought in the production itself. The producing One in its being-for-itself can be opposed only to the whole sum of the produced ones, as this is for itself: **the One** can be opposed only to the Many. Unity and plurality are then the duality that the One here encloses; we shall now see how this is developed and overcome.

One is the immediate and determinate expression of unity; but just because the One is itself the full unity, plurality, although a product of the One, comes to lie outside unity. But outside unity the One is at the same time outside itself. One can indeed say that every produced One is its own unity; but in this form it then no longer comes forth as produced in opposition to the producing One. As a term in plurality every One is delimited by other ones; in plurality the One breaks apart its own being-for-itself. But this going-out of the One from itself into plurality is precisely its going-back to itself and to unity. That the One has gone out beyond itself means, in other words, that it has become its own limit. Outside unity, where we should have expected something other, we meet the One, only in inverted shape. The One of unity, which is the principle of plurality, itself constitutes the first term in the series of plurality. As principle it has the whole of plurality in itself; as the first term of the series it is itself one of the Many, and coordinated with any other whatever. Every term in the series of plurality is consequently itself pregnant with a plurality.
 [18] The Many 2 are the very explication of the One, and the One the concentration of the Many. Thus the One of unity presents itself in a double form, namely as the principle of plurality, and as that which itself results from plurality. Thereby unity everywhere takes itself back out of its own plurality and integrates its being-for-itself. The same now holds of plurality as well. Since the true unity results from plurality, we must begin here with this. The many ones in their simultaneous existence thus precede unity: their sporadic character bears witness to the being-for-itself of plurality. But this being-for-itself is as yet only abstract. Plurality rests on individual ones, each of which is a unity **for** itself. In every isolated One plurality perishes: the individual One

is, as such, the limit of plurality. But this limit is sublated by plurality itself in a double way: a) In that plurality forbids the individual One to remain within its own unity, it directs its determination toward another One, and while all the ones are externally referred to one another, their unity thereby comes outside them all and outside itself; but this halving of unity, which takes place in such a way that its one moment lies scattered as center for the individual ones, while the other moment hovers over them all, is precisely plurality. Further, b) the moment of unity that everywhere constitutes the center of the being-in-itself of the individual ones is, according to what precedes, the principle of plurality. That plurality thus from all sides forms unity and results from it constitutes its perfect being-for-itself. But **the One** itself seems hereby given up as prey to the most decisive contradiction. It was to be the true solid identity, and yet two opposed elements break forth from its midst in closed circles. Its unity [19] has its being-for-itself directly over against the for-itself plurality. It is, however, so far from the case that this duality could burst the adamant **One**, that the latter, precisely through the determinate existence of the opposition, raises itself to the highest being-for-itself. The plurality through which unity in the One has mediated its being-for-itself is the very same that is in turn mediated through unity itself. The self-mediation of unity thus falls within the limits of plurality, and that of plurality within the limits of unity. Unity first attains its proper being-for-itself through the being-for-itself of plurality. The result is thus that being-for-itself develops in a series of for-itself moments: the one being-for-itself is only for the other; this infinite self-doubling is the means whereby otherness is here conquered.

In this result the development of quality culminates. Quality is being-for-itself posited in the form of immediacy. The moments of opposition that pure being absorbed are hereby given back. The unity of being is the principle of infinite specification. The carrying-through of this specification forms an atomistic element in logic, which dialectic can never dissolve without itself vanishing. Every category is a logical atom whose being-for-the-others is uninterruptedly mediated through its being-for-itself.^{*)}

^{*)}The category treated here plays a great role in theology, whose task it is precisely to mediate the being-for-itself of God with the being-for-itself of the world. The Hegelian disciples, however, seem not to grant it its due, however masterfully the master himself has developed it in his way. The reason for this is explicable. People have amused themselves so royally at seeing how, by the magic power of dialectic, the one could constantly turn over into the other, so that in the much-praised philosophy of spirit everything has in the end become a being-for-other. — The principle of the thoroughgoing mythical treatment of the life of Jesus is the idea of self-consciousness's own production of Christ. Christ, the Christ-consciousness, is then to be for human consciousness (i.e. for other) without really being for itself. — Thus, to be sure, everything becomes quite fluid; the qualities in this speculative fluid have no aftertaste; for there are none. It is pure philosophy, purified of all elements of representation;

[20] This positive form of being-for-itself expresses perfect immediacy. Every moment must be taken **for** itself; for it is as it is. From so complete a positivity, therefore, nothingness, which in determinate being hid itself under the mask of otherness, seems to be wholly displaced. Where could it now force its way in, since all places are surely occupied by solid ones and affirmative qualities? But if negation is not in positive being-for-itself itself, it must have a being-for-itself. This it has had, during our development so far, in the observing consciousness.

When the question was of the **limit of** the One, the question was really of its **negation**; but instead of the negative operation of self-negation, there presented itself at once the positive expression of negation, i.e. the Many. Since the positive moments are thus everywhere posited in the place of negation, they are mutually
 [21] each other's negation; being-for-itself must therefore be developed through all its negative relations and movements.

The One is, as we have seen, the identity of something and other. This identity has a wholly negative character, for it comes forth through the change of change. In change the negation that is was at work in that something and other were for each other other and nothing; the one nothing thus alternated with the other. This alternation bore an external stamp; for although something became nothing each time it passed over into other, it was not on that account any the less still a positive something in itself. Negation was thus merely relative: nothing had determinate being, but as yet no being-for-itself. In the thoroughgoing change, on the other hand, it is shown that something could not become other, i.e. its nothing, if it were not already in itself an other. But in that other is made into something, it becomes other to itself and thereby nothing in itself. The unity of something and other is thus to be posited as the doubled nothing in its most perfect likeness to itself: the positive One is of negative descent. We can now concentrate all these moments of negation in the following way:

Something is its other in that it is itself its nothing; for 1) something is = something; therein lies its being (a): it is itself and not other. 2) Something is = other: the being that something has lies not in itself, but in other. In its other it obtains its positive being (b). According to b, a must be the first negation of something, nothing (a): something **is not** what it is; it is in itself nothing, therefore it reaches out beyond itself in order in b to **be** what it is not. Since b expresses what something is not, it is in turn negated by a and thereby reduced to a nothing b. In order that the double being in something no

its pure being is purer than pure water.

longer be burdened with the relative opposition of determinate existence, but merge [22] more perfectly into **One**, each of the terms must itself be its nothing; without this reciprocal self-negation they cannot become positively identical. Thus the otherness taken up into something transforms itself into a pervasive negation. In that the One is posited, it acquires at once a positive and a negative side. The positive side comes forth in that being (a) is identified with being (b); but the identification goes through negation; nothing (a) is identified with nothing (b).

From this it now becomes clear that the One is its own negation. The negative side represents to us here retorted otherness. Outside the One, then, there lies no **nothing**; for the for-itself negation moves in and through the One; still less anything whatever other; for the whole of otherness is enclosed in the negative movement. The One has gone into itself and has taken everything with it: an **outside** no longer holds. But this identity of the positive and the negative side calls forth the unrest of contradiction in **the One** itself. The moments that constitute the positive side are the very same as those that determine the negative. Here there is not a position + a negation, but a position that is itself negation, and conversely. If we call, e.g., the positive side A, the negative B, then the One can hold itself in the moment A only by taking up the negative movement of B, and making itself into what B is; but B is precisely A's thoroughgoing negation. Thus A becomes the negative of itself; positivity falls over onto B, which in turn absorbs the negative moments in A. During the continued rotation of A and B the One vibrates uninterruptedly between itself and its nothing. But this nothing is itself a One, which makes its preceding One [23] into nothing. Therefore the for-itself negation is to be characterized as **exclusion**. In exclusion, the sharpest limit of quality, lies precisely the whole hardness with which closed positivity separates itself from closed negativity. This shows itself when we follow it through all its moments of movement, as a) beginning, b) reciprocal, c) absolute exclusion. Beginning exclusion is the One's own coming-to-be. The One posits itself in the moment A, thereby it excludes the positivity in B; B now vindicates its positivity and excludes the positive A. Under this dialectical pulse-beat the One must move, although it stands still. It moves; for scarcely has it fixed its positivity before this is at once broken down by negation. But it nevertheless stands still; for there is and remains only one single One; when the one One comes, the other is excluded. Thereby the One enters into a relation to itself that is no relation, and yet a relation; for the One that arises always presupposes the one that passes away: exclusion becomes reciprocal.

Every One thus has the property of positing itself and excluding another One; but this in turn posits itself, and excludes another, etc. Therefore the One exists only in plurality. In plurality all the individual ones divide between them self-maintenance and exclusion of the rest; these two activities condition each other. But the equilibrium of plurality is continually sublated; for what the one does, they all do. If the one One deduces its existence from itself, then the rest do the same: all the ones in plurality are at one stroke. If the one cannot exist except by excluding all the rest, then these [24] too cannot come into existence before they have accomplished the exclusion of the one and of one another. This is precisely what is desperate in the for-itself negation, that it knows no restriction. In logical despair the One splits itself apart in order to save its identity in plurality; but plurality rests on the maintenance of the One and perishes in its dissolution. Hereby all qualitative barriers are burst.

What is surprising in this contradiction stems from a residual immediacy. One concludes according to the principium exclusi medii: either the individual ones are excluded, or they are not. But such a dilemma cannot hold its ground when exclusion becomes absolute. For according to what precedes, the ones are posited in their individuality by exclusion itself; when this is now accomplished on the individual One, then justice is thereby done to it. The exclusion of all individuals is the position of all; every One then first posits itself in and **for** itself when it posits itself in and **for** all the rest: absolute exclusion is an assimilation.

Transition.

When it was said above, in the positive development, that unity through the being-for-itself of plurality obtained its perfect being-for-itself, the main thought was that the one positive opposite was to integrate the other. Therefore rounded immediacy came forth everywhere, and everything presented itself in the form of quality.

Now, on the other hand, since thoroughgoing negation has sublated the whole qualitative immediacy, the otherness that was pushed back and hidden has been duly drawn forth, and being-for-itself has **out of itself** become a being-for-other. Plurality [25] is again recognized as unity's other; but the One is no longer split apart into the Many, for its being-in-itself is at the same time its being outside itself. In that this **outside** is given back, unity continues itself by a pliant transition into other, produces its otherness everywhere and assimilates it to itself. All specifications are now to be regarded as extensions and restrictions of one and the selfsame One. This One is

no longer qualitative, for it has no being-for-itself outside the specifying movement. Self-extension and self-restriction are its own immanent determinations. Thus the stiff, fixed limit of qualitative being-for-itself has now become elastic and mobile; it therefore determines itself as

B. Quantity.

a) *Pure Quantity.*

§ 14.

Continuity, Discreteness, Limitation.

Quantity, the unity of being-for-itself and being-for-other, is the real limit. In that the limit develops its identity with the adjacent, it becomes delimited by itself, and is in this its self-extension determined as *continuity*. But the middle of the limit is the exclusive negation of everything adjacent, and thereby its own negative unity; as such the limit falls apart from itself into sheer exclusive limit-moments, and is *discreteness*. *Limitation*, the posited unity of continuity and discreteness, constitutes [26] the real determinate being of the limit, or its full self-delimitation.

Determinate being was only a being for other; therefore it passed through change over into being-for-itself. By absorbing otherness, being-for-itself took up its exclusive negation into itself, and therefore had to go out beyond itself; quantity, which is the higher unity of both, is now to develop the higher other of determinate being out of the One of being-for-itself, and must therefore be determined as the transition of both into each other, i.e. as the **limit**. The immediate or qualitative limit is a negative middle between two positive opposites: every quality has its limit. In quality the limit, as the real middle between something and other, is the pure negation that is in itself. The negative side of the limit, on the other hand, which turns toward something, is at once assimilated with the positive something itself, just as the side turned toward other is absorbed into the latter's positivity. The limit of quality is therefore positive determinateness. Determinateness is negation, but a negation that is absorbed as a vanishing moment in position: quality is a being-for-itself that must be taken positively, as it is. But if the limit that separates two qualities is as such neither the one nor the other of these, then both must, in the limit itself, be regarded as absent, and that not merely from each other, but also from the middle of the real

limit-line. They then do not border immediately on each other, but on the common limit. We thus have: adjacent, limit, adjacent... to infinity. — But just as being (§ 11) passed over into nothing because, as such, it had nothing in itself, and conversely, [27] so the limit and the adjacent here continually pass over into each other. If we call the limit's being-for-itself a , its being for the adjacent b , the adjacent's being for the limit α , its being for itself β , then it is shown that it is the limit that in the adjacent continually borders on itself. For since b lies between the limit and the adjacent, it is thereby itself to be regarded as the real negative and exclusive limit, for which a and α are adjacent moments. But just because b is now the for-itself limit, α becomes the limit-negation between b and β . In this way the limit continues to shift itself in infinite progress. This, then, is characteristic of the limit, that in exclusive fashion it is always both in and **outside** itself. Limit-mediation makes the adjacent **into** limit in the same instant as it makes the limit into an adjacent. In this self-extension of the limit quantity is posited as **continuity**.

In continuity it is shown that the limit cannot be anything stationary. Each time the limit is posited with a certain immediate determinateness, it is surrounded by an adjacent; but this is, as we have seen, itself limit, and consequently the limit itself. Therefore: only by the limit's going through all its delimitation-moments, positing and sublating all its determinations, can it be grasped as true limit. But in the self-shifting of the limit there lies at the same time an infinite repetition of its exclusive negation. What is first determined as the pure for-itself limit becomes in the next moment an adjacent; but every adjacent is likewise a for-itself limit: the one limit thereby excludes the other; but since each limit is determined in the same way, then [28] limit is always = limit; the limit thus excludes itself, posits itself thereby as separated from itself: in this completed self-separation the limit is **discreteness**. The pure limit then dissolves into a plurality of limits, such that each in turn contains for itself a limit-plurality. In the limit there is at once both continuity and discreteness, or, more precisely expressed, the limit is itself the true middle of continuity and discreteness. It is this sharp separation of both moments that underlies the Eleatic presentation of the logical impossibility of movement. One can, namely, in the line of continuity posit any two discrete points, e.g. A and B in the line **A—c—B**; the line itself is wholly indifferent to these; for it can be extended beyond both: the discreteness of the points is posited in external fashion in the flowing continuity of the line.

The question of the possibility of movement is now reduced to the question of what conditions its result. Before he who moves can come from A to B , he must

first have come half the way, namely from A to c. But the distance from A to c can again be halved, and the halving of the halved distances continues without cease. The absurdity of movement then lies in this, that even the shortest way cannot be covered before a still shorter one has been run through: movement presupposes itself to infinity. The result of the very first movement would thus have to be: 1) a **determinate** continuity (i.e. continuity with a finitely small extension); for without a certain distance between starting point and end point movement cannot be thought; 2) an **indivisible** continuity (with an **infinitely** small extension); for otherwise the movement would not be the first. The contradiction thus lies in this, that one demands a continuity without discreteness, while one nevertheless proceeds from the [29] consideration that every continuum can be separated into discrete moments. Thereby one comes to think movement outside movement itself. For prior to the very first starting point no movement can be given, since it is the first; but when movement stands still at the very first point, then it can surely never reach the second. Thus one comes also to think rest outside rest itself. Every rest is the result of a preceding movement. Movement cannot now come to rest at the second point, because it constantly rests at the first; but neither can it rest at the first, because no movement has gone before it.

The truth is that completed movement contains continuity and discreteness in indissoluble unity. The Eleatics have merely confined themselves to demonstrating both opposites, and instead of recognizing the transition of the one into the other, so as thus to comprehend movement from movement itself, they have pressed continuity and discreteness each for itself, and reduced movement to a discrete and consequently absurd standing-still. — Only movement can sublate the sharp opposition between continuity and discreteness. Just as becoming was an uninterrupted transition from being to nothing, and thereby at once affirmed and negated both moments, so movement is now a constant hovering between standing-still (the moment of discreteness) and self-shifting (the continuity-moment), and consequently the medium in which both are posited.

The result of movement is thus a continuity determined by discreteness, delimited by a discreteness determined by continuity, or, in other words, the determinate existence of quantity as quantum in continuous and discrete magnitude. Discrete [30] magnitude, since it has continuity in it, is a plurality of separate continua, just as continuous magnitude is a unity of several discrete moments. If one now tries to transform discrete magnitude as such into continuous, or conversely the latter into

the former, then one comes to the antinomy of infinite divisibility.

a) Continuous magnitude can be divided; for it has the moment of discreteness in it, and each of the discrete parts are themselves continua. By division, then, continuous magnitude is dissolved into a plurality of continuous magnitudes, which again each for itself can be divided: continuous magnitude is **infinitely divisible**.

b) Since the result of every division is a continuous magnitude, it is so far from the case that the continuation of division could sublate the continuity of the magnitude, that it rather becomes a repeated confirmation of it: continuous magnitude is consequently **absolutely indivisible**.

This contradiction one is now accustomed to veil by presenting every magnitude as consisting of infinitely many, infinitely small parts. Such an explanation displays an infinitely beautiful mathematical balance, in which the one thoughtlessness outweighs the other. One is in the first place to think that an infinite division is completed, that is, comes to an end; next, that the parts that are yielded by the infinite division are infinitely small (= 0), i.e. **no** parts.

It becomes evident from this that divisibility and indivisibility mutually condition each other. The parts are themselves magnitudes and the magnitudes parts. In that the one magnitude is delimited by the other, it is delimited in itself by its parts, and thus [31] **limitation**, or infinite delimitation, is realized. The elements of limitation are sheer magnitudes and sheer parts. Each part is as such a singularity; each magnitude, on the other hand, a composite. But since the part is itself magnitude, and the magnitude part, then the composite passes over into the single, and the latter into the former. Each single thing must as such be posited in its positivity, like each of the ones in being-for-itself. But here the single One is posited with the express determination that it is to be delimited by another single One. The point here is then not, as before, the return of unity to itself through plurality, but a **determinate** plurality and a unity **delimited** by plurality. The limiting unity and plurality are determined by a threefold act: 1) each of the terms of plurality is separated and posited for itself; 2) the posited terms are taken together, whereby magnitude, as encompassing unity, becomes composite; 3) the comprehending unity is again posited for itself as a new singularity. In this separating and taking-together limitation is numeration.

b) Number.

Number-Unit, Amount, Innumerability.

In limitation the unity of continuity is delimited on all sides by the plurality of discreteness; the mutual determination of both is to be posited as number. In the continuity of number the discrete plurality is at once absorbed and excluded; with this determination continuity is *number-unit*, and the discreteness of plurality is *amount*. Since each of the ones of the amount is a number-unit that contains its amount, [32] then number moves infinitely within itself, and yet goes everywhere outside itself: *innumerability* is number's own self-dissolution.

From the beginning of the logical development a determination of numeration has hovered before thought; for without such, no repetition, no opposition can be held fast. The moment of numeration expressed itself clearly in the **other** (secundum) of determinate being, still more clearly in the **One** and **Many** of being-for-itself. But with categorical accent numeration could not come forth in quality. In the determination of other the point was really to show what it was in itself, as a being (alterum, aliud), in opposition to something; its determination as a secundum was, on the other hand, wholly external and fleeting. Even in being-for-itself the concern was really only the qualitative genesis of the ones. The One of being-for-itself was therefore most nearly to be regarded as a One of identity; even plurality was qualitative, for it was determined merely as the sublated other of the for-itself unity; therefore the question was not yet asked: **how many**? Now, on the other hand, since unity has become a continuity that has taken up plurality into itself as its own discreteness, quantity posits itself as a unity perfectly determined through its discrete ones. Hereby the logical movement of thought comes as near as possible to illogical immediacy; for in numeration it confines itself to a pointing-out of the individual ones, such that each is held fast for itself and only in external relation to the rest. The result of numeration is the concept of number. Admittedly no numeration can in reality take place without the determination of number hovering before consciousness, but in the immediate [33] counting: 1+1+1 etc., each of the ones **is** still most nearly apprehended as qualitative being-for-itself; only through the comprehending operation of counting-up does the determinate concept of a unit, a two etc., i.e. of **number** as such, come forth. The most perfect being-determination at which we have now arrived must then be posited as a number-determination. All determinate existence is **a number**^{*)}, for it is a unit that repeats itself to infinity, but with each repetition obtains a new and wholly specific

^{*)}From this standpoint the Pythagorean philosophy must be judged.

meaning. Every unit is immediately one with itself, but in this being-for-itself it has its peculiar place in the series of ones. What is characteristic of the number-unit is precisely this, that with all its variety it is nevertheless in every moment so absolutely delimited. Insofar as the number-unit is regarded as such, e.g. a five as opposed to a six, it is absolutely identical with itself, and has excluded all plurality. But this exclusion is just as much a sublation and taking-up of the ones of plurality; for only in relation to a delimited plurality can unity be determined. Only by positing $1 + 1 + 1 + 1 + 1$ do we obtain the unity 5. But in the moment of plurality each of the ones is to be posited for itself and to follow a necessary determinate order; in that plurality is thus encompassed by unity, each of its ones is counted. These counted ones of plurality now constitute the second main side of number, namely **amount**. The amount is precisely the limit between unity and plurality; for while on the one [34] side it points to the discrete ones, on the other side it expresses their taking-together in the number-unit. The amount always states the reciprocal determination of unity and plurality: so great a unity, so great a plurality³⁾. In the amount, therefore, the inner contradiction of number comes clearly to appearance. For unity, plurality and the counted ones each have in the amount their abstract being-for-itself, while they are nevertheless only for one another. The number-unit is given in its simplest and most general form in the number 1. But 1 is always = 1. This tautological likeness of unity [35] with itself 33 makes it necessary that one, in order to **come** to a development of the ones of plurality, must take to one's aid another determination which, moreover, by its nature lies wholly outside the concept of number. For the thought of $1+1$ demands that one separate 1 from 1. In the sphere of representation this separation takes place very easily, since one here generally counts the determinately existent objects themselves. But if one now abstracts from all specific qualities, then one comes to

³⁾The peculiar development of unity and amount is given in the deduction of the four arithmetical operations, but here the number-determinations pass over into mathematics' own specifications in such a way that they can no longer become moments in speculative logic. A concrete development of numerical relations in their various transitions would require a thoroughgoing philosophy of mathematics. For while mathematics immediately presupposes its peculiar axiomata and by stringent definitions of the understanding characterizes its problems and justifies its procedure by the operations themselves and their results, the philosophy of mathematics would, on the other hand, have to deduce the peculiarity of the operations and of the results from the very concept of quantity itself. Mathematics obtains its exact character by the sharp delimitation with which it keeps all heterogeneous elements away. But precisely the circumstance that mathematical results can be applied to real determinate existence shows that the number-determinations are abstracted from a more concrete world. A philosophy of mathematics ought therefore to demonstrate the one-sidedness and contradiction with which all mathematical determinations are burdened, and thereby make it evident that this science, however independent it may seem to the immediate understanding, nonetheless dialectically sublates itself in order to become a moment in an all-embracing cognition of the world.

posit 1, 1, 1... This positing looks indeed at first glance like a repetition, but according to the pure concept of unity it really is not one. Thought cannot separate the one 1 from the other if one does not look about for heterogeneous criteria, e.g. time and succession. But succession lies wholly outside the concept of number. That 1 is a sign that can be written in several different places, that it can be uttered by repeating the same word several times, does not concern abstract unity as such. When, therefore, a real numerical separation is to take place, one must have a certain quality, no matter which, in mente. This quality is now to be regarded as the other of quantity, as the negation through which it takes itself back. Herewith, then, number goes outside itself and thus realizes the first main requirement of quantity.

But quality itself obtains no qualitative determination whatever through numeration itself^{*)}. As it is to number wholly indifferent whether we count the stars in the sky or the grains of sand on the seashore, so is it also indifferent to each single star whether it is posited in the amount as the 1st or as the 10th. On this indifference of number toward everything other is grounded the innumerability of the qualities of determinate existence. The things in the world can indeed be counted, but only on the presupposition that they present themselves with external, contingent restriction and delimitation. One can count the buttons on a coat; but there are in the world never so many coats and never so many buttons; there could, after all, as far as these immediate qualities themselves are concerned, be many more. That God, on the other hand, has numbered the hairs of men's heads is comprehensible only in that he who posits the measure of things at the same time posits the deeper unity of quality and quantity. Were he, on the other hand, first to take the hairs on our heads as given, and begin to count 1, 2, 3, then numeration would never be brought to an end. From this it is evident that number negates its otherness in order to determine itself; quality and quantity cannot delimit each other: **number counts only itself**. Thus we find the second main requirement of quantity, namely that its being **outside** itself is to be precisely its own being in itself, determinately expressed. [36]

But in that number excludes its other, it gives itself its otherness. It is this otherness that we shall now consider more closely.

Since each number is so immediately itself that one can come from one number to another only by the admixture of heterogeneous determinations, the individual

^{*)}Hence it also comes about that one cannot add up different qualities, e.g. 4 tables and 3 chairs. By such an adding-up one would confuse quantity-determinations with quality-determinations, which, according to the nature of quantity, is absurd.

numbers on this account hold themselves in abstract external opposition to one another. The abstract being in itself of number is its equally abstract being **outside** [37] itself. This externality of number knows no limit. Every One in the plurality of the amount can be posited as number-unit for a new amount to infinity: **the numbers are innumerable**.

The **innumerability** of number contains: a) the infinite reproduction of number-determination; b) the vanishing of number-determination; c) the logical sublation of number.

a) In the specific numerical expressions quantity is made finite and defined by quantum + quantum + ... The definitive quanta can be counted; but however long one continues addition and multiplication, the finite quanta never come to an end. Quantity, which sublates every limit, constantly meets new limits, and thus never comes to accomplish the sublation of the limit; it oversteps every amount and yet never reaches out beyond the finitude of numbers. Innumerability, as the unceasing reproduction of definitive number, is hereby posited as the omnipresence of the limit in quantity, as **infinite finitude**.

b) When quantity is expressed in a sum of finite quanta, then one would expect that in this perfect delimitation there was posited a determinate limit for a maximum and minimum; but the greatest in finitude has a finite greatness; there is therefore always a still greater; the smallest finite magnitude has a limit to its smallness; beyond this limit is found a still smaller magnitude. Further, there lies between two given finite magnitudes an infinite amount of other finite magnitudes. Between 1 and 3 lies not merely 2×1 , but $4 \times \frac{1}{2}$, $8 \times \frac{1}{4}$ etc.

Greatness and smallness are thus in infinite finitude wholly relative magnitudes. A minimum and maximum can by external comparison here be posited and sublated everywhere. Thus the discreteness of numbers flows away in the stream of continuity.

[38] Innumerability, as the dissolution of number, is a sublation of all posited limits,

[39] **an infinity resulting from finitude itself**^{*)}. c) In the mediation of amount and

^{*)}As an example taken from mathematics of quantitative infinity in its double form, one may cite the quotient of $\frac{1}{1-x}$, which (on the presupposition: $x > 0$ and < 1) gives $1 + x + x^2 + \dots$. The continued development of the quotient makes evident at once the relation between amount and innumerability and also the contradiction that lies in the approximation to the infinitely great and the infinitely small. At whatever term one breaks off the division, this breaking-off shows itself to be arbitrary. With each new term we obtain an increased definitive numerical value: but it is nevertheless always too small; with every continuation of the division we approach a more adequate expression: but the adequate limit itself flees unceasingly further away. The absolute limit can therefore be said to be just as far away from $1 + x + x^2 + \dots x^{1000}$ as from $1 + x$, whereby the whole approximation, regarded from the absolute standpoint, loses its meaning. This is, as Hegel too has developed it, the contradiction in the infinite

innumerability quantity becomes master of its limit. With the innumerability of the amount it sinks down into sheer delimited quanta and thereby **posits all limits**. The delimited quantum is finite, since it has a limit and constantly points out beyond it in order to obtain its determinateness in another quantum. But since this transition into other lies in the quantum's own determination, since this other is itself quantum, the delimitation is at the same time the sublation of the limit. Finitude mediated with itself is then infinity itself. Through this mediation of finite quanta quantity takes itself back, and **sublates all its limits**. Insofar now as all delimitations are posited [40] and taken up in quantity, the significance of numbers is preserved; but in that the limit is everywhere sublated, number is reduced to a vanishing moment. Instead of the immediately delimited number-unit, we then get a quantity-unity unlimited in its self-delimitation, i.e. **an intensive magnitude**; and instead of the amount a quantity-evolution in which innumerable quanta uninterruptedly fix and sublate all possible number-determinations, i.e. **an extensive magnitude**.

c) Absolute Quantity.

§ 16.

Intensity, Degree, Approximation.

By the infinite position and sublation of the limit, quantity moves within itself, and is absolute quantity. When the discreteness of amount is posited as a sublated moment in the continuity of innumerability, the being-in-itself of quantity is determined as

progression: "Das Quantum hat es in seinem Begriffe ein Jenseits zu haben. Dieß Jenseits ist erstlich das abstracte Moment des Nichtseyns des Quantums: dieses löst sich an sich selbst auf; so bezieht es sich auf sein Jenseits als auf seine Unendlichkeit, nach dem qualitativen Momente des Gegensatzes. Aber zweitens steht das Quantum in Continuitet mit diesem Jenseits; das Quantum besteht eben darin, das Andere seiner selbst, sich selbst äusserlich zu seyn, also ist dies Aeusserliche ebenso sehr nicht ein Anderes als das Quantum: das Jenseits oder das Unendliche ist also selbst ein Quantum. Das Jenseits ist auf diese Weise aus seiner Flucht zurückgerufen, und das Unendliche erreicht. Aber weil dieß zum Diesseits geworden wieder ein Quantum ist, ist nun wieder eine neue Gränze gesetzt worden; diese, als Quantum, ist auch wieder von sich selbst geflohen, ist als solches über sich hinaus, und hat sich in sein Nichtseyn, in sein Jenseits von sich selbst repellirt, das ebenso perennirend zum Quantum wird, als dieses sich von sich selbst zum Jenseits abstößt". (Wissensch. d. Logik. Werke 3 Band p. 265). If the development of the quotient is to be adequately concluded (as by $x^n + \frac{x^{n+1}}{1-x}$), then the progression is hereby reduced to the infinity lying in the relation between dividendus and divisor, and the amount is posited as one with innumerability. In this way true quantitative infinity is given in the expression $\frac{1}{1-x}$ itself. For since dividendus and divisor, each for itself, are determinate finite numbers, their mutual relation is here a determinate, constant relation. But this relation, delimited in itself, is precisely the source of the unlimited numerical magnitude that is evolved in the quotient. The expression $\frac{1}{1-x}$ thereby takes on the character of an intensive magnitude, whose extensity lies in the very evolution of the quotient.

intensity. Each of the moments of intensity has all the others sublated into unity with itself, and is consequently itself an intensity. The relation of the intensities is expressed in *degree*. Degree is the qualitative determinateness of quantity, but still abstractly quantitative. The specific delimitation is reached only by an *approximation*, whose insufficiency compels quantity, closed in itself, to go together with its qualitative other in modality. In the dialectical development of the categories we can distinguish: [41] a) the successive alternation of the opposed terms, which forms a continuous series, while it, so to speak, advances in a straight line; and b) the necessary emergence of the one opposition from the other, whereby the speculative unity of both is cognized, and the movement takes on the character of a circulation. Thus the series: being, nothing, being... can be continued without end; but in becoming it is cognized that nothing emerges from being itself and being from nothing. If one has thus seen through the constant relation between the first two terms of the series, then the meaning of all the subsequent ones is thereby grasped; for however often they are repeated, they are still only a tautological repetition of the first two. The problem that the rectilinear movement calls forth is always solved in the circular movement. As long as quantity is merely apprehended under the external opposition of limit and limitlessness, of amount and innumerability, this category contains an insoluble contradiction. One then holds fast to the demand that quantity is to be determined by discrete quanta, and that these must be stated in numbers. But precisely because one is caught in the finitude of amount, one is just as immediately overcome by innumerability and infinity. Stated determinately, the contradiction runs thus:

: Number has meaning; things must be counted if they are to be grasped; but now they cannot be counted: as surely as space is infinite, so surely are the *quanta* of quantity innumerable^{*)}.

When, on the other hand, one sublates the series and makes clear to oneself the [42] constant relation between the determinate quantum and the indeterminate quantity, between amount and innumerability, then the abstract opposites will sublate one another and the contradiction will vanish. By the finite quantum's delimiting itself, the movement of quantity is reduced to a circular movement. This now completes the delimitation; for the one finite quantum leads continually over into the other quantum (a) over into quantum (b), just as being into nothing but every barrier is at the same time lifted; for the finite quantum finds itself again in its negation [quant. (b) leads again over into quant. (a)]. Quantity hereby closes itself off as absolute

^{*)}Cf. the Indian myth of Brima.

quantity. Therefore it is now no longer necessary either to step from amount to amount in order to count the innumerable. The one amount is delimited by the other; but amount is = amount; **amount is its own other**, it goes together with itself: therein lies the mediated innumerability, which consequently cannot be confused with blind indeterminability. By this circular mediation the intolerable length and breadth of quantity is sublated. The eternal fundamental relation between amount and innumerability, in which its *dissecta membra*, the sporadic quanta, are concentrated, can now be seen in one view and grasped in one speculative thought: *intensity* is the truth of quantity.

In absolute intensity, now, all immediate discretenesses must in the first place vanish: its intension is that they should all be in one another and go together into one; but by their complete vanishing intensity itself would vanish; therefore it has at the same time a decided tendency also to posit the being of the finite quanta outside one another and to give them an extension. It is this ceaseless tension between intension and extension that maintains the limit and the infinite alternation of amount and innumerability. Under extension the one finite quantum is delimited by the other; but [43] this mutual delimitation, which forms extensity, is only relative; in intensity, on the other hand, all quanta have their common absolute limit: as many sublated limits in intensity, so many posited limits in extensity. In this way amount is fixed. But since intensity has sublated all possible limits, and thus has them in itself, every possible delimitation must also be able to be posited in extensity; thereby innumerability is preserved.

Although intensity is now the true limit for all extensive quanta, it nevertheless cannot have its being outside these; for in that case it would itself be reduced to an extensive moment; everything would then thereby be absorbed into extensity, and extensity itself would have to vanish, since it cannot subsist without intensity. As a consequence of this, intensity must sustain discreteness and continuity by always positing a **discrete** moment as point of departure for the **sublation** of all the others. If, then, regard is had to a single determinate moment by itself, it lies in the nature of the matter that intensity is opposed to extensity. For the intensive strength of the single moment consists in its having all the other moments in itself. But according to extensity the moments are outside one another. It is consequently a plain absurdity that a single moment should, in one and the same sense, both have and not have the others in itself. From this standpoint one concludes rightly: **the greater the extensity, the less intensity.** The moments that in extensity have their being

outside one another are, however, the very same as those that in intensity have their
 [44] being in one another; extensity is consequently intensity's own discrete and distinct expression: **the greater the intensity, the greater the extensity**. Since intensity is now to acquiesce in a single discrete moment while it sublates the discreteness of all the other moments, and each single moment in intensity and extensity must here have the same right, it holds of them all that each of them by itself is to be posited in its discreteness by the sublation of the others. On account of this, absolute intensity must extend itself in a **series of intensive moments**. Every moment is an intensity, but only in relation to the other sublated moments. According to the mutual distinction of the moments, the sublation must take place in a different way in each single one of them. Thus the discreteness of the intensities develops. But this difference is still only quantitative. This quantitative distinction cannot be sought in the greater and lesser extent of the moments; for their immediate extension has vanished. The extensity of the single discrete moment lies solely in the sublation of the others, and is consequently its very intensity. Just as little can the amount of the sublated moments form any difference; for when any single one whatever is posited in its discreteness, all the others are thereby posited as sublated. The amount of the sublated moments is always equally large. The distinction can then arise only from the **developed relativity of the discrete intensities**.

Every intensive moment sublates an innumerability of moments, in which it itself is to be sublated innumerable times. Insofar as it has all the others in itself, it does contain the whole intensity; but since it in turn falls back, as sublated, to the intensive discreteness of the others, it is only a relative expression for absolute
 [45] intensity. Absolute intensity then posits every relative intensity as a sublated moment for another relative intensity: the more sublated intensities the relative intensity contains, the more it approaches the absolute. Hereby absolute intensity unfolds itself in a series of **lesser** and **greater** intensities.

On account of this one must distinguish between a twofold sublation of the discrete moments. a) The **general** sublation reduces discreteness to its origin. It posits the continuity and unity of intensity as the primary, the discreteness and plurality of extensity, on the other hand, as the derived and secondary. In the universal sublation the discrete quanta as such are not yet posited. But only when something is posited can it actually be sublated. Therefore there now follows b) the **specific** sublation, which presupposes certain discrete moments as already posited, in order, by their absorption into a subsequent moment, to form an actual relative intensity. The

peculiar strength of the relative intensity thus depends not on how many moments it contains according to the general sublation (for it contains all), but on how many it has in itself according to the specific sublation, that is to say, how many relative intensities it has under it. The first and weakest intensity would now have to arise by the first discrete moment's being posited through a general sublation of the others; but since the relative intensity is never formed by any merely general, but only by a specific sublation, the weakest intensity would be no intensity at all. The intensities are on account of this innumerable, the transition from the lowest to the highest is infinite; the truth of the movement lies in gradation: **the series of relative intensities rounds itself off in the circle of degrees.** Degree posits intensity [46] with its determinate relativity. Every degree is as such a quantitative something by itself. But the single degree, which has sublated other degrees in itself, is according to its determination to be delimited and sublated in turn by a higher degree: its being-for-itself refers continually to another being-for-itself. The scale of degrees thus presents us with a series of for-itself moments, which are nevertheless all for one another mutually. This being-for-itself is now quantity's own quality, and this quality the mediated relativity. The transitions and nuances of gradation are in and for themselves innumerable; but relativity as such is the abiding determinateness that constitutes what is characteristic in all possible gradations, and therefore sublates the infinite series of degrees. Gradation expresses precisely the inflexible demand that there shall be oppositions, fixed and unshakeable difference-points in the true, absolute quantity: **degree separates itself from itself in order to refer itself to itself.** Since the opposition belongs to degree's own self-determination, there must be contained in the lower degree a moment that does not let itself be sublated by the higher: there must be a something (a quale) that stabilizes the distinction between the single degrees. Under this positive specification degree has its other in itself; it lies in its determinate existence that it must change. The single degree, which is itself something by itself, is thereby at the same time a degree of something that it cannot completely express. This something then reaches out beyond the lower degree, effects its sublation, and specifies itself in a higher degree, which thereby obtains its being-for-itself. But however often the sublation is repeated, the positive something will still always place itself outside the single degrees. Therefore it also shows itself with a twofold character. It fixes in the first place the limit between degree and degree, [47] and next forms the common determinate limit for all degrees. It is this something whereby degree becomes its own other, and thereby at the same time something other

than itself. Since each degree is something by itself, change is a transition from the **one** degree to the **other**; but as every degree develops itself as a degree of the other degrees, degree is always reduced to the tautological determination of being a degree of itself. The change of degree thereby sublates itself, and gradation loses its meaning. But when degree thus determines itself as a something without gradation, it is no longer degree; as the degree-change stops, degree has absolutely changed and has become something quite other. Yet as degree loses itself in other, it gains itself; for this otherness becomes the proper basis whereby discreteness is restored, and gradation comes into its own. Each single degree now sustains its specific meaning, and the degrees become one another's mutual other, and set one another limits in relation to the qualitative other, which posits the absolute limit of all. This other, however, cannot so appear in the single degrees that it is itself specified; for thereby the degrees would be separated into nothing but qualitative differences, and discreteness would become so predominant that continuity and with it discreteness itself vanished. From this it follows that **the quality that underlies the actual gradation is not itself subject** [48] **to gradation**^{*)}. But when the specification is owed to the quantitative something, and this something, as quality, falls outside gradation, then gradation falls outside itself; for it cannot do without the moments of specification. Degree can therefore be regarded as the general negation and limit by which quality completes its own specifications, since every term in the series is determined by a degree. In this way quality comes to develop itself in a gradation; but as quality turns over into its other and becomes degree, that which was formerly posited as degree turns over into its other and becomes quality. The result of this is then this, that the change of degrees or the true gradation is at once **an alternation of degree with degree and of degree with degree-negation**.

Herein lies a contradiction that comes to clear development in **approximation**.

Approximation posits the degree of something (quantity with quality) as point of departure. But, not content with the way in which the qualitative something is expressed in a certain degree, one strives forward toward a higher degree, which is to give the quality a truer determination. One does not, however, want another something, does not want to pass over to another quale; the otherness one seeks solely in the changed degree. Approximation **is** a continued **gradation**. What occasions the gradation is solely the demand that the quality in question is to have its abiding, adequate expression. Since degree is here the only determination of quality, the given

^{*)}From this standpoint the Stoics denied degrees in virtue and crime.

quale must receive different determinations in the different degrees. By gradation, then, quality itself undergoes a specification. The qualitative something would obtain its absolute expression only when the highest degree was attained; but degree **is** quantity, the amount of degrees innumerable: the adequate determination of quality [49] is consequently never attained. If there is now a relative distinction between the qualitative something posited in a lower and in a higher degree, then there must be an infinite distinction between its determination as it can be given in relative degrees and as it was to be given in the absolute degree. In **approximation** there thus lies **the insufficiency of gradation**; the qualitative something that one strives to express in the relative degrees thereby shows itself as a qualitative other that lies outside all degrees, i.e. as an unattainable goal^{*)}. Precisely because, on the standpoint of approximation, one so immediately trusts oneself to gradation and places the qualifying otherness in degree itself, one finds oneself just as immediately compelled to regard the delimiting other as lying outside every degree. When, on the other hand, it is brought to consciousness that the other of degree is everywhere both quantitative and qualitative, and consequently lies both in and outside degree, then the goal shows itself at once as both absent and present (*quod petis hic est*): the true approximation is an infinite evolution.

Transition.

Quality develops itself as a relation between for-itself moments. The qualitative limit is fixed and immovable; it cannot be changed without quality itself being changed: [50] : quality is as such the fixated determinateness.

Quantity, on the other hand, is the self-delimitation of the limit, which has its purest being-for-itself in number. But the self-delimitation of the limit is the sublation of every determinate limit, and number reproduces itself to infinity. Quantity is the movable limit; indeterminate increase and diminution is its determinateness. Quality and quantity, then, regarded in their immediacy, are indifferent to one another and therefore cannot delimit one another.

But this indifference, which stems from their immediate, categorical distinction, sublates itself.

^{*)}Subjective idealism, which postulates immortality on account of the endless strife between reason and drive, and panlogism, which urges the infinite process of personification of spirit but denies God's absolute personality that is for itself, both find themselves in the unresolved contradiction of approximation.

For as quality becomes its own other, it finds itself again on the far side of the fixated limit; its self-delimitation is therefore its indeterminate self-expansion and self-restriction; it thereby becomes something other than itself and is determined as quantity. The fundamental movement of quantity is limit-sublation. But the limit cannot be lifted without its having first been posited: continuity requires discreteness. In the posited limit and in discreteness as such we thus find again the qualitative determinations in quantity. As quantity qualifies itself and posits its other, it becomes, as approximation showed, the negative of itself, i.e. quality. The result, then, is that quality mediates its self-delimitation through quantity, and that quantity delimits [51] itself by quality.

C. Modality.

a) Pure Modality.

§ 17.

Quantitative Quality, Qualitative Quantity, Modification.

The mutual relation of the qualitative and quantitative moments is developed in *modality*. Every quale must as such qualify itself. Its qualification is a self-movement through all relative delimitations and determinations, and as a consequence of this a quantification: the quale delimited in itself is a *quantitative quality*. The determinate quantum results from a quantifying. Quantification is a development of a determinate relation between discrete, i.e. qualitatively distinct, quanta: every actually determinate quantum must therefore be posited as *qualitative quantity*. The transition of qualification and quantification into one another is a *modification*, which introduces the determinate existence of quality and quantity.

The categories are positive expressions for hypostatized thoughts. Because thought receives its fixed shape in the category, it appears with a certain restriction and, as a consequence of this, with a determinate one-sidedness. — The consciousness of this one-sidedness calls forth contradiction, and this in turn the dialectical [52] movement; therefore dialectic always goes against the categories. In the quality-categories thought everywhere seeks its foothold in the fixed, immovable limit: being is **not** nothing, something not other, the One not the Many. But dialectic always breaks down the posited barrier and expresses the dissolution of the limit in a special

transition-category (becoming, change etc.). — The transition-categories themselves are, with respect to the class of categories in question, partly **relative**, partly absolute. The relative transition-category merely shows the insufficiency of single subordinate categories and thereby introduces the thought-determination in higher categories of the same class; the absolute transition-category, on the other hand, presents the developed class of categories in its whole one-sidedness, and thereby leads over into a system of new categories^{*)}.

As the last and highest quantity-limit is sublated, it is hereby brought to clear cognition that every posited limit is variable. Since now the variable limit as such is the criterion of quantity, it follows from this that what comes to determinate utterance in the quantity-categories is nothing other than what has already implicitly moved through the whole dialectic of quality. But as the qualitative determinations are volatilized in the quantity-categories, dialectic must again lift this one-sidedness and continually restore the vanishing limit. It was these attempts at restoration [53] that in the preceding section led to ever higher and fuller categories, and thereby at last to the cognition that the quantitative determinations had to be integrated by repeating the vanished quality. Thus: one begins with the **being**, immediately given qualities (qualia). Their immediacy is sublated as they go through their **becoming**. This becoming, in which the qualities vanish, at first takes on the character of a quantification. But since quantification is the qualities' own genesis, it must in its development show itself as the proper qualification and thus lead to qualitative results. It is this fundamental movement that determines the whole of **modality**.

Every true quality must qualify itself. As long as quality has not yet gone through its qualification, it represents itself as a being, a sensuously given, that belongs merely to representation. The whole sensuous world is in its immediacy a sum of such unqualified qualities. By reducing the world of sense to its simplest elements, one arrives at crass **atomism**^{*)}. The atoms are sensuous immediacies; since they lack qualification, they necessarily also lack quantification, and are consequently **without extension**. Thus no atom has the moment of otherness in itself either; the atom presents only the abstract something whose other is external and indifferent:

^{*)}Thus becoming is a relative transition-category; for although it sublates the qualitative limit between being and nothing, it nevertheless introduces a new qualitative limit between the something and other of determinate existence. Only when the qualitative limit has reached its highest determinateness as exclusive limit, and exclusion in its absolute carrying-through has shown itself as assimilation, is every immediate quality-limit to be regarded as sublated.

^{*)}Even the Herbartian Realia are unqualified qualities.

distinction follows upon distinction without any transition. The medium in which the atoms are found is therefore also an external medium (space, the void), and the power that connects and separates them an external, incomprehensible power. This, [54] then, is the logical contradiction of the sensuous atoms, that they are to have a being without becoming, a determinate being without inner change, a being-for-itself without mutual exclusion and assimilation.

Pure being represents itself first as given quality, as **being** being; nothing can likewise present itself as **being** nothing. But as being results from nothing, it thereby posits nothing as a limit that it itself sublates, while nothing, in the reverse direction, takes itself back through the sublated limit of being. Both **qualify** and **extend** themselves as they **become**, each in its own **manner**: the quality of modality is a **quantitative quality**.

Modal being is posited as the primal quality that by its qualification produces all being determinations. But in the mere process of qualification everything fixed becomes fluid and vanishing, and being becomes the intensive magnitude that extends itself **without measure or manner**. Abstract qualification is a mere quantification; it is seen here as a coming-to-be that can never come to be anything, a restless change that never leads to being-for-itself, a unity without plurality, and is consequently a one-sided abstraction. Since abstract quantification never brings it to fixed quantitative determinateness, it can never constitute determinate quanta either. The quality-moments, which come and go to infinity, are innumerable, and to the primal quality itself, which is absorbed into the pure process of quantification, number cannot be applied at all. Quantification must therefore be posited as a moment for qualification, and this in turn lead to determinate qualities. As beginning-moment the primal quality or general quality must be the most abstract; the further, on the other hand, [55] qualification is continued, the more concrete become the qualities resulting from it. It is by these groups of more universal and more special qualities^{*)} (genera and species) that quantity properly comes into its own and becomes a moment in determinate existence. For just as the determination of quantity perishes when all qualities vanish in the general quality, so would it also lose its meaning if the determination of quality were driven to its extreme point and speciality held fast by itself. Only by the more special qualities being reduced to a more universal quality does a **qualitative** number-unit come about, and, as the universal quality again points to its specifications, a

^{*)}We use “quality” here in the widest sense. The distinction between the qualities as independent existences and as non-independent moments can only be brought out later.

qualified amount. By, e.g., reducing 4 tables and 3 chairs to the common quality “furniture”, a qualitative unity is obtained with which numeration can begin. But if one now stays with the more universal determination, then furniture = furniture; only by bringing out the specification is the **one** piece of furniture seen in its distinction from the **other**, and one can now count (determine the **amount** of) the **separate** pieces of furniture. Modal **quantity** is always **qualitative**. The transition of qualification and quantification into one another (*quod modum efficit*) can now be determined more closely as **modification**.

In modality something and other are each to be posited as **qualified** qualities. These qualities now subsist with relative independence in a system of qualitative moments. The determination for the qualitative something is always this, that it must go under in other; other is its **absolute** limit; where other begins, something must [56] cease. But in order that something can go under, it must first arise. It does not arise at one stroke; quality must qualify itself; it has its being in its becoming. Therefore the two moments that in abstract becoming immediately went together into one are now also each separated out and specified in modality: modal becoming is modified by a determinate opposition between **arising** and **passing away**.

As something begins its qualification, it posits its first qualitative moment, a moment in which it can be said both to be and not to be. Qualification therefore advances successively, as it continually posits new quality-moments and preserves those already posited. But the quality that results from this is as such restricted; it is a something that is delimited on all sides by other. In order to form the full delimitation of something, other must therefore both go before and follow after. The preceding other is something by itself, the subsequent likewise; the movement is this, that just as something arises by a negation of the antecedent other, so the following other emerges in turn from the negated something. But this opposition, which thus enters into otherness itself, is here to be seen merely as a moment for the determinate existence of the intermediate something. During its arising something must continually change. The change consists in its excluding the presupposed other by assimilating its otherness and making itself its own other. In this modification of change something thus has its subsistence, its **abiding**^{*)}. Something abides by its becoming (qualification) being posited as a moment for its being (quality). But in the [57] assimilation of other, something has taken its own nothing up into itself. The moments of otherness came from other when this was to pass over to something, but now it is

^{*)}“Blive” expresses both *manere* and *fieri*.

again the determination of something to pass over into other; the otherness-moments by whose assimilation it has reached its subsistence therefore develop into what they actually are, namely the negation of something itself. Something subsists in a nothing that in turn develops into positive being in the qualification of the subsequent other^{*)}. The subsistence of something thus introduces its passing away; with this modification the change of something is an **annihilation**. But if something now passed away in the same instant as it arose, there would be neither coming-to-be nor annihilation: each of the modifications of change must have its extension. In order to sustain its modal oppositions, qualification modifies itself into quantification.

[58] As something, during qualification, posits and sublates its relative limits in order to reach the absolute limit, it posits itself as a determinate **continuum**, and when the absolute limit is overstepped, other begins its continuation. While discreteness, then, during the whole coming-to-be is absorbed into the qualified continuity, discreteness on the other hand predominates in the limit itself between something and other, and thereby qualifies itself in discrete continua. The quality-unity of something is thus to be determined as an **intensive** magnitude that **extends** itself in the system of the qualitative moments. In this way quality and quantity both come each into its own. Quality requires its fixed, determinate limit; this it now obtains by transferring the variable onto quantity. But quantity varies only as long as the qualification in question lasts. By the restriction of quality, quantity obtains its fixed, immovable limit, indeed even becomes, as that which comprises all the qualitative moments of the particular quality, the only determinate expression for quality in its wholeness: where the absolute limit of quality lies can be decided only by quantity. What is constant in quality designates what is changeable in quantity; but the constant limit of quantity expresses the whole quality's own change. Thus modification leads to

b) Measure.

§ 18.

The Immediate Measure, the Qualified Measure, the Modification of Measure.

^{*)}The fundamental thought that something becomes its own other through something other than itself is of pervasive influence on the philosophical cognition of the world. Atomism, which acquiesces in the view that something has other outside itself, leads to materialism; for it belongs to spirit to become its own other to itself: the Orientals, who let the primal quality be its own other to itself without properly positing anything other than itself, are pantheists. Fichtean idealism does cognize that the I is to assimilate its otherness to itself through its other; but since this other is not qualified in itself, it remains standing as an immediate barrier. Christianity cognizes God in his personality; for here he is his own other (the Son) through an other qualified in itself (the world).

The qualified quality expresses its determinate existence by the determinately existent quantity, and is thus determined in *measure*. For quality in its mere determinate being, the quantitative determination is superficial, i.e. an *immediate* measure. Where, on the other hand, the being of quality is posited in unity with its coming-to-be, quantification develops itself out of qualification itself, and measure is qualified. The *qualified*, immanent measure of quality is determined by a relation to the immanent measures of other qualities; by this relation measure itself is infinitely *modified*. Qualification must lead to quality, as becoming to determinate being, and immediacy with the determinate limit is restored. Thereby the determinate quantum now also results from quantification. Quality has thus become quantum; they have their determinate existence in and with one another. But in the same way as something has quantified itself and in its determinate being shows itself as magnitude, other has also obtained its quantification and **is** likewise a magnitude. Both are then quantitative qualities and in this respect completely equal to one another. But when all opposition between something and other is sublated, determinate being itself vanishes in pure being. It is now a matter, then, of finding a new and higher distinction between something and other, that is to say, of determining the limit between the qualitative magnitudes mutually. [59]

The **qualitative** limit showed itself (§ 14, p. 26) as the exclusive negation; but since the bordering qualities were immediate and as a consequence of this without extension, they themselves were reduced to mere limit-moments. Quality was therefore absorbed into the self-movement of the limit, developed itself as **quantitative** limit (p. 27), and thereby produced an extension that sublated all delimitation. [60]

The **modal** limit, on the other hand, is fixed and determinate like the qualitative, for it separates **something** from **other**; but something and other are **magnitudes**; the modal limit is therefore movable like the quantitative, for it gathers in its determinateness the relative limit-moments of the magnitudes. The modal limit thus has two sides, whose mutual relation is developed in **measure**.

Since both main sides of measure are each by itself modal, they both contain the immediate unity of the constant limit of quality and the variable limit of quantity, but in opposite ways. For while the one side contains the movable limit as a moment sublated in the constant one, and is thereby posited as a quality with **determinate** extension, the other, on the contrary, lets every constant limit-moment vanish in the varying limit, and shows itself as a continuum with **indeterminate** extension. Extension is then the characteristic common to both sides; this is precisely what

is superficial in the **immediate measure**, that all quality-determinations are here absorbed into mere extension.

But quality continually takes itself back through the quantitative moments. The specific development of determination arises from the constant and the variable limit being united in each of the sides: thus they can be **measured** against one another. In measuring, the determinate continuum is posited as **measuring-rod**. The measuring-rod is a quantity that represents itself in representation; **how large** it is must be immediately intuited: its extension, i.e. its specific quantity, is the proper [61] determinateness of the quality. The constant limit that is posited in and with the continuum of the measuring-rod now becomes the means whereby the indeterminate continuum, i.e. that which is measured, is reduced to determinate limits. The measured magnitude thus develops both its moments: in and for itself it has a variable limit that not only makes possible but even requires constant limit-determinations; this last demand is satisfied by the application of the measuring-rod. But the determinate continuum of the measuring-rod, which has the variable limit in itself, now also requires that the hidden moment of changeableness be developed and determined. With its immediate determinateness the measuring-rod can be extended and restricted at will; but in relation to the measured magnitude what is arbitrary in its extension becomes delimited. The measuring-rod is a given unity that finds its amount in the measured magnitude.

Since the immediate measure merely expresses the superficial relation of the quantities, it follows from this that every deeper distinction must be excluded, and the quality-peculiarity that qualifies the magnitudes to be measured against one another must be immediately given^{*)}.

But modal determinate being develops itself as an abiding (§ 17), in which the becoming of qualification continually alternates with the being of quality. Since quality **is** as it **becomes**, it must be quantitatively determined as an **intensive** magnitude that extends itself in a series of intensive moments (§ 16. p. 44). But **something**, the determinate quality, arises and abides only by assimilation and exclusion of **other** (§ [62] 17. p. 56). The quality coming to be can therefore only be determined i.e. **measured** by another intensive quality, which is likewise qualified by its extension.

As now the one of these qualities is posited as indeterminate magnitude, whose involuntary increase and diminution is merely indicated by an immediate measuring-rod, the other, on the contrary, will maintain its qualitative peculiarity by assimilating

^{*)}Therefore line is immediately measured with line, surface with surface.

to itself the variable magnitude in a peculiar way in different quantities. (Thus, e.g., water takes up a different quantity of heat).

The assimilating quality has a delimited being-for-itself, and, as a consequence of this, likewise only a delimited assimilation of its variable quantum, which here plays the role of otherness. (Water as water takes up only a **certain** quantity of heat). It is now this assimilation that in its whole relativity and delimitation receives its development in the **qualified measure**.

Quality as such must be given with a determinateness that is, consequently also with a certain assimilation of its other, i.e. of the variable magnitude. (Water at the very thawing-point has a **determinate** heat). Since now a qualifying becoming must go before every qualitative being, one can only seize and hold fast the constant quality in positive unity with the variable magnitude by a leap that belongs to immediacy as such. (At the zero point of the thermometer one can, e.g., have both water and ice). But since the quality that is must **become** just as much as **be**, it reduces its relative being to a vanishing **state**, and documents its qualitative movement by letting the variable states succeed one another.

Everything thus depends on the dialectical relation between the constant quality and its changeable state. In pure immediacy quality is held fast by itself and the varying states by themselves. Therefore one cannot comprehend either how quality preserves unchanged likeness with itself although it continually takes up different quanta of the variable magnitude; still less does one see why quality, after it has shown itself indifferent toward a series of varying states, is at last altered at one stroke by a mere increase of quantity. [63]

These contradictions are lifted by consideration of the qualification of measure itself: a) Since the constant quality as such has a certain quantum of the variable magnitude in itself, it lies herein that its quantitative variety expresses precisely the quality's own determinateness, and that this, as a consequence, cannot be indifferent toward any state whatsoever. It is only through the **changes** that quality can develop its **constant** character; these therefore belong to its own qualification. When it is therefore said that the same quality sustains itself in all alternating states, the truth is this, that quality first expresses itself completely in all the states that are posited and sublated.

b) Since now, accordingly, no single state satisfies quality, it would never obtain its adequate expression if the moments of a lower state could not be preserved in a higher. But it is here that gradation develops in its full meaning. The external,

immediately determined quantity of the changeable magnitude is, in every given state, assimilated into peculiar unity with quality. Quality therefore has magnitude in itself as determinate intensive magnitude, that is, by an even distribution of the [64] intensity-moments that are to characterize the single states, as degree. Degree is here posited in and by a quality; therefore there is here a **lowest** and a **highest** degree. In the lowest degree the quantity of the variable magnitude is sublated as a moment for the state in which quality begins its determinate being; in the highest, on the other hand, quality appears absolutely identified with the state itself. (At the 100th degree (C) water has assimilated to itself all the heat that, according to its peculiar quality, it is able to take up). c) As long, now, as the relative intensity does not express quality's completed act of assimilation, so long can quality overstep every quantity-limit and change its state without itself being changed; when, on the other hand, assimilation has reached its limit, and the adequate state sets in in which the quality developed through the quantitative changes acquiesces, then it lies in the nature of the matter that this state cannot be changed by a raised degree without quality being altered with it. The surprising change of quality is thus introduced by the change of quantity. Hereby the constant quality is grasped as the immanent measure of the changeable magnitude.

In the measure thus qualified we then have: α) a quantity-unity positively determined by quality (from 0° to 100° (C.) an equal quantum of heat is always contained, if other circumstances do not act on the water); β) an amount determined by this unity, which is posited and immediately observed as the variable magnitude in the quality goes through its gradations; and finally γ) a true identity of unity and amount (the heat [65] of water at the 100th degree contains 100 degrees of heat). The immanent measure develops itself through innumerable gradations (between freezing point and thawing point there lie not merely 80 or 100 degrees, but, according to infinite divisibility, cf. p. 30, an arbitrary quantity); as a consequence of this every number-determination is sublated. But where number has vanished, the specific limit of measure is erased; if the gradations of the qualified measure are to be determined, then the marks of the degrees must be set off arbitrarily, and gradation be immediately observed by them.

But when the qualified measure thus depends on the immediate measuring-rod, it is thereby absorbed into unqualified determinations and itself becomes immediate. This immediacy has a twofold side: partly, namely, it lies in the arbitrary division of the measuring-rod, partly in the constant quality's own limits, as this by its alteration immediately indicates when the variable magnitude in it has overstepped its measure.

The variable magnitude itself, on the other hand, is not altered (heat continues to be heat after the water has become steam), but seeks within the limits of another constant quality another immanent measure etc. Hereby the qualified measure develops itself in a series of immanent measures, and thus becomes external to itself. From this externality there now arise the specifications of measure itself. Since the variable magnitude is determined by the totality of the constant qualities in which it finds its immanent measures, its quantum is hereby specified; but the constant qualities too are quantitatively specified, for their qualitative peculiarity is determined solely by the particular quantity that each of them takes up of the variable magnitude. If these quantities are now compared with one another mutually, then measure is reduced to constant ratios. The varying immediacy of quantity is hereby sublated, [66] and the immediate measuring-rod, whose arbitrary division now no longer has any influence on the determination of the constant ratios themselves, is reduced to an external means whereby the immanent measure measures itself. (For measuring the temperature it is indifferent whether the thermometer is divided into 80° or into 100°).

Reduced to the constant ratio, the immanent measure has its specific expression in the exponent of the ratio. Every immediate quality is as such one-sided; it seeks its negation and determination in an opposed quality, as this one does in that; both are then to be regarded as each other's sides, and the complete quality as the unity of both. The developed quality is always a double-quality, which in unity with itself exposes the ratio between two qualitative sides. But as the qualitative sides determine one another mutually and negate one another, qualitative immediacy vanishes in their mutual relation; the one is thus taken up into the other, the one is contained in the other, the increase of the one entails, if the ratio is to subsist, an increase of the other: their mutual determination is altogether quantitative. Since the ratio, as the exponent shows, can remain the same provided only that the increase or diminution is undertaken in a corresponding manner with both sides ($1:2 = 2:4$), quantity has obtained in the exponent a fixed, specific character, mediated through the quantitatively variable sides. This specifically determined quantity expresses precisely the explicated quality, as the equilibrium of the quantitative sides expresses their qualitative determinateness. Thus the complete development of the immanent measure is to be sought in the exponent, But in the system of immanent measures [67] developed above this exposition is not yet carried through. It is indeed evident that the specific quality everywhere conditions the specification of quantity and conversely; but these specifications are not yet deduced from one another. The variable magnitude,

which can be regarded as the common side of the constant qualities, as the general quality running through them all, is taken as it is immediately found. Since no increase or diminution ever brings it to give up the peculiarity of its quality, the whole alteration that it produces in the constant sides in which it finds its measure is also a mere modification. The constant qualities therefore retain the whole stamp of immediacy, from which it then also follows that the exponents likewise show themselves as immediate number-determinations.

If specific qualification is to be absorbed into specific quantification, the qualities must forfeit their immediacy in quantity, in order to realize the true quality in the quantitative ratio. Every immediate quale must then show itself as it is, namely as the neutrum that is neither itself nor its other, but waits for another neutrum that will make it its other, while it itself makes itself an other for this one. This qualification is represented in chemical neutralization, where the exponent can be said to be the developed quality itself.

Let A and B be the qualitative sides (substances) from whose union the qualitative exponent (the body) E results; their immediate qualities are then no longer to be sought in E, for in that case E would merely be a composition of A and B, but no quality by itself; but as the immediate qualities are negated and sublated in quantity, [68] their quantity itself, on the other hand, is preserved: in quantitative respect is $E = A + B$.

Here the mutual specification of quality and quantity now shows itself most clearly of all. Which quality-determinations lie in A and B can be known only from the quantitative ratio under which they combine with one another; but on the other hand one cannot determine this ratio either, except precisely by testing the qualitative peculiarity of both and asking them themselves under which quantitative conditions they will unite. From this it is explained: α) that A and B must always unite in a certain ratio in order to produce a certain qualitative exponent; β) that from the nature of such a ratio one cannot immediately conclude that it is the only one; for since in its exponent it expresses only one determinate quality, both sides may, under a new ratio-exponent, present new quality-moments; finally A and B may each by itself be sides for several other immediate qualities: A can, e.g., unite with C, D etc.

The relation between the sides themselves and their exponents is now this, that the former are absorbed as moments into quantitative ratios, while the latter, on the contrary, represent the qualitative being-for-itself. In the series: E (A + B), E' (A + C), E'' (B + C), E''' (C + D) A can be determined altogether quantitatively; it thereby shows

itself as the variable magnitude that finds its immanent measures in the constant qualities B and C. If, on the other hand, A and B are regarded as constant qualities, then C represents the variable magnitude; the same holds of B, which as common quality for A and C likewise takes on a quantitative character and is taken up by these in different quantities. The exponents E, E', E'', on the other hand, exclude one another as for-itself qualities, and thereby express the specific ratio of the quantitative sides. [69]

Yet even this opposition between the exponents and their sides must, when it is further developed, sublate itself. The exponents, which by negation of the quality of the sides have gone through their qualification, themselves take on the stamp of immediacy, and can thus again become sides for exponents of higher order. ($E + E''' = E''''$), and since every immediate quality as such presupposes a qualification (p. 53), the subordinate sides are themselves to be regarded as exponents. Insofar now as all exponents are reduced to sides, all quality-determinations are sublated in quantity; insofar, on the other hand, as all sides are posited as exponents, qualitative being-for-itself takes itself back at all points.

The tension that hereby sets in between quality and quantity is lifted in **affinity**.

According to affinity the qualities cannot unite indiscriminately, but must be disposed toward one another; their mutual assimilation entails an exclusion, whereby the quality-moment as such asserts itself. The greater or lesser disposition of the qualities toward one another does not here stand primarily in relation to the quantum of the sides; rather, the union itself is a neutralization that grants quality its right. Since all qualities are to be regarded as results of the qualifications of the primal quality (p. 54), they are all mutually related; but since specification necessarily belongs to the forming of the exclusive limit-determinations of quality, their kinship is not equally great. **Affinity has its degrees.**

As a moment in the system of qualities no qualitative side can be considered in isolation. Every new union is a dissolution of previously contracted unions. By the neutralization of A and B an immanent measure is constituted. But A's union with B presupposes its separation from C; with C, A also forms an immanent measure; this must then be dissolved in order that the former can be realized. The **elective combinations**^{*)} thus present the most complete evolution of the qualified measure. The immanent measures, whose totality expresses the whole self-development of [70]

^{*)}That the categories of affinity and elective combination hold not only in chemistry but also in psychology, Goethe has shown in "die Wahlverwandschaften".

measure, are not here compared with one another in a merely external way; rather, the one presupposes the other and proceeds from the other; the coming-to-be of the one is the annihilation of the other: the immanent measures thereby modify and negate one another mutually, and measure is sublated.

c) Absolute Modality.

§ 19.

Indifference, Difference, Pregnant Being.

The highest distinction and unity of unity and distinction to which being as such can bring it is posited with the immanent measure, whose self-development closes itself off in absolute modality. As the total unity of the distinct moments, the immanent measure preserves all distinctions in its unity, so that the separation of unity and distinction is quite indifferent: modality is determined as the indifference [71] of being. But the moments of measure are themselves immanent measures, each of which concentrates all being-determinations in itself; in this way the union of unity and distinction is indifferent, and being is absorbed into infinite *difference*. Since the whole being-unity is in every distinction, distinction and unity are everywhere determined in the selfsame way; herewith all being-determinations vanish in *pregnant* being. It is the task of philosophy to cognize the true unity in the true distinction. The unity that has distinction outside itself is itself distinct from its distinction and thereby reduced to a distinction-moment. In the same way the distinction that has unity outside itself also goes into one with itself, and thereby constitutes a side of unity. The true unity must unite both sides of unity in itself, i.e. be posited as a unity of distinction and unity. But the unity that negates and excludes distinction is, as it appears as a distinction-moment, precisely thereby distinct from itself: it is, in its separation from distinction, in itself distinction. Likewise the abstract distinction that negates the immediate unity, in order to be absorbed as a unity-moment into the developed unity, is distinct from itself. The separation of unity and distinction is thus no longer immediate, but results from the self-development of both. While the higher unity, through the immediate and thereby subordinate distinction-moments, goes together with itself and predominates, distinction takes itself back from the developed unity-moments as a higher distinction co-ordinated with the concrete unity. But [72] when the developed distinction is co-ordinated with the developed unity, the latter

can no longer predominate; it is then reduced to a distinction-moment for a higher distinction between unity and distinction.

This ascending development forms a dialectical scale, which marks off its determinate steps in categorical immediacy. As long, then, as a logical sphere has specific categories for a higher unity, it is not yet dialectically exhausted; when, on the other hand, the category is developed that expresses all the specific determinations of the sphere in highest unity, the determinations themselves also appear in their highest distinction; if it then turns out that unity, when it is held fast, loses itself in distinction, and that distinction, when it is sustained, vanishes in unity, then there is neither distinction nor unity; the categories are then insufficient, and the sphere in question is sublated.

The unity and distinction of being, with the specific transitions of both into one another, are considered from the standpoint of quality, of quantity and of modality.

The immediate qualitative unity in its most abstract shape is **pure being** itself; but as it reduces all distinctions to non-being and makes them **nothing**, it is itself reduced to an immediate distinction-moment, namely a being distinct from nothing. It is this immediate distinction that in **becoming** yearns for a higher unity, since each of its sides shows itself distinct from itself. **Determinate being** is now the more concrete unity that has overcome the empty nothing, and cannot be reduced to a distinction-moment by pure negation; it is no immediate combination of being and nothing, but a union of being and being mediated through negation. But as being in determinate being is to be determined by being, it must separate itself from itself, and distinction enters anew in **something** and **other**. This distinction is higher than the [73] distinction between being and non-being; for both distinction-moments have, each by itself, a determinate being. Hereby determinate being itself has become a distinction-moment, and unity is broken. For the distinction lies not merely in a separation of something and other from one another, but is at the same time a distinction between determinate being as such, regarded from the standpoint of unity, and determinate being in something and other, determined by its own distinction-moments, thus: a distinction between unity and distinction. Insofar as determinate being is given up on all sides to distinction, it exhausts itself in **change**.

As the change of change there results the predominating unity of quality, namely being-for-itself, which lets something and other go into one. But as the One negates all other outside itself, it thereby comes outside itself; the One is broken asunder into the Many, and distinction again displaces unity in the reciprocal exclusion of the ones.

Since, however, reciprocal exclusion develops through absolute exclusion into an assimilation, in which the separated Many flow together again into one, distinction cannot sustain its preponderance either. A restful equilibrium that is, between unity and distinction, quality can never bring about; for if unity is held fast, everything goes into one, and distinction vanishes; if, on the other hand, one vindicates distinction, then in the Many it is all over with unity. Here, then, there is only an alternation of unity and distinction, a restless yearning for equilibrium; but equilibrium itself must be sought in **quantity**.

The category that stands on the limit of quality and quantity, of distinction and unity, is the **limit** itself. In the qualitative limit unity is negative, distinction positive; here, then, there is specific distinction between unity and distinction: the quantitative [74] limit, on the other hand, which, as it makes the bordering into limit and the limit into the bordering, and in the movement of continuity has the resting points of discreteness, posits unity (continuity) just as positively as distinction (discreteness); in the quantitative limit there is therefore unity of unity and distinction. **Limitation**, which shows the omnipresent limit, now contains the task of everywhere finding and positing the distinction of unity (every continuum is as such discrete), the distinction of distinction (every discretum is as such continuum and thereby discreteness in itself) and the unity of distinction. This distinction and unity of unity and distinction is given in **number**. The one of the number-unit differs from the qualitative One precisely in this, that the latter negates and excludes plurality, while the former, on the contrary, vindicates its unity by the discreteness of plurality. The plurality discrete in itself preserves its distinction from unity by the units of **amount** being specifically ordered; since every numbered unit is assigned its place, quantitative plurality cannot, like the qualitative, be dissolved again into a single standing One. But the distinction of discreteness does not interrupt the unity of continuity either, for each of the ones of amount is itself a unity for a new amount. From **innumerability**, the infinity of the number-unit dissolved into an infinite amount, there develops the predominating unity for which the distinction of number-discreteness is posited as a sublated moment. This elastic unity, pregnant with all specific distinction-moments, is **intensity**, which in **degree** posits the whole developed distinction by positing itself. Unity is here its own distinction, and thereby comes to predominate, but each distinction-moment has the whole unity in itself, and is thus itself its unity; this then [75] points to the preponderance of distinction. The predominating distinction is now no longer a distinction between quantity and quantity, for every such distinction

is already exhausted, but rather an exclusive distinction between quantity and non-quantity, in which the qualitative is taken up again. That quantity is not by this exclusion reduced to an immediate qualitative moment, whereby dialectic would sink back onto the overcome standpoint of quality, is prevented in **approximation**, whose true development is an **evolution**. According to approximation the exclusive quality-moment is introduced by the pliant, assimilating quantity itself, and according to evolution the whole quantitative gradation is itself an expression for the specific positions of quality.

The distinction between the qualitative and the quantitative moment that hereby sets in lies solely in the **manner** in which being is determined in each of them. **Modality** yields the higher unity. For quantity does not come in from outside as an arbitrary auxiliary determination for quality, but is quality itself, determined in another manner. Likewise it follows from the dialectic of quantity itself that it must determine itself in a manner that is precisely opposed to the quantity-determinations as such. Since now the qualitative manner of determination is thus opposed to the quantitative, and “everything depends on the manner”, the all-sided distinction is realized as a distinction between two classes of being-determinations. Hereby the unity of modality is dissolved into two modal sides, **quantitative quality** and **qualitative quantity**, each of which by itself is the whole modality. But as each of the sides separates itself from itself, the modality of quality is itself that of quantity, and unity is striven for in **modification**. Modification expresses precisely the fleeting distinction in the preponderant unity. Quality and quantity are both sides of the [76] **same** being: the specific quantity-categories must in their full extent be integrated by corresponding categories of quantity. The indissoluble and specific unity of both classes of categories is posited at one stroke in **measure**. But the unity of measure too determines itself to distinction: both sides in the immanent measure are, each by itself, themselves immanent measures. In these immediate and infinite series of measures the one measure is separated from the other by each of the sides, when it is regarded as measure, being posited as unity for sublated distinction-moments, while conversely every measure, insofar as it is itself a side, yields a distinction-moment for a still higher unity. In this way the immanent measure everywhere comes outside itself. a) The highest immanent measure would be that in which all others were sublated as negated sides; but it lies in the dialectic of every measure itself to be posited as side. b) The highest measure should, as that in which all other measures are posited, be the most concrete of all; but every measure is, as the negation of the sides, a pure

being, which in its sheer immediacy presents only itself: every immanent measure is therefore, as such, equally abstract and equally concrete. The distinction of the absolute measure from the relative ones therefore seems to have to be reduced to the modal genesis whereby the one measure becomes from the other. c) The highest measure would then be that from which all the others would have to be deduced. But the highest measure is, as negation and sublation of all lower ones, precisely itself deduced from these.

The absolute measure is hereby determined as the modal intensity that, under a gradual approximation, seeks its adequate expression in the relative measures without, [77] however, ever finding itself in them: **the highest measure is unattainable**.

As that whose determinations can never be exhausted in any finite, attainable measure whatsoever, the unattainable measure separates itself from all relative ones, and is thereby itself posited as a distinction-moment. But separated from relativity, determined solely by its negation, it is in its being-for-itself itself relative. Its inflexible determination is to specify its content in the relative measures, just as these too, each by itself, always express the absolute in a certain degree.

The becoming in which the absolute measure continually passes over into the relative, and this into that, is **measure's** own infinite **modification**; by this it strives through all its distinction-moments toward its highest unity. Since every special and relative manifestation of the absolute measure is only a modification of the same, and the distinction of modification only a fleeting distinction, the infinite series of modification must end in **absolute modality**.

Measure in its highest unity gives itself its own sides; indeed, measure is itself its own side, and the sides, each by itself, measure itself. In absolute modality every distinction has thus vanished. All the distinction-moments that were held back by pure being, repressed in non-being, have now gradually come forth from their nothing as passing being-determinations, but have thereby at the same time shown themselves in their true nothingness, forfeited their meaning in the dialectical process, and thus betrayed their indifference. The unity that now presents all distinctions in this their mutual indifference, and by its indifference toward them all shows itself indifferent [78] toward itself, can only be determined as **absolute indifference**. Every being-unity is always posited as the indifference of the sublated distinction-moments; but such an indifference is still relative as long as it can itself become a distinction-moment. Thus in the moment of pure being, being is posited as the indifference of the distinctions, but distinction was latent in nothing; determinate being therefore became the indifference

of being and nothing, and being-for-itself in turn sublated something and other in the indifference of the One. The whole dialectic of being can be regarded as a successive reducing to higher and higher indifferences. Absolute indifference is the **all** of being; for all being-determinations culminate in it; but the being of the determinations in indifference is precisely their non-being; indifference is the negative unity in which all distinctions sublate one another; as such, indifference is the **zero** of all-being. The zero is the standing-still nothing^{*)}, which by the indifferentiating of distinction is torn out of the stream of dialectic. Since absolute indifference is indifferent toward all distinction, it is consequently also indifferent toward the distinction that there is between the highest unity and its sublated distinction-moments, and thus indifferent toward itself: **indifference is the logical readiness of being for all.**

The immanent measure is the neutrality of the sides; none of the sides (*momen-torium neutrum*) is preserved as such in the neutralization; the being of measure is the non-being of the sides. As indifference, as the immanent measure, now itself constitutes its own sides, it thereby sets itself aside: **the being of indifference** is eo ipso **its non-being**. In order rightly to show its indifference toward itself, the indifferent unity determines itself to distinction, and being opens itself up in **infinite difference**. Herewith it is then given that being concentrates all its determinations in [79] any single determination whatsoever. The whole being is itself pure being, the whole being is a nothing, a something, an other, quantity and measure; **the whole being is all and zero.**

Every difference of being is consequently itself the whole being-unity. With absolute difference the unity of distinction and unity is predominant insofar as every difference becomes its own unity. But as each single difference in its unity with itself is an indifference of all the other differences, and reduces their distinction-moments to the nullity of indifference, it must itself vanish as an indifferent moment in every other difference, and thus differs from itself. The indifference of difference consists precisely in this, that all differences are equally valid. While being, then, in absolute differentiating, places the unity of its totality in every difference, it at the same time reduces every difference to indifference, posits all distinction-moments as vanishing, the unity of indifference, on the other hand, as the abiding; there then sets in once more a distinction between (the indifferent) distinction and (the abiding) unity. But since absolute indifference is indifferent toward itself, and is thereby absorbed into

^{*)}See Kant's Versuch den Begriff der negativen Grössen in die Weltweisheit einzuführen. Werke (G. Hartenstein) Erster Band p. 21.

infinite difference, the distinction between unity and distinction is just as indifferent as the unity of distinction and unity.

The result of this is that being cannot be without giving itself a determination, and that the being-determinations continually negate one another. Unity displaces distinction, and distinction absorbs unity: the one determination cannot be at rest for the other. Even the unrest in which all-being hereby finds itself cannot even be
 [80] expressed in any becoming whatsoever; for becoming presupposes a long-vanished distinction between being and non-being. Being is as it is not, and is not as it is: **all-being is pregnant.**

According to this pregnancy every being-determination always means at the same time the opposite of what it states. Herein lies the highest criterion for dialectic's having exhausted and used up all the determinations of being. Absolute being will, in the successive negation of all distinction-moments, go together into unity with itself; but by the very negation of all being-moments it is itself infinitely negated and reduced to non-being. But non-being **is**, and is even all-being, since it is all-being itself that has posited itself in the moment of non-being. In its affirmation, then, being is negated, and in its negation at the same time affirmed. Every specific determination that is now to express this being affirmed in its negation can then no longer be held fast from the side of being alone, for thereby it would again be negated and pass over into non-being; just as little can it be posited as the pure negation of being, for every non-being is sublated again in being. Every true determination must therefore be posited at once in the moment of being and of non-being, and categorically express the pregnancy of negation and affirmation. But in the sphere of being this pregnancy is an indifference different in itself and a difference indifferent in itself; here, then, are not the higher determinations themselves, but only the dialectical birth-pangs
 [81] under which the tried being is reborn in new categories.

Chapter Two.

Essence.

Introduction.

§ 20.

The Essential, the Unessential, Relativity.

Pregnant being is being and non-being in the unity and distinction of both. In positing its non-being as a moment for an affirmative, determinate being, and showing itself as *the essential*, it must at the same time posit being as a moment vanished in non-being, and is thereby determined as *the unessential*. Thus a distinction that simply is gets maintained in pregnant being (the standpoint of criticism). But all being is absorbed in becoming. Insofar as non-being is itself being, the unessential can continually be raised from its immediacy to the essential (the standpoint of ingenuity); insofar as all being, on the other hand, is itself non-being, the essential constantly perishes in the unessential (the standpoint of skepticism). The truth of the essential and the unessential lies in the infinite *relativity* of both, which sublates the fluctuation of the standpoints, deduces the one central movement from the other, and thus reduces [82] the dialectical development to essentially distinct spheres.

Pregnant being is a double being in a unity of being. This being, doubled within itself, is however, by virtue of the characteristic pregnancy of the unity, no longer to be regarded as a being limited by non-being, for such a qualitative limit would sublate the being of both in each other. We therefore do not have here merely a being which, with non-being as its limit, becomes “something”, while non-being, limited by being, becomes an “other”, but a being in which being is, in **unity** with a being in which non-being is, and in which being therefore is not. It is precisely this **being-in-itself** of the reduplicated being itself that distinguishes the self-doubling of pregnant being

from determinate being.

Every category of being expresses as such only pure abstract immediacy, an immediacy that is in turn sublated by the individual negation. In the categories “something”, “the One”, “the immanent measure”, being is indeed presented with richer and richer determinations, but in each of these it is nevertheless always found over against another being, in which it must in turn vanish. What is characteristic in the determination can therefore everywhere be reduced to: **an immediate immediacy, limited by an immediate negation.**

The dialectical progress in being takes place in that the corresponding nothing (non-being) becomes more concrete as the content of being is more and more developed, but the mutual relation of both is constantly dissolved in an alternation that continually prevents being from coming to itself. If being in a category is held [83] fast with positive immediacy (as “something”, “the One”, “measure”), then precisely the being by which it was to integrate its determination is posited as immediate non-being; there is thus in being itself no non-being, and in non-being no being at all. Since there is no categorical preservation of immediacy in negation or of negation in immediacy, immediacy can as little as negation obtain any true being-in-itself. Pregnant being, by contrast, which posits a categorical unity of being and non-being, seeks its higher specific determinations in a **pregnant immediacy with a pregnant negation.**

If the pregnancy of immediacy and of negation is developed, then the opposition between the essential and the **unessential** sets in.

Being in its abstract immediacy is determined as pure, distinctionless being, i.e. as being without all negation. But this immediate immediacy has nonetheless been won through a negation, for only by negating the distinctions does one arrive at pure being. If this is now held fast in immediate equality with itself, it gets nothing as its limit, is thereby negated and thus comes **outside** itself. If it is to remain in itself and affirm itself as constant being, then it must indeed open itself to negation and concede to the distinction-moments their being, but instead of letting this being of the distinctions determine itself as its own non-being, it must conversely posit their non-being as its being; only thus does it negate the negation, reduplicate its immediacy and come forth as a being in being, i.e. as an **essential** being.

But since non-being has had to give up its positive being-moment to essential being, it itself retains only a negative being. It must indeed be acknowledged that [84] that which is non-being also **is**, but seen in its own negation it can no longer assume

the character of pure immediacy and appear as the positive other over against the essential. The being that non-being has is precisely a being negated in itself. That which is non-being must thus pass for what it is, namely for the side of being that is abandoned by affirmative being itself. Since its non-being is its being, this being is itself a non-being. We thus get non-being in its own non-being, i.e. a pregnant negation. That which is non-being, with non-being as its being, is thus determined as the **unessential**.

The distinction between the essential and the unessential is hereby developed as a distinction of dignity, but the dignity itself depends on the relation of both. The essential is essential only with **regard** to the unessential, just as conversely the unessential is unessential only with **regard** to the essential. Each of the opposed terms doubles itself in the further development of the relation.

The immediate being of the essential is, as such, unessential, and assumes the character of essentialness only through a privation of the being that would otherwise belong to the unessential. The essential is thus essential only in the unessential, and so has the distinction of dignity in itself.

The unessential does not, as such, belong to itself; isolated from the essential it is only an immediate non-being, and consequently neither unessential nor essential. Herein lies: a) that the negated being of the unessential rests in a positive other, with regard to which it is determined, that it consequently cannot itself make itself what it is, but must fetch its unessentialness from outside; b) that the essential, which gives the unessential its unessentialness, thereby characterizes its own essentialness [85] solely in this, that this essentialness, unessential in itself, is in consequence nothing other than the very unessentialness in the unessential; thus: unessentialness is the unessential's own essentialness.

The relation must then be more closely determined thus: that the selfsame thing which in the one term is essential is in the other unessential, and since each of the terms refers itself to itself as to its negation, the selfsame term is in one regard essential, in another regard unessential. The distinction of dignity is entirely dependent on the different regard (*diversus respectus*). But no regard can take place without there being something to which one looks. This something can be sought neither in the essential nor in the unessential, since it is precisely this distinction of dignity that is to be determined by the regard itself. That to which one looks must therefore present itself as something immediately given, as an abstract essentialness valid for both terms. If, e.g., A is such a given essentialness, with regard to which a is posited as the essential,

b on the other hand as the unessential, then A, as that on which the distinction of dignity between the subordinate terms rests, is the only thing that in this relation can be called the truly essential. But if A is the essential, then, considered in and for itself, it is at the same time both essential and unessential; its hypothetical dignity then depends on an opposed term B, which likewise can in itself be both essential and unessential. The distinction of dignity between A and B must therefore be determined by a still higher essentialness, etc.

Insofar as B, then, is the unessential, A is the essential, and the distinction of dignity deduced from it between a and b stands firm; **insofar** as B, on the other [86] hand, is posited as the essential, A becomes the unessential, and the subordinate dignity-moments are altered; insofar, finally, as both A and B, according to higher regards, are each in its own way recognized as essential, their subordinate moments become now more, now less essential, and the modification goes on to infinity.

The characteristic one-sidedness of **criticism** becomes evident from this. The critical method presupposes an essential distinction between the essential and the unessential; it is so far from confounding these dignities of being that its whole endeavor is rather directed at discerning and separating them from one another. But since criticism grasps this **essential** distinction merely as something that immediately **is**, and everywhere seeks to mark the qualitative limit by the demarcation lines of the understanding, it must continually change standpoint, and so loses its way in a labyrinth of contradictory hypotheses and different regards.^{*)} The next advance is that the different regards, with all the dignities of being that follow from them, are grasped in their whole mutual relativity, whereby every immediate determination, whether in its pure immediacy it presents itself as essential or as unessential, is sublated. This [87] sublation of all superficial immediacy characterizes the standpoint of **ingenuity** and of **wit**, where one seeks in everything a deeper meaning (ὑπόνοια).

On the one side, then, one has here the whole sum of determinate-existence-moments, which are all unessential because they are all immediate; on the other side, by contrast, pure essentialness, which, in giving all determinations their essential meaning, thereby at the same time determines itself. The task is then to demonstrate

^{*)}These “different regards” are, so to speak, the squalls of external reflection, which, if they gain the upper hand, must cause every philosophical idea to capsize. It is with the critical philosophy as with critical science in general: it always says: Insofar — insofar! But the insofar-philosophy is an old man’s philosophy, which despite all *reservationes mentales* must *crepere* from scrupulosity. The various divisions into *Articuli fidei fundamentales* et *non fundamentales* can, as far as the Church’s doctrinal system is concerned, furnish an example.

the relation of the immediate moments to essentialness; for in this relation they are all essential. On the standpoint of ingenuity, where even the most insignificant thing receives its significance, the distinction that **is** between the essential and the unessential is thus sublated. The method aims at negating abstract immediacy, which as such is one with unessentialness itself; but this negation is a reinterpretation, whereby every moment entirely loses its unessential side, and essentialness itself is identified with the sum of the relative essence-moments. Ingenuity is still caught in the critical dilemma: either A must be essential or unessential. The being of essence in the totality of the relative moments is thus after all still an immediate being; one procures only a superficial immanence, without bringing it to consciousness that essentialness must necessarily have unessentialness, as such, in itself. The one-sidedness therefore also betrays itself in a double way: partly, namely, one can develop essentialness only by a successive reinterpretation of the unessential moments, whereby the development loses itself in an infinite becoming and approximation that never reaches absolute essentialness itself; partly the essentialness presented by the reinterpretation is drawn down into the relativity of the moments to such a degree that in them it loses all [88] essential meaning, and wit ends in witlessness.*)

For if the unessential has itself become essential and been posited as the immediate expression of essentialness, then the essential has hereby also become unessential. With the vanishing of unessentialness the fleeting negation vanishes, as that which concerns only external consideration, and only pure abstract immediacy remains; but this is precisely the true characteristic of unessentialness.

Skepticism shows us how the immediately essential constantly passes over into the unessential; every affirmative being dissolves in the skeptical “tropes”. α) Pure immediacy, the thing as such, **is** only **for** a consciousness; the being of the thing therefore does not affirm itself, but the affirmation belongs to self-consciousness, which is the thing’s non-being. Since it is thus not the thing itself, but only the subjective assertion about the thing, that has significance, every thing, as such, is **unessential**: “Man is the measure of things”.

But the affirmative being of consciousness characterizes itself in that it can negate any determinate being whatever: its self-affirmation lies precisely in the negative operation whereby it negates everything, itself too. The essentialness of self-consciousness thus consists in its being able to posit itself as **unessential**. β) If the negation by which consciousness negates its own being and that of all things is in turn negated,

*)Examples of this we have in superficial teleology, tasteless typology and arbitrary allegorizing.

[89] then the negative operation does thus indeed assume a positive tinge; but the essential immediacy in which the being restored by the negation coincides with itself is nevertheless only the indeterminate and all-determining opening, pure postulating. But every postulating must postulate something. Insofar as something is postulated, other is negated. Now since something is postulated only because it is postulated, and other is negated merely because it is negated, one can conversely just as well negate something and postulate other. If the ground why something is affirmed is not to lie in the affirmation itself, then it must be sought in an other that is already affirmed; but if this affirmation in turn is not to be groundless either, then it again presupposes an other, and so on to infinity. The axioms of dogmatism are all groundless and in consequence **unessential**. If one finally reduces the affirmation of something and other to their reciprocal relation, so that consciousness is affirmed because it affirms the thing, and the thing in turn is affirmed by the affirmation of consciousness, then a “Dialellus” sets in, which makes the confirmation dependent on that which itself depends on the confirmation.

The strife between these different standpoints arises from a one-sided conception of the infinite **relativity** of pregnant being. a) Relativity in all determinate being presupposes a being-for-itself. That something is relative means that it is just as much for itself as for other. This side is held fast in criticism.

b) True relativity expresses the being of the relative moments for one another. [90] Herein lies partly a mutual affirmation, partly a mutual negation. Ingenuity grasps the relation from the affirmative standpoint; what is negated here is only the isolated being-for-itself of the moments. The one immediate determination coincides with the other, and as all being-moments are joined to and supported by one another, all-being consolidates itself as the positive essentialness. Ingenuity recognizes the pregnant immediacy of being, but on the other hand does not notice that the one immediate being-moment is precisely, as such, the negation of the other, and that true being continually vanishes as one tries to grasp it and hold it fast. Skepticism takes relativity from its negative side; for it the sum of all the moments of being is only a totality of mutual negations. Immediacy vanishes each time it surfaces, and with it every affirmation vanishes too. Skepticism has an eye only for the pregnant negation, under which all determinations mutually consume and dissolve one another, but it does not feel the infinite presence of essentialness in all negative movements, and can therefore never reach the categorical expression of true being. Absolute relativity, on the other hand, presents to us the pregnant immediacy in the pregnant negation.

While skeptical relativity expresses itself only in an external relation between negative moments, so that its negation is successively infinite without being absolute, absolute relativity on the contrary concentrates all negative moments in a negative unity, in which every negated determination refers itself to all the others as to itself, and thereby raises itself to affirmative immediacy. According to relativity, the one immediate being-determination is the negation of the other; herein lies: α) that immediate being [91] **is** negation, and thus the negative of itself; β) that its negativity **is** the very other in which it is negated; γ) that this other also **is** the negative of itself.

All negative moments thus **are**, namely as negated, and the one is what the other is, for it is a common determination for them all that each of them for itself is the negative of itself. Every negative determination is thus in its negativity itself and only itself alone; this its relation to itself constitutes the first main side of immediacy. Next, the negative moment in its negativity is precisely the negative of itself; it is itself all other negative moments. It therefore does not put itself in the place of other and exclude otherness, as the One does in being-for-itself; otherness **is** in the negative moment as negated; but negated otherness is otherness in its own otherness, thus otherness in its truth: the negated moment is itself its other, since it is an other of itself. This relativity expresses the second main side of immediacy.

But this pregnant immediacy, which is **negativity's own immediacy**, is consequently at the same time **immediacy's own negativity**.

Negative immediacy is the unity of being in which all negated moments sink together as in their universal negation. The universal negation is thus a negation of all negative moments and, as such, their affirmative unity. As the unity that affirms the negative moments, it does indeed affirm its own other; but since its relation to its other is its absolute relation to itself, it affirms itself in affirming its own negativity. Every immediate being-determination that can vanish in it has thus already vanished, [92] and every one that can come **has** already come; as the negation of all coming and vanishing, the unity is the positive center of all-being, its absolute remaining-in-itself. This central being, purified in negation, is the **essence** of all-being. As the immediacy of negativity, essence is the affirmation of negativity in negativity itself; every other being that shows itself with pure immediacy must then just as immediately show its immediacy negated; every immediate being will then henceforth have to be regarded as immediacy's own negativity, as a being that immediately expresses its non-being, i.e. as **semblance**.*) It will be evident from this that the pregnant immediacy and

*)Think here, e.g., of the thinker's absolute relation to himself through his thoughts.

self-affirmation which essence vindicates through the pregnant negation can only be posited and developed as all the moments of determinate existence, as semblance and being-reflexes, are sublated in the dialectic of essence. a) The self-determination of essence thus accomplishes itself in a circular movement, during which it takes up all the moments of being: **the dialectic of essentiality must have its own peculiar sphere.** b) The same holds of semblance, the essential negation of essence. Although the being of semblance must be deduced from essence, it nevertheless has a being; just because the being of essence is the original and that of semblance the deduced, the proper dialectic of semblance can only develop by positing essentiality as a negated [93] moment; semblance thus everywhere sublates essence, and moves within itself as phenomenon. **Thereby the phenomenon obtains its logical sphere.** c) But as essence and phenomenon, each in its sphere, round themselves off into dialectical totalities, it turns out that these are only relative. Their true distinction of dignity must be sought in their absolute relativity. According to absolute relativity the totality is referred to itself as to its other, and to its other as to itself. **The pervasive unity of the totalities, which will overcome the essential dualism, unfolds itself in the sphere of actuality.**

A. The Sphere of Essentiality.

a) Pure Essence.

§ 21.

Essence, Semblance, Reflection.

Pure essence, i.e. the absolute unity of being, which sublates all distinction in negating all immediate and relative being-moments, is, by virtue of this universal negation, first to be determined as the absolute nothing. But the immediate determinations of being are annihilated in the absolute nothing only in that they annihilate one another; since they are thus posited in their nothing, they are posited in their truth. Finite being is hereby recognized for what it really is, namely negativity's own fleeting immediacy, pure *semblance*. Identity, the essential unity of essence and [94] semblance, is the unity of distinction, and opposition, the essential distinction of both, is the distinction of unity: *reflection* expresses the self-movement of essence and its mirroring in all the moments of semblance.

Although being in the preceding chapter has separated its categorical determinations, and has thereby gradually been dissolved into a multiplicity of limited and modified moments, yet with all this it is the **one and the same** being that, by negating its immediate equality with itself, has posited its distinction-moments, and, by a successive negation of every specific determination, has sublated all its immediate categories, in order to coincide with itself in absolute unity.

In **pure being** all specific being-determinations are suppressed, and their place is taken by pure nothing; in **absolute indifference** the distinct determinations develop at once into indifference and into equal validity. Insofar now as their indifference is their invalidity, indifference presents itself as the blind unity of being; but insofar as the moments, on the other hand, in their indifference each for itself have the same validity, indifference is abandoned to infinite difference, and being never attains any true determination. In pure **essence**, by contrast, all being-moments are not merely developed and posited, but also negated and sublated; their immediate validity is hereby determined as their true invalidity, and essence posits itself as the absolutely valid, i.e. as the true unity of being. Since essence, as absolute being itself, cannot change, it follows that it cannot immediately be “something” either; for every “something” stands over against an “other”, and is as such subject to “change”. Just as little can essence be held fast as an immediate being-for-itself whose qualitative unity [95] would exclude all relative being-elements, for thereby these, as for-itself, would in turn have to exclude it. Through such a reciprocal exclusion essence would then present itself only as “One” among “Many”, and thus be drawn into the circle of finite relations.

The only determination of essence then becomes that of negating every determination, whereby it then again seems to present itself as pure being. But the essential distinction between being and essence is nonetheless, when more closely considered, conspicuous. For while pure being, in its logical innocence, as yet knows of no negation, and is therefore, if we may say so, surprised by the delimiting nothing, so as to be determined by it in its whole indeterminateness, essence on the other hand has taken up negation, and with it the principle of all determinations, into itself. Essence is not negated by anything, since it rather itself negates everything; it does not **let** itself be determined, but is itself that from which all determination proceeds. The determinateness of essence is thus to be posited as its absolute self-determining.

But although essence, as being concentrated in itself, is now regarded as the logical wellspring from which all the moments of being emanate, and consequently must

itself yield determinations to infinity, this its determinability is nevertheless by no means to be confused with the readiness of indifference to assume any determination. Indifference falls prey to difference, and makes do, so to speak, with the being-moments as chance may have it, just because it must **let** itself be determined. It does indeed have negation under all particular shapes in itself, but it does not itself master [96] this negation; its negation therefore constantly alters its being, and thus prevents it from all self-determination. Essence, on the other hand, has negation itself in its power, and therefore also masters all relative being-determinations. Every immediate being that attempts to escape the central unity and affirm its own immediacy is then at once overtaken and overpowered by the irresistible negation of essence, which compels it to confess the Whence? and Whither? of its movement. The immediacy that is becomes from its nothing; it thus comes from the negative of itself, i.e. from essence; in its becoming it therefore also goes back into its nothing, i.e. into the negation of essence.

Since essence negates every immediate being, it must consequently also negate the immediacy of its own being. By its two-edged negation it does indeed win for itself a pregnant immediacy, but its two sides always constitute one single, purely immediate unity. According to the pure immediacy of this unity, essence is, in its self-determination, continually on the point of becoming “something” and of presenting itself as something that is. Now if every immediate something has fallen prey to the negation of essence, then this negation must also continually sublate the being of essence itself. Absolute being is thus posited as the in-itself absolute nothing, and the positive side determines itself as the negative. If essence is in itself negativity’s own immediacy, then it is eo ipso also immediacy’s own negativity: **pure essence is, as such, pure semblance.**

The relative, finite nothing, which negates only a certain something, is in itself just as much a being as a nothing; it therefore also presents itself as a determinately existent nothing, and assumes the positive stamp of otherness; but the in-itself absolute nothing, which tolerates no immediate being whatsoever, can on the other hand never [97] itself enter into determinate existence. The result then seems to be this: that essence, according to its self-determination, must deny itself every being-determination, that it thus does not exist at all, and that only finite being, seen in its own infinity, i.e. in the wealth of all its moments, is true being.^{*)} But if essence is without determinate existence, then determinate existence must also be essenceless, and, as such, present

^{*)}In this result atheistic logic acquiesces; for atheism, logically taken, is the denial of essence.

itself in its whole unessentialness. The dialectical development of determinate being does indeed show that something must itself be its other, and that it thereby becomes something other than it was before; but this sublation of the immediacy of something is, on the standpoint of being, only an alternation with a following immediacy. The negation of change is thus merely a progression from the one immediacy to the other. What is negated here is only the given, determinate immediacy-moment; the negation is therefore partial and successive. The something that perishes is annihilated only as **this** or that determinate something. But every something that follows must always be determined as **this** or that: the “**determinate** something” thus remains, throughout the whole change, really unchanged. Herewith, then, the being of change is sublated and posited as a semblance. How far change is to hold depends solely on how far something can immediately separate itself from other. As long as there is a distinction that is between something and other, so long is there also a becoming and a transition from the latter to the former. But according to the pregnant negation the immediate being of something is really its non-being, its being as not-something. Something is in itself a semblance; from this it comes that its transition into other is no transition. [98] The other of something then, in consequence, is not a real other either, but only the reflected semblance of other, by which something points beyond itself. As other now casts its semblance on something without itself being absorbed in it, it reserves its pure immediate being for itself. Other is thus now the real something, the real, which seems to have saved itself out of the nothingness of semblance. But if other is now held fast as something, then it is, according to what precedes, again a semblance in itself and a reflected semblance of other. Thus determinate existence with all its multiplicity becomes transparent, and its immediacies clear into innumerable reflected semblances. Each semblance in this realm of finitude is a fleeting immediacy that in its negation points beyond itself to something that is; but in the place of what is a new semblance continually enters, and affirmative being flees away into infinity. In semblance itself there is not anything, and every something outside semblance transforms itself into semblance; thus determinate existence stands as absolute emptiness: “Alles Seyn ist Schein”.⁹⁾ The nothingness in which all-being now seems to evaporate must, however,

⁹⁾Herewith the standpoint of acosmism is indicated. The acosmist and the atheist can unite in recognizing the transience of the world. But they grasp it in opposite ways. The atheist regards everything from the standpoint of being and change, and can therefore indeed concede the perishability of things in the particular; but since the partial immediacies are continually restored in change, he insists, as far as the whole is concerned, on the eternal apriority and imperishability of the world. The acosmist, on the other hand, sees through the nothingness of the whole of determinate existence, in that he grasps, from the standpoint of essence, the content of all-being as semblance of semblance and

[99] itself vanish as semblance when the essence-negation is carried through. What is terrifying in the thought-movement of nihilism lies in this, that it presupposes a distinction of dignity between immediate being on the one side and essenceless, illusory semblance on the other. It ceaselessly seeks a being which in its truth and purity should be freed from every semblance, and since it then everywhere finds that such a being can only be determined as the pure other of semblance, and that every such other, as the negation of semblance, is, when one wants to hold it fast, a reflected semblance of semblance and in itself a semblance, it leads consciousness to the disconsolate result that everything is **only** semblance.

One rejects semblance because one trusts in the pure immediacy of being. If, on the other hand, it becomes evident that it is precisely immediate being which, when more closely tested, is itself semblance, then being has its truth in semblance; semblance then stands, as such, above mere being, the relation of dignity turns around, and one must admit that every immediacy that is supposed to lie outside semblance is **only** a being. Now if true being is to be sought in semblance, then it is hereby given that every other being that is not sublated in semblance must for just that reason be regarded as a real semblance-being. The essential separation between true and untrue being will therefore now have to be posited as a **separation between true and false semblance**.

Pure semblance is in the first place an immediacy that is, which represents only itself; but as fleeting immediacy, i.e. as immediacy's own negativity, it must next just as immediately turn over into its negation. This sudden reversal, which repeats itself everywhere in the infinite series of semblance, always brings with it, for naive, [100] credulous consciousness, a surprise. He who does not suspect that immediacy is itself negativity will, when he sees the pure immediacy of semblance, want to capture and hold fast positive being in it; but as the semblance-immediacy now at once betrays the secret of its negation, he sees himself deceived, and will then leap over semblance entirely in order to grasp reality. It is this infinite self-separation, in which semblance continually repeats itself anew, that produces the illusion: "**Semblance deceives**".

The single semblance in its self-negation refers to another semblance; the flight of immediacy and positivity shows itself as an uninterrupted transition from semblance to semblance; thus the affirmation of semblance lies in its negation. But as semblance through its negation mirrors and confirms itself, it is completely sublated; for it conflicts with the determination of semblance to affirm and mirror only itself alone.

the world as the realm of illusions.

The absolute semblance, which shines through all reciprocal semblances, is then at the same time the true other of semblance, the real in semblance, whose immediacy is not fleeting but positive and abiding; thus **essence**, the **absolute negation** of semblance in **semblance itself**, is **clarified as the pure light-** (τὸ

The light is the unity of semblance; this unity is won through the infinite self-separation of semblance; it is thus the unity of distinction, and as such **identity**. As the affirmation of semblance in its negation, identity is semblance-unity and itself semblance; but as the negation of semblance in its affirmation, as its sublation in other, it is essence-unity, indeed essence itself, and distinction is semblance. Since identity is thus both semblance and essence, it is at once the negation of distinction and at the same time itself distinction. Both these moments must then be posited and negated in the infinite reciprocal semblance between essence and semblance, i.e. in **reflection**. [101]

The all-round development of reflection characterizes its three main shapes: 1) As reflection of **movement** it expresses the infinite transition of identity and distinction into one another; 2) as **reflection of determination** it fixes the opposition of identity and distinction; and finally 3) as **absolute** reflection it shows the true reciprocal semblance of movement and determination.

1. The reflection of movement is a) **positing**, b) presupposing and c) **opposing**.

a) Immediacy, pure abstract identity, negates itself and vanishes as semblance in presenting itself as its own distinction; the immediate thus passes over into the negative. This transition, however, is no becoming; what immediacy hereby **becomes**, namely the negative of itself, it already **was** before the transition took place. Here, then, one does not begin with the immediate; rather the reflection-immediacy **results** as an identity-medium between two negative extremes. The transition thus takes place from the negative to the negative, whereby negativity refers itself to itself, so that immediacy is only the unity in which the relation is held fast. Distinction, the negative that proceeds from immediate identity, is precisely that from which identity, or the immediacy that is, has itself proceeded. It is the negation of immediacy that sublates identity; but since immediacy, as semblance, is itself this negation, identity in turn sublates distinction. The return of the immediate to itself through negation is the very return of negation to itself through immediacy. Immediacy is posited in resulting from the sublated negation. But it is not posited by the abstractly negative, for this too is resulting, and is itself **posited** as the sublation of the immediate. [102]

What is **posited** and **sublated** in this transition is thus a fleeting moment, a

semblance that vanishes as it comes, and comes again in the same instant as it vanishes; essence, on the other hand, is the infinite **positing** and **sublating**, and as such movement and reflection itself.

As pure positing, essence is a movement from semblance to semblance, and consequently a movement that does not move itself, i.e. a semblance-movement that is itself posited by the unmoved. As the essence-identity, through the sublation of the posited being of semblance, would affirm itself, it is absorbed in an essential distinction; for it becomes at once both the unmoved, which posits but is not posited, and the negative of this, namely the positing movement that is itself posited. As the not-posited but positing, essence is the **principle** of movement, movement on the other hand, with all that it deposits, semblance and **result**. But as the principle of movement, the principle must express its essentiality in movement itself; it thus proceeds from its own posited and sublated movement, and is accordingly itself result. Principle and result are now identical; but since the principle is principle only by **positing**, and the result result only by **sublating** the movement, the **movement** itself is essential, and expresses the true distinction between principle and result.

[103] With the principle the positing movement **begins**, with the result it **ends**. Since the principle is itself result, the movement must end in the same instant as it begins; but since the result is itself principle, it must also begin in the same instant as it ends. The pure positing of essence is thus an infinite converting. Ahead of every result there goes a positing that is negated in the result itself; but since the result is hereby converted into principle, the sublated positing again proceeds from its own negation and continues itself.

As the positing that must already be posited in order to be able to be posited, and for that reason posits its own sublation in order to posit itself, reflection is **presupposing**. b) Presupposing reflection determines the essential identity and distinction of principle and result. In order that the principle can posit its result, it must itself already be. But in this abstract being-for-itself it is only a semblance; its true essence lies in the positing by which it posits the result. Before it has posited itself, it is thus not an essential principle, and before the principle has become essential, it can deposit no result; but conversely, it cannot posit itself either except by depositing its result. In the essence of principle and result there thus lies a double presupposition. α) In order to posit itself, the principle posits its own negation and sublation, namely its result, but it itself sublates this negation; for it posits itself only by positing its result as that which is not yet posited but is to be posited. According to this

primitive presupposition the principle posits itself **in advance** by presupposing its result. β) The result is presupposed as a semblance vanishing for the essence of the principle, and thereby presupposed as that which is to be posited; with this positing the essential negation of the principle sets in, and the result posits itself. But the negation of the principle is an essential moment in its self-position; the result thus posits itself as that which does not posit but is posited; it presupposes its presupposing principle; its true essence is its self-sublation, and its presupposing **consecutive**^{*)}. γ) This presupposing, doubled in itself, is however by no means to be regarded as a composition of two heterogeneous fragments. The primitive and the consecutive presupposing are identical. But their identity is no tautology either; each of the two terms of reflection is itself the whole reflection. They are both equally independent, and in this their mutual independence each other's complete negation and distinction. The developed presupposing is thus one single positing reduplicated in itself, which uninterruptedly turns **against** itself, and thereby characterizes itself as an **opposing**. As opposing reflection doubles its own independence, it deposits two centers, and thus goes, through a double movement, back into itself. The principle takes itself back through the result, and writes, so to speak, its result as a periphery around its own center. It is thus at once positing, posited, presupposing and presupposed, and its movement, complete in itself, constitutes its immobility. Conversely the result reflects itself in its principle; its self-sublation is its self-position. But the self-position of the result is the essential negation of the principle: the result thus reflects its immobility in itself, and rests in the sublated principle as in itself alone. Herewith absolute identity is posited as absolute distinction. The principle is now no longer principle, for its transition into the result is completed; just as little can the reflection of the result have any specific significance, since the result is now rather itself principle. Each of the opposed terms is thus closed in itself, the movement has vanished, and only pure opposition remains^{*)}. 2. In the presupposed opposition each term is independent, [104]

^{*)}Since God has in advance posited his world (primitive presupposing), the world now also presupposes its God (consecutive presupposing).

^{*)}The essential distinction between pantheism and atheism, dualism and deism on the one side and theism on the other shows itself as a distinction between the one-sided and the all-round conception of the reflection-movement. Pure reflection describes a circle. Pantheism is now separated from atheism (pancosmism) in that the former makes God, the latter by contrast the world, the center of the circle. But one-sided reflection without essential opposition is an abstract unessentialness, and the single circle a big zero. Dualism (deism), on the other hand, keeps to opposition. For the dualist, determinate existence presents itself under the image of two circles touching each other. But since one here forgets that the presupposed primal opposition is posited in advance, thus not unoriginated but sprung from a deeper identity, the double center of dualism can also be said to represent pure incomprehensibility. [105]

determinate in itself, and must be taken as it is given. Herewith movement vanishes as semblance in the reflection of **determination**.

Determination-reflection is a) **distinguishing**, b) **antinomic** and c) **fixing**.

a) For distinguishing reflection opposition presents itself in its pure immediacy, and is therefore held fast as a co-being of two identities touching each other: $A = A$, $B = B$. As the reflection-determination is now posited as the identity acquiescing in itself, movement vanishes as semblance; it is hereby posited as something wholly irrelevant to identity itself, as a juxtaposing and comparing that takes place merely in the subjective consciousness of the observer, thus as an **external** reflection. The observer's eye rests now on A and now on B, and subjective reflection now impresses their distinction on itself: A is not B; B is a not-A; A is a not-A; A is not not-A. In the pure identity of A with itself there lies, then, no determination at all of any not-A whatever. Indeed the very proposition: A is A, expresses only a reflection-identity that falls outside A itself. For A is here posited twice; but in its pure identical being-for-itself A cannot separate itself from itself. The separation is thus owed to external reflection, which, in its effort to hold fast identity in its perfect determinateness [107] and to **distinguish** between A and not-A (B), has had to posit A over against A, and by the copula "is" to undo this opposition again. Pure determinateness, freed from all contradiction, can only be expressed as an interjection-identity: A!, and the substitution by which subjective reflection puts A in the place of A (A is? — A!) is then hereby reduced to a perfect tautology⁹).

But even this tautology, which strives to escape contradiction, has its real life-principle in contradiction itself. For subjective reflection runs through the following propositions in its movement: A is (perhaps) not-A; A is not not-A and finally A is A. That it puts A in the place of A has significance solely in that it would otherwise have to put not-A in the place of A. But in this way it puts precisely A in the place of (the feared) not-A. Only by contradiction itself can subjective reflection distinguish itself free of contradiction. Contradiction is thus no longer an error of thought but a necessity of

Only theism grasps the true reflection-movement in its whole self-doubling. In recognizing the center of God and that of the world as sprung from the divine essence's own absolute centrality, theistic reflection sublates the circles of dualism: $\odot\odot$ in the symbol of infinity ∞ .

⁹Tautological reflection, whose criterion is that it regards contradiction as a subjective error of thought that can be removed by a distinguishing between the identities that are, has found its most extensive development in Wolfianism. Wolf defines contradiction as a "*simultaneitas in affirmando et negando*", without an inkling that he hereby defines the very principle of true reflection. In describing identity: "*Eadem dicuntur, quæ sibi invicem substitui possint*". (*Ontolog*, p. 148) he adds: "*Facta nimirum substitutione perinde esse debet, ac si nulla facta fuisset*", without observing that every such substitution thereby becomes entirely meaningless.

thought, and reflection is herewith recognized as **antinomic**. Through antinomic reflection it is brought to consciousness that duality, opposition and contradiction belong to reflection's own essence; but despite this the reflection-movement from which the determinations result is nevertheless posited as a semblance-essence, whose propositions must be sublated as soon as they are posited; true essence, by contrast, keeps itself in its pure indeterminable unity, and every attempt to determine it is annihilated in the "antithetic" of reflection. *Thesis: True essence is, when it is more closely determined, absolute identity.* [108]

Pure identity is **distinct** from distinction and **opposed** to opposition. Herewith it has sublated its abstract being-for-itself and itself posited itself as the distinction of distinction and the opposition of opposition; absolute identity is thus in itself opposition. *Antithesis: True essence must be determined as absolute opposition.*

In every opposition the one term must necessarily presuppose the other; for in order to be opposed, they must both be **posited** against each other: opposition is the inclusion of the opposed terms. But since each of the terms in the opposition is opposed to the other, they must mutually exclude each other; opposition is thus the mutual exclusion of the terms. Inclusion and exclusion are themselves opposed to each other. Thus opposition is, then, on all sides in opposition with itself, and thereby, as absolute opposition, opposed to itself. But the opposite of opposition is identity^{*)} [109]

The essence that remains in itself and is indeterminable in its pure determinateness is, however, not to be confused with the absolute indifference of being. Indifferent being is continually on the point of assuming any determination whatever, and is thus in an uninterrupted movement and unrest. The essence that is in itself, by contrast, keeps all reflection-determinations out, sets them off from itself as semblance and reflected glow, and thus acquiesces in its pure **transcendence**, lifted above all oppositions.

c) When this separation of identity and opposition, determination and movement, is carried through at every point, and thereby driven to the highest pitch, reflection shows itself as **fixing**. Fixing reflection holds fast, in the strictest way, the pure being of essence in its distinction from all negation. Even the reflection-determinations must in consequence be fixed as immovable. The reflection-determination fixed in itself^{**)} is now to be posited as a for-itself essentiality, whereby the primal identity of essence is shattered and separated into an innumerability of identity-fragments. Each of these

^{*)}Antinomic reflection is characteristic of Kantianism.

^{**)}Fixing reflection has been carried through with a rare energy in the Herbartian philosophy.

fragments is itself an in-itself, a pure identity, a tautology, thus a contradiction. The omnipresence of tautology is also the omnipresence of contradiction; every specific
 [110] determination that subjective reflection attributes to the determinate it must therefore continually take back. The immovable moments of essence show themselves to reflection in an uninterrupted movement, although reflection continually assures us that they do not move; in their mutual determination they continually pass over into each other, and reflection must itself employ the negation of the one in order to determine the other, although it is nonetheless asserted that the one identity-fragment (“reals”) does not concern the other. Reflection here entangles itself in an infinite self-deception; in fixing its determinations so one-sidedly, it fixes itself.

3) This illusion is sublated in **absolute or all-round** reflection, which, as a) **optical-intuitive**, b) **dialectical** and c) **dialectical-speculative**, lets determination and movement mirror each other.

a) Transcendent essence, which hovers above the opposition of reflection, thereby becomes opposed to opposition itself, and is thus determined in itself as the absolute identity of opposition. Essence now mirrors its immobility in its movement, it beholds itself in all its reflection-determinations, and its dark transcendence transforms itself, through optical-intuitive reflection, into clear **immanence**^{*)}. But the determinateness beheld in immanence is as it is, and it is not yet evident why it must move; movement is beheld as absolute, and it is not yet recognized why it must deposit the determinate. The identity of movement and determination is thus still tautologically immediate, and
 [111] the contradiction evident. b) The contradiction immanent in this identity of movement and determination first comes to true development in **dialectical** reflection.

Absolute identity is, as such, itself identity and opposition, and developed opposition likewise at once both opposition and identity. Each term in the opposition is thus for itself the whole identity and the whole opposition. It maintains its integrity by excluding the other term; identity excludes opposition just because it is itself opposition and has opposition in itself. Since each of the opposed terms now has its independence in itself by having its other, and has this other only by excluding it, it excludes its independence in the same instant as it would vindicate it; it steps out beyond itself and comes into movement just as it would remain in itself and fix its determinateness. According to this immanent contradiction, each of the terms has its inequality sublated in its own equality, and is thus to be posited as the **positive**; but conversely it also has an inequality reflected in equality, and must therefore just as

^{*)}Schelling.

well be posited as **the negative**^{*)}. c) But when the positive in its development is itself [112] the negative, then the identity of developed positivity and negativity, more closely considered, is developed tautology itself. The contradiction is then not yet resolved, and cannot possibly vanish as long as determination itself is not yet more closely determined. The positive must then be posited against itself as a This! against This! But this specific antithesis reflection, as such, cannot grasp; for to pure reflection This = This, as $A = A$. Fixed determinateness culminates in immediacy, i.e. in the negation of the reflection-movement. The demonstrable positivity-moment must be beheld as it is posited by essence itself. It is not, however, sensed as something that immediately is; its specific positivity is at the same time its specific negativity; it is, as the immovable, a moment within the dialectical movement itself. Integrated by this determination-moment, reflection is **dialectical-speculative**. As essence, as infinite negativity, deposits the positive, specific determinations, and thereby at the same time posits them as the negative, immovable moments of the reflection-movement, the thetic distinctions are preserved and mirrored in reflection itself. The dialectical stepping-forth of the thetic moments from the pleromatic center of essence thus constitutes the real presupposition, and reflects the own speculative ground-type of absolute essentiality. [113]

b) The Duality of Essence.

§ 22.

The Primitive Essence, the Consecutive Essence, Subordination.

In the absolute identity of all positive reflection-determinations essence has its infinite *fullness*. As the negative unity of the fullness (transcendent hypostasis) it must deposit the specific moments of determination; but since these vanish as semblance in its own self-position (transcendental hypostasis), the fullness remains esoteric, and the opposition reflected in it is sublated in the *primitive* essence's own for-itself

^{*)}Dieß ist also derselbe Widerspruch, der das Positive ist, nemlich Gesetzseyn oder Negation, als Beziehung auf sich. Aber das Positive ist nur an sich dieser Widerspruch; das Negative dagegen der gesetzte Widerspruch; den in seiner Reflexion in sich, an und für sich Negatives oder als Negatives identisch mit sich zu seyn, hat es die Bestimmung daß es Nichtidentisches Ausschliessen der Identität sey. Es ist dies gegen die Identität identisch mit sich zu seyn, hiermit durch seine ausschließende Reflexion sich selbst von sich auszuschliessen. Das Negative ist also die ganze, als Entgegensetzung auf sich beruhende Entgegensetzung, der absolute, sich nicht auf Anderes beziehende Unterschied; er schließt als Entgegensetzung die Identität von sich aus; aber somit sich selbst, den als Beziehung auf sich bestimmt er sich als die Identität selbst, die er ausschließt. Hegel.

identity (absolute hypostasis). The infinite positivity of the primitive essence is at the same time its infinite negativity; the esoteric fullness is therefore negated in the exoteric, and distinction enters in all-round specification. The independent unity of the exoteric fullness, reflected in itself, is hereby posited as the primitive essence's own central opposition, i.e. as *consecutive* essence. But as the esoteric fullness, in the presupposing reduplicated in itself, subordinates the exoteric to itself, the primitive essence itself becomes subordinated to the consecutive, and with this reciprocal *subordination* the central opposition perishes.

Determinate existence has dissolved in its nothing; it vanished as semblance and shadow in pure essence. Essence in this its abstraction was itself a negative being; [114] but from its infinite negativity there developed at the same time the negation and sublation of semblance; the self-reflection of essence constituted itself as principle for all reflection-determinations, and determinate determinateness culminated in the immediacy that is. Herewith, then, determinate existence is reproduced as the being **posited** by essence.*) The whole wealth of specific determinations of determinate existence thus **is**, and must be taken as it **is** given; but it is not of itself; as something that immediately is, it is infinite fragility and self-dissolution; its becoming is an uninterrupted resulting, and it itself a result that presupposes its presupposing principle; according to this consecutive presupposing, all determinate-existence-moments are sublated in the negative unity of the primal essence. But as negative unity, essence is not an abstract medium or external receptacle in which the moments could be thought of as preserved as things that are. Their being in essence is precisely their non-being; in the self-position of the primal essence they are posited only as those that are to [115] be posited.**) Insofar as essence is determined as that **which** posits itself by positing the infinite multiplicity of determinate existence, it is, with this pregnant identity, reflected in itself as in the absolute fullness (πλήρωμα). Essence is here consecutively presupposed, without however really being posited; it is posited by posited being, thus by that which can posit nothing, since it is itself deprived of all independence. The reflection-movement which essence thus itself has to go through in order to be able

*) In der Sphäre des Seyns war das Daseyn das Seyn, das die Negation an ihm hatte, und das Seyn der unmittelbare Boden und Element dieser Negation, die daher selbst die unmittelbare war. Dem Daseyn entspricht in der Sphäre des Wesens das Gesetzseyn. Es ist gleichfalls ein Daseyn, aber sein Boden ist das Seyn, als Wesen oder als reine Negativität; es ist eine Bestimmtheit oder Negation nicht als seyend, sondern unmittelbar als aufgehoben. Daß Daseyn ist nur Gesetzseyn dieß ist der Satz des Wesens, vom Daseyn. Hegel. Logik Iltes Buch. p. 23.

**) Denn man kann nicht sagen, daß in Gott sey Feuer, Bitter oder Herbe, vielweniger Luft, Wasser oder Erde, allein man siehet, daß es daraus worden ist. Jacob Böhme.

to deposit the specific moments of the fullness, reflected in their being-for-itself, shall now be considered more closely: a) Since all reflection-determinations vanish in the primal unity of essence, this unity is reflected in itself as in the negation of the determinations; essence affirms itself by negating all determinations; its indeterminability is its determinateness reflected in itself. But in this determinate indeterminability its being is infinitely affirmative, and essence is hereby presupposed as the **transcendent hypostasis**. As essence is hypostatized, it sublates the consecutive presupposing, and determines itself to be the all-positing. Hereby the reflection-determinations are then presupposed as those that are not yet posited. But they are to be posited; for the indeterminability of the transcendent essence is determined solely as the principle for all determinations. b) Insofar as the transcendent hypostasis now posits itself, it must determine its determinations, and thereby deposit difference and multiplicity as that in which it is itself negated; but insofar as it is to posit itself as the all-determining, the reflexes of the determinations must be absorbed as vanishing moments in its own self-position; only thus can essence appropriate to itself all reflection-determinations, [116] assimilate them to itself, and make them its own. But hereby the transcendent essence at the same time transcends its pure abstract being-for-itself, and opens up its hidden fullness, in order to hold itself fast as the determinate identity of the reflexes. Through this reflection-movement essence is posited by itself, and has thus determined itself as the in-itself determinable, i.e. **transcendental, hypostasis**. Transcendentality, immediately taken, now contains nothing more than what must already have been given in transcendence itself; but, according to the reflection-movement, it does contain something more. For in pure transcendence all determinations had vanished, and essence was consecutively presupposed; in the transcendental hypostasis, by contrast, they are posited as reflexes in the self-position of essence, and essence has accomplished the movement by which it constitutes itself as the all-positing. What thus lay hidden in the involution of transcendence becomes clarified and posited in the evolution of transcendentality. According to the self-movement that sets in between the transcendent and the transcendental, essence now relates itself to itself as principle to result. The transcendental hypostasis presupposes the transcendent, as the result presupposes the principle. But the principle is only the principle of the result. The transcendent hypostasis with its hidden being must therefore posit its reflection-determinations as the self-negation and opposition in which it first comes to possess itself and its fullness. Both hypostases are thus, each in itself and each for itself, the whole essence with its whole fullness, and by this their being-for-itself

[117] reflected in each other as mutual negations. Herewith the pregnant identity of the primal essence **is** reduplicated in itself as primal opposition and **duality**. c) This duality in the primal essence is, however, not to be held fast as a distinction that merely is between essence and essence. Self-movement is no becoming, no successive transition. In order that essence can be a transcendent, it must already have posited itself as a transcendental: the principle is itself result, and the result principle. The negation and distinction that remove tautology lie in the differences and oppositions of the fullness; but since all moments are still only vanishing semblance in the self-development of essence, essence moves from itself to itself, and posits the reflexes of determination as the medium in which it mirrors itself alone. Essence developed in itself is thus at once both positing and posited, and holds fast in its **absolute hypostasis** the whole fullness as **esoteric**.

The absolute hypostasis presupposes the developed distinction between transcendence and transcendentality; it is thus neither the one nor the other of these, but keeps itself in its being-for-itself as the identity of duality and opposition. If it were only the developed tautology of transcendence and transcendentality, all determination would vanish again; essence would then once more be transformed into a transcendent abstractum, and the movement would have to begin anew; but if, conversely, the absolute hypostasis posited the transcendent and the transcendental outside itself and, so to speak, **beside** itself, then the self-affirmation of the primal essence would
 [118] dissolve into sheer relativities; it would thereby represent itself as a posited determinate existence, which would again have to be sublated and negated. The self-position of essence is then to be posited as absolute identity in absolute opposition. Each of the terms of the opposition is itself the whole identity; thereby identity is opposed to itself, but this opposition is the negation of identity in identity itself, thus its own self-determination, whereby the opposition is sublated in the for-itself identity. Thus the absolute unity of the primal essence is reflected in its developed triplicity (τρεῖς ὑποστάσεις ἐν μιᾷ οὐσίᾳ), and essence has affirmed itself as **the primitive** essence.

As transcendent hypostasis the primitive essence is a principle that merely **is**, an essential semblance that reflects its own distinction: as transcendental hypostasis, by contrast, it is **posited** as principle, and is thereby its own result; and finally, as absolute hypostasis, it constitutes itself as the **self-positing**, in itself complete and essential principle.

But the **essential** principle is only the principle of the essential result; it is therefore reflected and completed in itself as that which is not yet completed. As the self-positing

principle the primitive essence vindicates its own central identity with itself; this centrality lies in this, that each hypostasis can for itself be posited as the unity of the two others; as the transcendent is thus posited as absolute, it reflects in itself the transcendental as transcendent and the absolute as transcendental. The self-movement by which the primitive essence posits its own identity and distinction is thus, taken for itself, a semblance-movement, and only as primitive presupposing [119] absolutely essential. The reflection by which the essential principle is reflected in itself must therefore be doubled from all sides, and thereby show itself as a reflection by which it is reflected in other. The primal opposition between the transcendent and the transcendental hypostasis, from which the central identity results, must thus itself be reflected in a central opposition, whereby the primitive essence is negated in the non-primitive. The self-negation of the primal essence is thus reduplicated in itself: partly, namely, it is a negation by which essence posits itself as its own negativum, which, as shown above, produces the primal opposition in the primitive essence itself; partly it is a negation by which the primitive essence, as concrete for-itself identity, posits its non-essence, i.e. its essential other. Without such a central opposition the primal opposition is an empty semblance, and the central identity a transcendent abstractum; but, reflected in its central opposition, the primal opposition is itself the primitive presupposition, and the central identity of the primitive essence the self-positing principle, which in the central opposition deposits its essential result.

This central opposition of the primitive essence can now be sought neither in determinate existence, since this has itself vanished as semblance, nor in pure semblance, since this is only the negation of pure essence, which is itself semblance. The essential negation of the primitive essence must therefore be posited as the semblance reflecting in itself, i.e. as the unessential or **consecutive essence**. Pure semblance [120] is infinite distinction; it affirms itself as semblance of semblance in uninterrupted self-separation. The semblance reflected in itself thus mirrors back an innumerability of semblances, of which each single one is in turn a semblance reflected in itself, a semblance-hypostasis. Insofar now as the semblance-movement everywhere tends toward a hypostatizing, every semblance takes on a stamp of essentiality, and vindicates for itself a relative independence; but insofar as the essential semblance is only a semblance-essence, its hypostatic affirmation is absorbed as a moment in its essential negation: the reflection-in-itself of the consecutive essence vanishes everywhere as infinite reflection-in-other; in thereby negating the central identity, and transforming itself into a semblance-identity for the hypostatized distinctions of

the outer reflection-determinations, it posits itself as the essence cast outward, with an **exoteric** fullness.

The esoteric and the exoteric fullness negate and reflect each other mutually. In the esoteric, every distinction-moment can now vanish as semblance, just because distinction itself is posited and hypostatized in the exoteric; and conversely, the identity in the exoteric can be posited as semblance-identity, since the identity of the esoteric fullness is affirmed and centralized in the primitive essence itself.

The central opposition between the primitive and consecutive essence now also presents itself as a true opposition between the **positive** and **negative**. The primitive essence, which in its abstract being-for-itself would sink down into a fleeting semblance without any independence and reflection-in-itself, frees itself from this [121] abstraction by positing the consecutive as its true negation, and thus shows that it has infinite negativity in itself; but it at the same time posits the consecutive essence as an essential result, which must presuppose its presupposing principle, and thereby goes uninterruptedly back into itself, as the absolutely completed. All negativity and non-independence is hereby posited as a serving moment for its positivity and independence; what steps forth in the exoteric fullness is already given as negative being in the esoteric; the reflection-movement by which the primitive essence posits changeability, and passes over into the exoteric fullness as into its own concrete transcendental, is thus the very same in which it reflects its unchangeability, and vindicates its eternal transcendence: the **hypostatized** semblances of **the consecutive** essence **are all radiations of the primitive light**.

The consecutive essence thereby shows itself as the self-development of negativity. It proceeds in all respects from its other. Reflected in the primitive, it **is** before it becomes **posited**; it **is** presupposed, as that which is to be posited. But reflected in itself, it is posited before it comes to be; its proper being proceeds from the self-position by which it negates and sublates its presupposition. But herein lies precisely its essential contradiction: it is, in order to be posited by its other; and it is posited by its other, in order to posit itself and to be. This contradiction finds its resolution in the fact that the peculiar reflection-movement of the consecutive essence lets its whole positivity be absorbed as a moment vanishing in the posited and developed negativity. According [122] to this peculiar reflection-movement, the consecutive essence **is** an independent, for-itself, self-identical essence. But its identity is negative. It posits itself as that which is posited by other; its independence expresses its non-independence: the position is negation. As identity would hypostatize itself, it vanishes as semblance

in an innumerability of relative hypostases; and as each separate essentiality would hypostatize and sustain its being-for-itself, it posits its own self-contradiction; as the result of a vanished independence, every semblance-hypostasis vanishes in another self-contradictory independence. The distinction-moments in the exoteric fullness are thus produced in order to be destroyed, and destroyed in order to be reproduced: the essential result is an identity dissolving itself.^{*)}

It is the primitive essence that uninterruptedly posits and sublates the contradictions of the consecutive; and it is, on the other hand, the negativity in the consecutive that expresses the positivity in the primitive. As they thus mutually presuppose each other, the distinction of dignity is at the same time posited in and with the reduplicated presupposition: their reciprocal relation is a mutual **subordination**; for [123] subordination is the reflection of the non-independent in the independent.

The consecutive essence cannot vindicate for itself exclusive independence, for it would thereby cease to be consecutive; nor can it give up its independence and vanish, for the primitive itself would thereby be annihilated. But the contradiction that the independence of the consecutive essence lies in its non-independence is removed in subordination. That it has independence follows precisely from its having in itself the primitive as its essential principle; the independence it has in itself is thus not its own; it is sacrificed in being subordinated. But since, as a semblance reflected in itself, it reflects, has and is in itself its own essential distinction, it is not violated in its sacrifice by an alien essence: its subordinating is its own complete self-position, and its independence results uninterruptedly from its non-independence.

The primitive essence can then subordinate the consecutive to itself only in that the latter subordinates itself. The self-position of the consecutive is thus the basis on which the independence of the primitive rests, the real presupposition from which its whole primitivity proceeds. But in this way the primitive essence itself becomes consecutive, and the consecutive primitive. The presupposing of subordination transforms itself, then, in its development into a mere interchanging of the independent and non-independent, thus into a coordination of both. The essential advance lies in this, that all the reflection-movements and thetic moments that the central opposition contains [124]

^{*)}According to its triplicity, the essence of God is infinitely affirmative; the world-essence, on the other hand, uninterruptedly seeks independence, without being able to attain it in itself. The independence it has in its peculiar self-movement is only a medium for the revelation of God's absolute independence. Could it, on the other hand, in actuality be thought of as torn loose from identity with God, it would thereby become diabolical; for the diabolical essence is precisely the contradiction ceaselessly hypostatizing itself, which can nevertheless never attain a true hypostasis.

are now grasped and determined; but since each of the terms in this opposition is itself at once both the primitive and the consecutive essence, and the one is thus in the ground the very same as the other, the whole opposition is itself a central contradiction, and must consequently go to the ground.^{*)}

c) *Absolute Essence.*

§ 23.

Primal Ground, Content, Mediation.

In absolute essence every determinately existent independence is sublated; all is in the ground one; thus is *primal ground*. But distinction is just as fundamental as identity. All is in the ground distinct; as the ground of all, the primal ground opens [125] itself out in a *content* of relative grounds. This double ground-movement, whereby the primal ground partly sublates ground-elements, in order itself to ground its own transcendence, partly gives itself up, in order to express its essential immanence in the determinate relative grounds of determinate existence, is consummated in *mediation*. In “pure essence” all being-determinations are absorbed as reflexes; the one reflection-moment mirrors the other; in “the duality of essence” the reflection in other becomes determined on all sides as a reflection-in-itself. Essence sublates semblance, and is reflected in itself as essence in essence, just as semblance conversely takes up essentiality into its self-reflection. This central opposition between the primitive and consecutive essence is reflected again, through subordination, in one single ground-identity, whereby the immanent, all-sided reflection is carried through, and essence posits itself as **absolute essence**. In absolute essence every essentiality-moment now steps forth with absolute reflection-in-itself. The primitive essence is absolute, for it sublates the consecutive as a moment in its own self-reflection, as substrate for its subsistence; each of its hypostases is consequently also absolute, for it reflects the whole primitive essence in itself. On the other hand, the consecutive essence,

^{*)}When the central opposition which logic has hereby intimated between the essence of God and that of the world cannot maintain itself, but dialectic must again let them vanish into each other, the ground of this is that the categories in which God and the world are here apprehended are still too abstract. But the theistic type vindicates its significance nonetheless; for every central opposition that vanishes thereby forms a transition to fuller categories, in which it returns with greater clarity. The typical course of development is then this: the deeper the immanence, the higher the transcendence; the more concrete the universality, the firmer the centrality. Speculative logic therefore cannot stop before the theistic central opposition is posited with absolute freedom, so that the primitive essence can no longer vanish in the consecutive.

which in its self-movement sublates the primitive, and, when its reflection is complete, subordinates it to itself, is likewise absolute; and since now each of the consecutive hypostases again reflects all the others, the absolute itself is posited in every moment of absolute essence. Since no being, no semblance can fall outside the absolute, the absolute in turn cannot fall outside any of its moments whatsoever; every moment of the absolute consequently becomes itself posited as an absolutely independent, indeed as the absolute itself. But the absolutely independent tolerates no otherness outside [126] itself. For if it left otherness behind, this would in turn, by virtue of the absolute, itself become an absolutely independent, and we would thus obtain two absolutes, of which neither was absolute. As a moment of the absolute becomes absolutely independent, it thereby subordinates all the others, and transforms them into substrates. Now as all the moments have equal claim to absolute independence, so must they also all, without exception, be transformed into substrates, and are consequently, each for itself, absolutely non-independent. Here, then, is an innumerability of independents, which are sublated and vanish in the absolute independence.

When the independent is sublated, it goes to the ground. Independent being is first the true determinate being; to lose the independence of one's being is to lose one's proper being; the transition from absolute independence to absolute non-independence is therefore a transition as immediate and abrupt as from being to non-being: **to go to the ground is to be annihilated**. But the absolutely independent is sublated only because it itself has its non-independence in its independence, because the other which constitutes its foundation and substrate would itself be posited as absolutely independent; it thus goes to the ground only insofar as it seeks its independent foundation; in this respect it is so far from being annihilated that by **going under** it much rather itself becomes the solid **underlay** and foundation in which the independent other must posit its true independence; **there is thus no annihilation**. But if now the whole multiplicity of independents is reduced to substrate for the independence of the absolute, then this becomes an independence in which nothing is independent, consequently an absolute non-independence; if, conversely, the absolute independence goes up into the multiplicity and distinction of the independents, it [127] precisely thereby goes under in sheer relativities, and neither have we anything absolutely independent. In the ground itself, then, lie the immediate identity and distinction of independence and non-independence. In order that independence can be grounded, the independents must go under; but in order to ground the independents, independence itself goes to the ground. As all is thus to be grounded, nothing becomes

grounded.

This ground-contradiction in absolute essence can first be removed by the true ground-movement. The absolute grounds itself in order to ground its other, and it grounds its other in grounding itself: the absolute is absolute only in that it itself is the medium between itself and other. The ground-movement is then, as a consequence of this, a double one: partly a primitive, whereby the absolute grounds itself as absolute; partly a **consecutive**, whereby it lays itself down as ground for the non-absolute. The one of these ground-movements grounds in turn the other, and is thus the other's medium: grounding is **mediation**.

As the absolute independence in which all that is independent has its ground, absolute essence is the primitive ground, i.e. **primal ground**. Since pure absolute independence sublates every independent being, it is, in this its abstract being-for-itself, presupposed as the negation of all independence, as that in which as yet nothing is grounded, but from which all being, even the absolute, is nevertheless to proceed and be grounded. In this its transcendence the primal ground is thus determined as the real nothing, **the negative identity of** all. The non-absolute proceeds from its other, and precisely therefore comes from the absolute as from its nothing; the
 [128] absolute itself is its own other, it originates from itself, and is precisely therefore the unoriginated, i.e. that which has originated from nothing. Nothing is thus that from which all originates, but only the real nothing grounds a true, real being. In “becoming” pure being does indeed originate from pure nothing, but here there is no grounding; for since being, as such, is only an abstract immediacy, the nothing that is is also an empty, abstract negation. In reflection, essence is the nothing of semblance and semblance the nothing of essence, but they alternate as fleeting reflexes in the clear light, and lack the being of the ground. In mediation, on the other hand, where every being is reflex, and every reflex a being, where becoming is reflection, and reflection becoming, real being goes forth from real nothing as from its ground.

The **transcendent** primal ground, which concentrates all-being in negative identity, is consequently no immediate being-indifference which itself immediately and without any ground turns over into difference; for its posited reflection is its solid being-in-itself, whereby it holds fast all in absolute unity; but neither is its being-in-itself an abstract essence-reflection in which the one hypostasis clarifies the other through and through; in the real nothing all being collapses **immediately**, and the light of reflection is extinguished in the night of the primal ground. As reflection goes to the ground, it is sublated in becoming; as the real nothing, the primal ground

is therefore the immediate identity of the principle and the beginning of all-being. For insofar as it is the negative presupposition of real being, the absolute other from which the absolute itself is to proceed, it is principle; insofar, on the other hand, as it has as yet grounded no being, since it is itself nothing, it finds itself in a becoming, and must therefore be posited as the absolute beginning. With the absolute beginning all begins; every distinction between principle and result as between the primitive and consecutive, every separation between the different terms of successive development must also have its ground in the primal ground; therefore all will come to be at one stroke. But as all is at once to come to be and be grounded, and the grounding of the one presupposes the going-under of the other, since it presupposes its foundation, the transcendent primal ground, as negative identity, i.e. as unity of conflicting tendencies, is in an infinite tension, unrest and fermentation.^{*)} [129]

This strife between nothing and being, which in the ground is a strife between foundation and grounding, dissolves the abstract transcendence of the primal ground. The ground lays all under itself in order to be all; its non-independence goes under in its absolute independence; it makes itself the foundation for its own grounding. Since the becoming of the ground thus consists in this, that, according to the primitive ground-movement, it sublates the real nothing in the real being, and posits itself as its own consequence, it thereby becomes determined as the **positive identity of all**, [130] i.e. as the **transcendental primal ground**.

Insofar as the transcendental primal ground presupposes its real nothing, in presupposing a ground-movement from which it results, there is in the ground nothing, whose immediate being is indeed sublated, nothing, which has indeed been made foundation; but insofar, on the other hand, as it is the transcendent primal ground that has itself become transcendental, there is nothing either, whose real being is indeed posited in and with the ground, nothing, which has indeed been grounded. If the unity of the transcendent and transcendental primal ground were immediate, there would be no ground-movement, and consequently neither ground nor grounding. The primal ground itself thus presupposes a ground-distinction, and

^{*)}Jacob Böhme has depicted this dialectical self-contradiction of the primal ground in mystical colors in his writing *De tribus principiis*: “Man findet im Urkund die allerschrecklichste und strengeste Geburt, alles Herbe, Bittere und Feuer: da kann man nicht sagen, daß es Gott sey, und ist doch der innerlich erste Quell, der in Gott dem Vater ist, nach welchem er sich einen zornigen, eifrigen Gott nennet, und derselbe Quell ist das erste *principium*, und ist Gott der Vater in seinem Urkund, daraus diese Welt sich urkundet. — In diesem *principio* stehet nichts als nur die allerschrecklichste Gebährung, die größte Aengstlichkeit, feindliche Wonne, gleich einem Schwefelgeist, und ist eben der Höllen Porten und Abgrund, darinnen Fürst Lucifer in Verlöschung seines Lichts geblieben”.

so rests in two mutually opposed foundations. But if, conversely, the negative and positive identity of the primal ground were not one and the very same ground-identity, all ground-relation would cease, and nothing would be grounded either. Since the true primal ground can first result from the presupposed opposition, there is no ground-relation that can connect the two primitive foundations; they therefore relate indifferently to each other, and are, each for itself, ungrounded, since they themselves constitute the presupposition of the ground-movement. In the duality of the principle, then, lies the absolute beginning. But since the primitive ground itself results from the dualistic principle, the two foundations contain only the ground of the primal ground, and consequently have identity and the mutual ground-relation in themselves; every foundation is thus itself the medium between the ground and the grounding. According to this development the identity of the negative and positive identity is [131] mediated, and the primitive ground determined as the **absolute** primal ground. The negative ground-identity, the real nothing, now constitutes the whole absolute primal ground, but only on the presupposition that the positive identity, the real being, is at once posited both as its posited other and also, according to the grounding, as its **sublated** other, i.e. as its foundation; likewise the positive ground-identity, the real being, will now also constitute the absolute primal ground itself, which has overcome and sublated the real nothing. The primitive ground is thus in itself neither an abstract essentiality nor an abstract determinate being, neither a real nothing nor a merely real being, but the medium of both. The posited being thus, according to the carried-through mediation, comes no more from nothing than nothing from being; but **everything must have its sufficient ground**.

According to the primitive ground-movement every distinction and opposition has vanished as ground-element in the identity of the primal ground; all is then in the ground one; the primitive, absolute ground is the only ground of all.^{*)} From this there now develops a double ground-opposition. In the first place, the primal ground is opposed to itself; it is its own other and as such itself both ground and consequence; next, it is opposed to its other, for according to its self-grounding it has as yet become merely ground; but a ground that grounds nothing **is** no ground. [132] The primitive ground-opposition is thus indeed a fundamental presupposition for the

^{*)}Devotion, as it is described by Dr. W. H. Rothe (The Doctrine of the Trinity and Reconciliation): "He (man) is gone, the soul hovers in a sea of light, gentle feelings stream through the heart, clear figures of life pass by the soul; in visions, fleeting as morning clouds, in the depths of the heart his spirit moves, but not as his etc." expresses the sinking down of subjective consciousness into the primal ground of life.

consecutive one, but without it utterly ungrounded. Only the ungrounded can be grounded; for what is immediately identical with the ground itself cannot follow from any ground-movement whatsoever, and consequently cannot be grounded either; the other of the ground must therefore be found present as something that immediately is, which does not lie in the ground at all, but is utterly distinct from it. But only that which proceeds from the ground itself can be grounded, and only that which lies in the ground can proceed from the ground: the ungrounded must nevertheless lie in the absolute ground. The primitive ground thus has in itself that which is distinct from it, and which it itself is not: it has a content.

The content is, in the first place, the ground's own and, according to the primitive ground-movement, identical with the primal ground itself; its moments then continually coincide with the ground and thereby with one another. The primal ground broods over its **esoteric** content as over an eternal mystery. But on the other hand the content is the other of the ground, which emanates from the ground, that in which the absolute ground goes out beyond itself and posits its relativity; as the ground-moments of the content thus separate themselves from the ground itself, they thereby part from one another, and step forth, each for itself, with a relative, grounded independence: the mystery of the ground opens itself out in the **exoteric** content. The esoteric and the exoteric content are in the ground one, and precisely therefore ground-distinct. From the fundamental proposition that all is one is now derived this one, **that all** in the ground **is** distinct; from here the consecutive ground-movement begins.^{*)} Insofar [133] as the exoteric content in its distinction from the absolute ground is nevertheless identical with it, it is thereby determined as the primal ground's own alteration, i.e. as an innumerability of **determinately existent grounds**; insofar as it is, on the other hand, posited as the other of the ground, it represents itself as a **grounded determinate existence**. The being-in-itself of the absolute ground is the presupposition of its being in other; its transcendence grounds its immanence; it is thus itself the medium between the determinately existent grounds and the grounded determinate existence, and mediation lies in this, that the absolute becomes relative, in order that the relative can become absolute. Since it is the primal ground itself that is altered, the absolute

^{*)}It is Professor Martensen's merit, in his "Mester Eckart", to have brought forward a cardinal point in mysticism of which, in philosophy as well as in theology, one has hitherto had only a very unclear representation, namely the relation of mystical consciousness to mystery and revelation. Taken logically, we can now locate the one-sidedness of speculative mysticism in this, that in its profound contemplation it uninterruptedly tries to reduce all the oppositions of determinate existence to the esoteric unity of the primal ground, but for that very reason is just as uninterruptedly compelled by the dialectical contradiction to return to the exoteric content.

has thereby itself become relative; everything determinately existent has its measure of the absolute in itself, and thus expresses in its peculiar delimitation the whole absolute.^{*)} But if the relative is to express the absolute, it must itself be posited with absolute relativity. As an isolated, for-itself something, the determinately existent has merely a relative ground; only on the presupposition that it is itself a moment in all the rest of determinate existence, in which the altered primal ground exhausts its whole

[134] multiplicity of relative grounds, can it be said to have the absolute ground in itself. Thus: the determinately existent has its ground in itself, and is immediately identical with it, for it is because it is; but just as immediately it is now also distinct from the ground; for it exists only on the presupposition of another determinate existence, and consequently has its ground **outside** itself. As the ground of determinate existence, the altered primal ground is immanent in determinate existence itself in that the one determinately existent grounds the other. Everything determinately existent is thus at once both ground and consequence. As consequence it arises through the going-under of an other; as ground, on the other hand, it itself goes under in order that an other can arise. But also only insofar as determinate existence expresses the primal ground's own alteration can the one determinately existent ground the other. If everything determinately existent merely had the ground immediately in itself, the multiplicity of determinate existence would express the multiplicity of the determinately existent grounds of the altered primal ground; the whole of determinate existence would then be grounded at one stroke, and the ground-movement would cease; the distinction of the ground from itself would then become so immediate that the ground-identity, and with it the ground-relation, would entirely vanish. Only in that the one determinately existent uninterruptedly passes over into the other, as the ground into the grounded, can the ground-movement be vindicated, and identity uninterruptedly result from distinction. But if, conversely, the one determinately existent merely had its ground in another determinately existent, the one would have to presuppose the other in an infinite series; distinction would then be posited so immediately in determinate existence itself that the ground-movement would lose itself in an uninterrupted change without grounding. The presupposition that the one determinately existent grounds the other then turns over just as immediately into

[135] the presupposition that everything determinately existent is immediately grounded

^{*)}One finds oneself at this standpoint when one seeks the revelation of God's essence in a blade of grass.

by the primal ground.^{*)} This abstract contradiction is mediated in the consecutive ground-movement in that **the ground-relations of determinate existence are specified**.

From the standpoint of immediate being the distinction of determinate existence shows itself as an outward, superficial diversity; here there is found only the indeterminate swarm of “somes” and “others,” which come and vanish in indifferent becoming and change, and in their separation and connection ceaselessly seek a highest goal. But as being first finds its measure in essence, so it is in turn the determination of essence to make itself the ground of being and to ground determinate existence. Regarded from the standpoint of absolute essence, the distinctions of determinate existence therefore present themselves as essential and grounded; the ground posits the determinate measure, and modality can now no longer be dissolved into pure indifference. If any something whatsoever could be laid as ground for any other whatsoever, unity itself would be groundless, and every fundamental distinction would vanish. It is then, as a consequence of this, only certain particular determinately existents that can be posited as ground-elements for certain others, and become presuppositions for their grounding; with essential measure, elective combination thus also returns, and determinate existence is grouped, according to its ground-content, in closed circles. As now the one and same ground-relation which runs through all determinate existence must specify itself into particular relations in order to become grounding, the primal ground is mediated with every determinately existent ground, and the [136] contradiction is sublated in the self-determination of the ground.

a) In the one determinately existent lies the determinate ground of another determinately existent on the presupposition that every “something” just as immediately refers itself to a circle of “others” as to itself. Insofar as the determinately existent has the ground in itself, it refers itself to itself alone, and according to this ground-relation cannot immediately contain the ground of other; but insofar as it has its ground outside itself, it has, on the other hand, an overreaching content, a sum of determinations and relations whereby it refers to certain other determinately existents, as a something that is itself posited **because of the circumstances**. The content which everything determinately existent thus has in itself, and the content it has outside itself, are then content-moments of one and the same ground-relation, and in the

^{*)}Traducianism, which seeks the ground of the children’s souls solely in the souls of the parents, is, e.g., just as one-sided as creationism, which seeks the ground of every soul immediately in God’s creative will.

mediation of these moments lies the **specific** ground. α) The ground is the identity, mediated with itself, of the grounding and the grounded; the determinately existent which is to ground, and that which is to be grounded, have, as a consequence of this, the same content; for otherness itself lies in the determinately existent which contains the ground, since its relation to other is only a moment in its relation to itself. β) But the real ground lies, on the other hand, in the fundamental distinction between the grounding and grounded; the determinately existent which is to ground must therefore conversely posit its relation to itself as a moment for the relation to other; the pure mediation of the ground then falls outside the ground-elements through [137] which it is accomplished: **every specific grounding presupposes its particular conditions**. γ) The one determinately existent thus contains the ground of the other in that there lies a whole sum of conditions between the ground and that which is to be grounded. The conditions must be presupposed as immediately given; they constitute only the discrete points in the circle of determinate existence within whose periphery the grounding is sought; as **one** such sum of determinately existents they relate indifferently to the whole ground-relation, and give themselves out as **unconditioned**. But in their unconditioned being they are merely determinately existent, and can consequently condition nothing, since their relation to themselves among one another vanishes in abstract immediacy: only in relation to the ground-relation does their immediate being-for-itself turn over into a being for other; for another ground-relation the very same moments of determinate existence would furnish other conditions; they are thus, as conditions of the ground, themselves **conditioned**. If now all conditions thus depend on the determinate ground-relation, this must thereby step forth as unconditioned; by a mere addition of conditions one procures no grounding; here one must then begin with a determinately existent that can be said to contain the ground. But only insofar as the content of the conditions is taken up as moments into the content of the determinately existent ground can a real distinction be posited between the grounding and that which is to be grounded; the peculiarity of the ground-relation is thus nevertheless conditioned by the immediate determinate existence of the conditions. Through the immanent unity of the pure mediation of the ground and the immediacy of the conditions, the ground becomes specified and [138] determined. But the ground so determined is in itself insufficient. For the closed circle of the particular conditions is only a term in the infinite series of all the other circles of determinate existence, and the specific ground-relation, which through its conditions is unconditionally brought out as a for-itself determinateness, only a

moment in the universal ground-movement. In order now to be freed from this indeterminate infinity, the determinate ground must then at the same time be posited by an unconditioned position of the primal ground itself. This specific position, whereby the primal ground fixes the relative ground over against the particular conditions, in order to sublate both as moments in the mediation of the sufficiently determined ground, now itself bears the stamp of immediacy. According to this immediacy the unconditioned position of the primal ground is then also conditioned; for its specification has the relative ground and its conditions as its outer presupposition, whereby its relation to itself vanishes in a relation to other. But the relative grounds and their conditions, which constitute the whole grounded determinate existence, are only an immediate expression of the primal ground's own alteration; the presupposition by which its specific position is conditioned it has itself presupposed; it is thus conditioned only by the conditions it has itself given itself, and thus steps forth in the sufficiently determined ground as **the absolutely unconditioned**. In the absolutely unconditioned all ground-determinations are now posited, and thereby at the same time sublated. Determinate existence with its relative grounds is only presupposition and condition for the primal ground's own self-grounding; therefore the primitive ground sublates the presuppositions it has itself posited. In the immediacy of de- [139] terminate existence its content is altered, and this alteration is a ferment whereby it consummates its own real mediation, and lets all conditions vanish as moments in the esoteric content. As determinate being rises up out of the primal ground, so must it also sink back into it; therefore the determinately existent ceaselessly goes to the ground; the relative grounds are in themselves only **semblance-grounds**. But conversely the primal ground now also sublates itself, in sublating its exoteric content; for its ground-identity is itself condition and presupposition for the development of the fundamental distinction. In the outer conditions and the immediacy of the determinately existent grounds lie the alteration and self-sublation of the primal ground; but as it must thus in turn sublate its own self-sublation in order to posit itself, the negation of the conditions shows itself as an indispensable condition for the unconditioned being-in-itself of the primal ground, for its esoteric content. Since the exoteric content is posited by the esoteric, it nevertheless always lies, in the ground, outside the ground; it has an alien ground in itself, is a merely grounded, a substrate for the true ground's mediation with itself, and must therefore be sublated. But as the outer multiplicity is sublated as conditioned and posited, it precisely thereby itself becomes a positing, and transforms itself into a real ground for the esoteric

content, which now becomes a posited and grounded. As posited and grounded, the esoteric content must in turn be sublated, and in its self-sublation lies the grounding of the exoteric. The semblance-grounds of determinate existence are all **grounded** [140] **semblances**; they are **phenomena**. Although now this mediation, whereby the transcendence and being-for-itself of the primal ground uninterruptedly posits itself as presupposition for its immanence and being for other, can in the ground never cease, it is nevertheless meaningless to wish further to hold fast the separation of the opposed ground-determinations, since they have all shown themselves to be one-sided abstractions. The immediacy regained by the sublation of the ground then steps forth with unconditioned independence. Since mediation is thus exhausted, identity again turns immediately over into distinction, and the latter into the former; the ground itself thereby steps into the background, and a new sphere opens.

Transition.

The identity of essence cannot be without distinction. For pure essence, distinction is semblance; for the primitivity of essence and ground, it is a consecutive essence, a determinate existence of relative grounds. But, as a moment vanishing in identity, distinction has not yet come into its right; therefore identity must now conversely be laid as ground for an independent development of phenomenal oppositions, and reflection itself change its character. For while the immanent, dialectical-speculative reflection predominates in essentiality, the outwardly distinguishing and fixing reflection becomes, on the other hand, predominant in B. The Sphere of the Phenomenon.

B. The Sphere of the Phenomenon.

a) The Ground-Phenomenon.

§ 24.

Matter, Form, Reflexivity.

As the phenomenon, the immediate unity of essence and semblance, is posited as [141] result of the mediation of absolute essence, the immediate falls outside the mediate. That which immediately is in the phenomenon represents itself as *matter*, the reflection falling outside matter, on the other hand, as form. This distinction is again just as immediately sublated: no matter without form — as immediately fixed: the same

matter can have the most diverse forms, and the same form contain the most diverse matters. This outer reflection-relation is expressed in the *reflexivity* of matter and form.

The dialectical transition from being to essence is an apparent advance, but an essential retreat. According to its pure immediacy, determinate existence represents itself as if it were groundless only because it needed no ground, as if it were itself the unconditioned presupposition for all movement and development, thus as the primitive. The essencelessness in being itself is thus, regarded from this side, so far from being a lack that it much rather expresses the apriority whereby determinate existence becomes able to posit essence. The movement from being to essence is thus, according to this view, progressive: **essence is a consequence of being**. But as the self-development of being ends in essence, it becomes evident that the unrest and movement which has driven being out beyond itself stems precisely from its own lack and one-sidedness; its transition into essence testifies to its origin from essence. Since being thus shows itself as the immediacy which essence itself has presupposed, in order by the sublation of this presupposition to posit itself, the movement from being to essence is **regressive**. Essence, which comes forth as the last, **is** then the [142] proper first: **being is a consequence of essence**.

The contradiction that essence cannot come forth except as a consequence of being, although being itself first comes to be as a consequence of essence, finds its solution in the mediation of the ground.

Insofar as the esoteric content of the ground presupposes an exoteric one as that which is ceaselessly posited and is to be posited, the ground itself follows from immediate being; but as it is centralized into primal ground, it sublates the immediacy of all-being in its own absolute independence, thereby follows from its own consequence, and reduces determinate existence to a consequence of the ground. The advance of being to essence is then hereby posited as a retreat to its proper source, and the ground has sublated the illusion that essence should be a consequence of immediate being. Since, however, in every true illusion there nevertheless lies a semblance of truth, this truth-semblance in the ground now also comes into its right. For it has turned out that the esoteric ground-content in itself would only be a semblance if the exoteric with its relative grounds and conditions were only semblance; if the one of these main sides vanishes, the other vanishes with it. As it is thus an illusion to wish to hold fast a for-itself primal ground, and to let immediate determinate existence come and vanish as superficial semblance, or, on the other hand, to wish to dissolve the

primal ground centralized in itself into the relative grounds and their conditions, so it is also a logical illusion if one^{*)} lets both these main sides go under in an immediacy [143] that is. If the absolutely unconditioned is to be determined as that **which** sublates the primal ground and its conditions in an identity of essence and semblance that is, then the advance of the ground-movement to “the fact itself” again becomes a retreat to the absolute primitivity of immediacy. This indissoluble, adamantine immediacy then reduces the preceding mediation to a merely outward reflection, a subjective thought-movement. All thus ends in a sterile unconditionedness from which one can come neither forward nor back. The absolutely unconditioned cannot be held fast as **posited** without at the same time presupposing the presupposing ground; it cannot gather itself together and sublata ground and conditions without at the same time having to let go of the primal ground as that which can posit other conditions; it cannot step forth as determinate without reflecting the ground-movement by which it is determined. “The fact” is thus this: that the inexhaustible primal ground always yields determinate grounds, that the stream of mediation breaks its waves on the immediacy in which it is itself crystallized. If the content of the ground is to be more closely determined, the determination can no longer be kept in the pure streaming of mediation, but must be posited and sought in the medium in which mediation has gone together with immediacy, where the identity of essence has become identical with the distinction of semblance, where the determinate ground has been absorbed into the grounded, thus in **a being, which so follows from essence that essence and the ground themselves follow along.**

The phenomenon is now this immediate, and thereby at the same time determinate, identity of essence and semblance. As distinction is sublated, reflection has vanished. Essence is no longer essence, because its separation from semblance has ceased; for the same reason semblance is no longer semblance either; both reflexes hereby take [144] on **one** stamp of immediate being. But the immediacy of identity is won through the mediation of distinction and opposition; semblance therefore presses forward anew, gives its ground-content a tinge of essentiality, and reflection thus returns again, only with changed character. Essence is determined by semblance, and has posited its content in the reflection of semblance, and semblance is determined immediately as that which gives essence its determinate shape. Essence determined by semblance now no longer keeps itself in a distant background, but is itself the semblance in which it shines; conversely, semblance is no longer the empty reflex either, which

^{*)}As Hegel. Werke 4. B. p. 110–118.

vanishes and deceives, but represents the fundamental essence: the reflection of the phenomenon thus reflects its own sublation. As immediately as the determined here coincides with the determination, so immediately do they again separate from each other. This alternation of identity and distinction, according to which that which is to be determined just as immediately has the determination in itself as outside itself, characterizes the phenomenon as that which is grounded in itself, as something that is, which is at once in the ground and yet outside the ground, as a **ground-phenomenon**, whose universal moments are **matter** and **form**.

Matter is the essence that is, the fixed presupposition of essentiality, which approaches palpable immediacy. In opposition to this, form shows itself as the pure activity of determinability, reflected in itself. Matter and form thus seem to relate indifferently toward each other.

As essential immediacy, matter is indifferent toward reflection and form; therefore it represents itself in the sphere of the phenomenon as a substrate that takes on all the determinations of being. That matter is that which is in the ground-phenomenon [145] is seen also from its reproducing at once both quality and quantity. Its ground-parts, the atoms, express the original quality-distinction, and its infinite divisibility gives us back quantitative discreteness. But matter does not come to be, although it **is** in a constant becoming; it has unchangeability in common with essence itself, although it is uninterruptedly subject to change. Since material identity is just as little able to posit its own distinction as material distinction is capable of reflecting its identity, matter, as such, remains **inert** and obscure. Matter is in itself indeterminable, and must nevertheless be determined; its obscurity negates reflection, and nevertheless presupposes the light of reflection: matter's own indeterminability thus expresses its claim to be determined by its other, i.e. by form.

Form, taken for itself, is pure determining, which has as yet determined nothing, since that which it is to determine falls outside the determination itself; it is the **clear, freely** hovering **reflection**, which in the being of matter reflects its own self-sublation. Formal identity mirrors its distinction; it thereby points out beyond itself, comes into movement, and determines its own sublation; for the same reason formal distinction reflects identity as its negation and sublates itself. Form is thereby posited as the active principle, as infinite self-movement.

In their immediate opposition matter and form are, each for itself, equally finite and non-independent. If matter could not determine itself because its identity and distinction fell indifferently apart from each other, neither can pure abstract form

[146] consummate its self-determination, since its distinction and identity uninterruptedly sublate each other. The unity of material and formal distinction is first the true determinate distinction; for insofar as distinction has a material side, it cannot be sublated as a semblance vanishing in identity, and insofar as it at the same time has a formal side, it points out beyond itself, and determines itself to identity. As matter without form is a shadow, so form outside matter is a semblance; only through their mutual affirmation do they both obtain independence. Matter's negation of all form is its own essential form. By keeping itself as the indeterminate over against the determining form, it gives itself a determinateness. Its indifference toward form is its own indifference toward itself; when it then takes up form and lets itself be determined, it takes up no more than what it already has; form expresses only matter's own independence. On the other hand form, when it keeps itself in its independent distinction over against matter, becomes reflected in its otherness. But now form-identity is precisely determined as that which in all distinction and opposition wins itself; matter is thereby posited as the other sublated in the negativity of form, i.e. as form's own independent subsistence.

This developed identity of matter and form shows that the one does not ground the other; for since there is no transition, there can be no ground-relation either. As in the ground itself there is no matter, so in matter there is no ground either, and as form cannot follow from matter, since it is itself matter's own immediate presupposition, so matter cannot follow from form either, since abstract form presupposes the being of
[147] matter. The subsistence of matter and form in and through their phenomenal identity is just as immediately a subsistence in phenomenal distinction. Matter, which in its independence has sublated form, is thereby already formed, just as form, which has posited matter as its sublated other, is materialized. Both are then at one stroke in the ground-phenomenon itself.

If the phenomenal identity is more closely determined, it shows itself at once both as essential and as unessential. It is essential to matter to have a determining form; but which determinate form it is to have is as yet quite unessential to it; likewise it is essential to form to be materialized; but which matter form is to determine is entirely indifferent, since the determination of matter depends solely and alone on form. Insofar now as matter is reflected in form as in its negation, it thereby becomes delimited; but insofar as it itself subsists in form, it just as immediately sublates its non-being in being, and is posited as **determinate** matter, whereby form is then also fixed into immediately **determinate** form. This determinateness, with which all

mediation has ceased, lies in the **surface**, which precisely shows itself as the pure identity and distinction of matter and form. In superficial determinateness matter coincides with its form; for immediate form is the surface of matter; in the surface matter ceases, and vanishes as semblance in the being of form; as the determinateness of matter, the surface is matter's negative, its pure otherness, i.e. form itself. But on the other hand superficial form must now also vanish as reflex in the being of matter. At the standpoint of being, all determinateness is only a limit which lets the delimiting fall outside the delimited; but the phenomenon, whose determinateness has through the reflection of essentiality been raised to the immediacy of being, on [148] the other hand identifies the sides of the limit, and thereby posits its surface for itself. The surface is consequently matter's own determinate being; so that it is not matter's semblance, but matter itself as that which is, that shows itself in the surface in the most determinate way:^{*)} the superficial determinateness of matter and form is then, as the posited identity of both, immanent and essential.

But since mediation has vanished, superficial identity just as immediately turns over into distinction, whereby the posited determinateness shows itself as unessential. Matter, which is indifferent toward its determinate form, at the same time falls outside the surface, and thereby shows itself as an unformed mass which can receive innumerable other superficial determinations. On the other hand form, as the **moving, articulating** principle, cannot acquiesce in the surface's determinateness as something that is either; for since formal identity reflects its own distinction, it must, as a consequence of this, reduce its superficiality fixed in matter to moment and presupposition for other determinate forms; only by sublating the posited determinatenesses as reflexes in an innumerability of form-determinations can form sustain its pure self-determining. Since every determinate surface can thus be exchanged to infinity [149] with any other whatsoever, the superficial distinction between matter and form is posited, and the determinateness of the surface reduced to a pure unessentiality.

This distinction between matter and form shows itself still more determinately when it is apprehended in relation to the surface's own essential and unessential side. For when matter uninterruptedly tends to remove the surface's essential determi-

^{*)}The senses of sight and of feeling give us the surface from two opposite sides. Sight properly sees only the form, not the matter; when we nonetheless seem to see the matter itself, this comes from the reflex of matter being sublated in the being of form. Feeling, on the other hand, refers itself immediately to matter, not to form; we only seem to feel the form, because its reflex is sublated in the determinate matter. If sight posits form as a premise from which one infers to matter, feeling conversely posits matter as the premise from which one infers to form. That the inference as such does not come to consciousness stems from reflection being sublated in the phenomenal identity.

nateness, and as a “rudis indigestaque moles” to sink into its chaos, it lies, on the other hand, in the forming and shaping principle to posit superficial determinateness as a moment preserved in the immanent formation, or to convert the surface’s unessentiality into its essentiality. Although the mass withdraws from the determinate surface into the indeterminable, it nevertheless cannot escape form, since the latter itself reaches out beyond every fixed determinateness. Since form thus first becomes essential and immanent by sublating its superficial distinction, the mass, in withdrawing from the surface, falls on every point to the essential form, and is thereby posited as its **stuff**. By giving itself as stuff, matter is in every respect subjected to form. Insofar as the surface is still indifferent and unessential, the indeterminate stuff resembles the mass formless in itself; but since it is form itself which, by sublating its own superficiality, has penetrated the mass, and masters the stuff, the essentiality of the surface is hereby at the same time posited; for the formation of the stuff consists precisely in this, that the form and the surface are determined. The stuff’s essential form is superficial, since it lies in the stuff’s own elasticity that it cannot immediately [150] have any fixed determinateness. The superficiality of form is to be posited as the stuff’s pure formability; but already in that matter is determined as stuff, it has, as such, the determining form in itself; the specific expression of the determining form is immediate form-determinateness, surface; consequently superficial form is also essential.

The all-sided determination of stuff and form develops more closely thus: α) Stuff and form are immediately identical; the immediacy of identity is pure indeterminateness, and this indeterminateness is the ground of the surface or of determinateness. With grounding, mediation returns; as identity posits itself as ground, it sublates its own immediacy, form comes into movement, and fixes the surface as the result and consequence of the immanent formation. But when the consequence is posited, the ground-movement ceases, and the immanent formation is stamped out on the surface. The stuff itself is hereby determined from a double side: partly it becomes, namely, in itself infinitely determined by the immanent form, and thereby raised to the **content of form**, partly it becomes determined from the side of finitude, that is to say, delimited by the superficial form. Since now the sides of finitude and infinity, according to the sublated reflection, no longer fall outside each other, since the unessential and superficial form immediately expresses the essential and immanent, the stuff has, in the ground, no other content-determination than that which shows itself on

the surface^{*)}. This unity of both main sides of the formation is not a tautological “*Einerlei*”, for mediation has stepped between; but just as little is it to be regarded as the reflex of a fundamental opposition, for the presupposed mediation is sublated; in the immediate coincidence of both sides lies, then, the **specific peculiarity** of the [151] determinate stuff. β) The one stuff steps forth with its peculiarity over against the other; as the peculiarity of the stuff is given with the determinate form, so conversely the specific determinateness of form is fixed in the stuff. Since the distinction between the heterogeneous stuffs is posited superficially, the separation still shows itself only as outward and indifferent; form seems to obtrude itself on the stuff, to come to it from outside, in order to make a divorce between stuff and stuff. Nonetheless superficial form is already presupposed as the immanent formation’s own determinateness; form-separation therefore begins just as much from within, so that form itself in every peculiar stuff presupposes a distinctive content. How every stuff is in itself determined as the content of form, it can then show only in relation to another peculiar stuff of which the same holds. Insofar as the separation is outward, the relation can only be determined superficially; the surfaces of the stuffs touch each other. But in the medium of touching the one stuff immediately coincides with the other; every touching produces a superficial re-forming, in sublating the outer distinction; since now the surface itself is the immanent form’s own determinateness, every superficial re-forming at the same time produces an inner transformation: the heterogeneous stuffs interpenetrate one another^{*)}. Since all interpenetration is only an all-sided [152] touching, material distinction is hereby vindicated; the one particle falls outside the other, so that the stuffs are not confounded, and do not flow together in chaotic indeterminability; but insofar as the infinite touching is an interpenetration, and thereby at the same time a transformation, form itself is posited as the sundering, articulating principle, and materialism sublated. From this mutual specification of matter and form it now becomes evident that, as form by means of matter becomes distinct from itself, and thereby separated into a multiplicity of finite forms, so conversely the

^{*)}In this presupposition all plastic art is grounded.

^{*)}These two modes of view already began to assert themselves in the old Ionian philosophy of nature. The mechanical tendency proceeded from a consideration of the multiplicity that is, and explained the origin of things from the separation and connection of the primal qualities, unchangeable in themselves, i.e. from the all-sided touching of the constituents. But by this hypothesis the qualities’ own origin itself became just as inexplicable as their superficial sundering and union. The dynamic philosophy, on the other hand, let the qualities’ own determinateness vanish as moments in the infinite transformation, without being able to give any sufficient explanation of the essential and phenomenal distinction of things. The one-sidedness of both theories is sublated in the dialectical identity of all-sided touching and immanent transformation.

obscure, indifferent unity of matter becomes separated and sundered by means of form. The form-unity, infinite in its pure formation, which would everywhere raise every opposition into a fleeting reflected gleam of the light of identity, is bound and fixed in the dark, inert mass, finds in the stuff it penetrates ceaseless barriers, and thus falls out from itself into a series of material forms. In matter's outward, indifferent difference, then, lies the ground of finitude. But regarded from the other side, matter shows itself at the same time as the indifference which effaces all distinction. As matter and mass, the ground-stuff is only one, and like itself at all points; form, on [153] the other hand, as the pure self-separation of essentiality, is the reflection-movement which drives the mass-like chaos over into distinction, sunders, articulates and shapes it. It is the one, infinite form that makes matter into the many particular matters, into **one** discrete content of heterogeneous stuffs: the finite determinateness of matter has its ground in form. Just as matter, then, from its side is the medium between the determinate form's identity with itself and distinction from other forms (a medium which immediately vanishes in the determinateness of form), so form in turn is the medium between matter's specific unity with itself and distinction from other matters; hereby the ground-phenomenon, indeterminate in itself, is sundered and split into a **multiplicity of determinate phenomena**.

The determinate form's reflection in itself is its being in matter, and the determinate matter's being-in-itself its reflection in form. The reflection of both in each other shows itself, then, just as immediately as their independent being-for-itself, since the reflexes from both sides are removed as vanishing moments; conversely their being-for-itself thereby at the same time vanishes as the reflex of their being in each other: they are, each for itself, **reflexive**. This unity of relation and reflection is again, when it is more closely determined, to be regarded as a) **pure**, b) **conditioned** and c) **unconditioned reflexivity**. a) According to pure reflexivity it is enough for the determinate matter to have a determinate form; as form is thus bound in matter because of the immediacy of determination, so it is just as immediately freed to being-for-itself and independence by virtue of the outwardness of reflection. With [154] regard to superficial formation, the one and same form can be imparted to utterly heterogeneous matters^{*)}, and as regards essential form, the same matter is able to undergo the most diverse metamorphoses, insofar, namely, as it is superficial re-forming that, according to an infinitely all-sided touching, brings about transformation, and insofar as the peculiarity of the stuff is solely and alone **to be** expressed in the deter-

^{*)}The same form of Jupiter can, e.g., be expressed in a statue of clay, plaster, bronze, marble etc.

minateness of form. When the stuff by a change of form becomes another stuff, the otherness lies not in matter, which on its side continues to be like itself, but in form. The result is that in the same degree as phenomenal **identity** has won independence, **phenomenal separation and diversity** has also been **made independent**^{**}). Since the phenomenal separation of matter and form nevertheless presupposes identity, they themselves determine their mutual specific determinateness; this specification comes to appearance in conditioned reflexivity. For insofar as form itself is both immanent and superficial, the determinate phenomena are separated from each other in that their essential continuity is reflected in an unessential discreteness; phenomenal distinction is only a semblance-distinction, since the one phenomenon can by transformation become the other. But on the other hand essential continuity nevertheless comes to appearance only in discreteness; the independence of the phenomena depends on their phenomenal distinction; in this independence the semblance of discreteness is [155] essentially immediate, and thereby at the same time material; continuity, on the other hand, which cannot posit itself as determinate phenomenon, remains unessential and formal. According to the immediacy of discreteness, phenomenal being-for-itself is posited as reflection in other phenomena; every form-distinction is superficial, indifferent and changeable. The discrete centers remain standing as substrates whose alternating forms are imparted from outside. But when every phenomenon fetches its form from outside, and outside the given phenomenon nothing can be given other than phenomena, then phenomenon is uninterruptedly determined by phenomenon; their exclusion is an assimilation, so that the outwardness according to which the phenomenon had to fetch its determination from other phenomena is thus an otherness which lies in the determinate phenomenon's own determination. Hereby the discrete form is posited as immanent, so that every phenomenon can now be said to determine its own form. But in this way phenomenal being-for-itself is also again transformed into a being for other, for the phenomenon determines itself only by determining other phenomena. The result is thus this: every phenomenon is determined by other phenomena, so that it is thereby posited as a stuff indifferent toward its superficial form; but just as immediately the phenomenon is determined in and through itself; it is a content specified in itself, which sets formation its determinate measure: the mutual non-dependence of form and stuff and their reflection in each other, or their reflexivity, is all-sidedly conditioned.

c) The phenomenon is determined only insofar as it comes to appearance (for what

^{**}) Ice, water, steam can show themselves as the same stuff in different forms.

does not come to appearance cannot be a phenomenon either); but the phenomenon
 [156] comes to appearance only in the superficial form, in other phenomena; its ground is dissolved into sheer conditions; the independence of the phenomenon is thus negative; it shows itself immediately as non-independence. But this non-independence is in turn negative; every phenomenon sublates the conditions in its own ground; the ground itself vanishes in phenomenal independence, and posits its phenomenon unconditionedly.

Distinction is now driven to its immediate extreme. Form-separation is material, for it is outward and immediate; but matter is at the same time all-sidedly formed, since all distinction has become superficial. The superficiality of the forms is nothing other than **their** material being. In every determinate form the determinateness of matter is now at the same time posited so immediately that every change sublates the independence of the phenomenon. Reflexivity is consequently unconditioned. The phenomenon can be altered; therein shows itself its conditioned independence; but it is altered only when the given conditions are sublated and new ones have entered; the changed conditions give themselves each time as moments in the absolute determinateness of the unconditioned. As the conditions are, so too is the unconditionedness in which they are sublated, and so too is the phenomenon determined. Since now there can be no phenomenal change without changed conditions, and the changed conditions are always concentrated in the unconditioned, the transition from phenomenon to phenomenon is a transition from the unconditioned to the unconditioned. This transition is formal, tautological and untrue; distinction vanishes as a semblance, since the unconditioned is always identical with itself. But just as immediately it
 [157] represents itself as outward and material; the transition happens by a leap, since the one unconditioned is indifferent toward the other; this material separation vanishes again as semblance in the essential identity of the unconditioned, and so on to infinity. Since matter and form, as a consequence of this, can no longer be separated, they must necessarily lose their particular significance, and be absorbed into a world of independent, freely emerging **phenomena**.

b) Existence.

§ 25.

Thing, Properties, Appearance.

As the determinate phenomenon steps out of the inwardness of the ground and

comes to *existence*, its reflection-in-itself becomes an equally immediate being-for-itself, as its reflection-in-other becomes a being-for-other; it thereby comes to subsist as the *thing*, which has its *properties*. The properties show themselves to be the thing's own existence: the thing makes its appearance in the properties; conversely, the properties vanish in the thing's subsistence: the thing's being in its properties is only *apparent*. This existential antinomy between immanence and transcendence is sublated in *appearance*. The opposition between the primitive and consecutive essence has now developed into an opposition between

the unity of the ground that is in itself and the manifoldness of the independent phenomena. This opposition is absolute; for as it is sublated, it is posited, and each time it vanishes, it comes to appearance again. In mediation the ground has its independence, but the mediating ground-movement must always yield a result that has being, in which immediacy returns. The transition from the sufficient ground to the independent phenomenon is an interchange of mediation and phenomenal immediacy which continues to infinity. Phenomenal independence is grounded in the sublated mediation; but the sublation of mediation lies in mediation itself; mediation thus becomes what overreaches, sublates its own sublation, and reduces the phenomenon to a moment vanishing in the independence of the ground. The identity of the independence of ground and of phenomenon is to be posited as **existence**. [158]

The existential unity of ground and phenomenon is in the first place immediate, and as such phenomenal. When the ground has separated itself, as the absolute primal ground being-in-itself, from the determinately existent and relative ground, when in this self-separation it has presupposed and sublated its determinate amount of outer conditions, then it joins all its extremes together and fixes itself as the sufficiently determined ground. The sufficient ground is, in the sum total of its sublated conditions, unconditioned; its ground-elements are sundered into particular determinateness, in order to reflect one another in mutual subsistence and negative being-for-itself; the sufficient ground thereby itself comes to appearance in striking immediacy: **it exists as the independent** phenomenon.

On the other hand, the immediacy with which the matter and form of the ground-phenomenon fall outside one another is only a reflex of the overreaching mediation of the ground. Although matter seems to be indifferent to all the determinations of form, this indifference is nevertheless only an essential unessentiality. As matter is not of itself, so it cannot be in itself either; it must become the foundation for **the** determining form, and thereby shows itself to be a mediation-moment that [159]

belongs to the ground. The absolute primal ground itself needs the manifoldness of the phenomena in order to ground its own unity therein; it presupposes the whole superficial play of heterogeneous stuffs and material forms in order therein to clarify its own immanent, affirmative independence: **the phenomenon exists therefore as a reflected semblance of the existing ground.**

Ground and phenomenon thus have, in consequence of this, the same content; the distinction is only formal: **all** moments in the absolute are to be determined as ground-moments, for there is no phenomenal determinateness that is not posited by the ground, just as little as there is any ground-determination that must not also show itself as phenomenal. If absolute existence is considered from the principal side of mediation, then the absolute itself exists as the esoteric content of the primal ground, in which the phenomenal oppositions vanish as immanent reflexes; if absolute existence is determined, on the contrary, from the other principal side as sublated mediation, as reflected being, then the absolute itself exists in the exoteric content of the ground, in the outer manifoldness of the independent phenomena, so that the primitive essence-fullness is absorbed in the consecutive essence.

But in this existential identity lies an existential distinction, according to which [160] each of the principal sides itself is to be posited as absolute existence. 1) **The** absolute exists as phenomenon.

In the independent phenomenon the sufficient ground exhausts its determinate content; its dark pregnant inwardness becomes clear, everything comes to appearance in superficial immediacy. Since all the conditions of the phenomenon are sublated in its unconditioned independence, the existing phenomenon refers itself to its own relative center, as to a midpoint absolute in itself, and rests on itself alone. With the same unconditioned independence one phenomenon steps forth after the other, and since each of these has its sufficient ground in itself, the absolute centrality of the primal ground vanishes in the relative centers of the innumerable phenomena. The being-for-itself of the phenomena makes up their immediate unconditioned existence; every phenomenon comes to appearance in its own light; its relation to other phenomena, which was to show its infinite conditionedness, is an unessential semblance, since the conditions are everywhere sublated in unconditioned independence. The mutual relationship of the phenomena, their being for one another, is then, considered from this side, only an external reflection. But phenomenal being-for-itself is just as immediately a being for other; reflection in itself is itself superficial; it is essentially a reflection in other, since it is phenomenal. According to the im-

mediate reflection-in-itself of the phenomenon, the conditions are sublated in its unconditioned being-for-itself; according to the immediate reflection-in-other, the unconditioned being-for-itself dissolves into sheer conditions. Only in this abrupt, unmediated interchange does superficial existence come to appearance. The form of the absolute's existence in the series of phenomena is therefore the infinite progress. The absolute as such cannot exist in any single phenomenon, for the unconditioned independence of the phenomenon immediately turns over into non-independence; [161] just as little can an absolute existence be expressed in the sum of the phenomena, for every existing phenomenon is burdened with the same essential contradiction. Phenomenal existence is thus infinitely fragmentary; it must incessantly begin over again, and the progress that was to contain the new beginning is only a semblance-progress, in which phenomenal non-independence everywhere comes to appearance. As the determinately existent had to perish because in its immediacy of being it lacked all ground, so the existing phenomenon must now also perish, because it would sublate the absolute ground and exhaust it in superficial determinateness. The more clearly the particular independence emerges, the more sharply the transition shows itself in which the independent finds its dissolution. Now as the absolute thus seems to run off into sheer relativity and to scatter its content into peripheral centers, phenomenal existence at the same time betrays its infinite negativity; the primal ground steps forth anew as the leveling principle, and takes back its absolute centrality.

2) The absolute exists as ground.

Only in relation to the immediate independence of the phenomena does the primal ground come to appearance as the all-dissolving ground; but everything that it thereby dissolves it has itself posited; it therefore only takes back its own, in order to affirm itself. It has already been shown that the esoteric and exoteric content of the ground reflect each other mutually; the esoteric content is in itself ground-identity, and thus has at one stroke all distinction-moments in its inner infinity, all principles of determinate existence in its one ground-principle; but in this its immediate primitiveness the primal ground has as yet no existence; it is as [162] yet only presupposed as the real beginning of all-being, as essential becoming, as originality itself. In contrast to this, the exoteric content presents an evolution of the thoroughgoing distinction. Here unity is posited in the form of manifoldness, here is a sporadic plurality of principles and relative beginnings, an innumerability of determinately existent grounds and finite conditions. It has further been shown that each of the terms in the central opposition must itself be presupposed as absolute, in

order that the ground-content, doubled in itself, can be developed on all sides. The absolute primal ground is, in its original essentiality, infinite mediation of abstract identity, negative, transcendent unity, and abstract diversity, negative, transcendental manifoldness. This mediation grounds itself in its own primitive movement. — Only as the primal ground takes back its concrete unity through the exposed manifoldness is its esoteric content developed; but in order that the many-sided sundering can be realized, the exoteric process of finite grounds and conditions must be presupposed as the medium through which the return incessantly takes place. Therefore the consecutive ground-movement must also complete its circuit, and its exoteric content be uninterruptedly restored through the medium of the primal ground. Were the exoteric progress of relative grounds and separate conditions only a fleeting semblance, did it not contain an absolutum relative in itself, then the primal ground would lack the real medium for its immanent explication, then it would be without the otherness of discrete being in which the pure light of essentiality and originality could refract its rays; but conversely, if the primitive ground-movement perished in the exoteric and consecutive one, if the refracted rays were not cast back again into the depth of [163] the primal ground, then the ground-mystery would remain in eternal darkness, then the original unity would have to be broken off in the alteration of the ground, and the absolute deny itself.

In phenomenal existence the exoteric mediation of the ground has now culminated. The rich variations of manifoldness have come to appearance; the positive immediacy has fixed itself in the relative centers of the existing phenomena; the exoteric ground-content is posited with absolute superficiality, and thereby presupposed as what is absolute in itself. But this immediate positivity is at the same time infinite negativity. α) In order to exist, the one independent phenomenon must presuppose the existence of the other; if there is one single existing phenomenon, then there is at the same time an infinite manifoldness. The independent phenomenon thus reflects in its immediate existence an innumerability of independent phenomena. That every phenomenon subsists in itself will then mean that it subsists in the subsistence of all the others. β) But the reflection of the phenomena in one another is superficial; the relative centers repel one another mutually; the one phenomenon is immediately the negation of the other; insofar as the one exists, the other cannot exist; if the one phenomenon therefore subsists in the subsistence of the others, then it subsists eo ipso in its own non-subsistence. The negation from which existential immediacy proceeds is itself an existing immediacy from which negation results. γ) This contradiction does not find

its resolution in the consecutive process, which on the contrary must be regarded as its infinite continuation. The essential thing is that existential diversity comes to appearance; but as it becomes phenomenal, it becomes at the same time immediate and thereby unessential. It is thus only its unessential side that can vanish in the dissolving ground, and it is this dissolution by which the primal ground sublates [164] its alteration and returns into itself. Only this return is the true, essential advance. The pleromatic center has, during its inner self-separation, struck into the relative centers, because the ground first comes to true subsistence in existence. But in phenomenal existence the primal ground is lost and its centrality sublated. The pleromatic centrality therefore subsists as the phenomenal center subsists, i.e. it subsists in its non-subsistence, it exists in the negation of its existence. Only as it consummates this negation does it affirm all existential moments, and thereby posit itself as what exists in itself, as the overreaching centrality, as the primitive presupposition of the subsisting phenomena, as the existential **depth**. 3) The absolute exists in the mediation of the central-existence and the phenomenal progress.

The manifoldness veiled in the unity of the primal ground is a negative identity which sublates itself in order to posit its distinction. That all-identity has in itself infinite distinction, and that conversely manifoldness and infinite distinction are reflected in themselves by reflecting identity, is shown by pure mediation. Nevertheless this mediation is only the form of the absolute's infinite self-determining, and as such without any determinateness; it is only formal. But formal determining posits and presupposes determinateness; otherness emerges out of the unity of reflection, and form deposits its content; manifoldness is therefore to be determined and posited as manifoldness, and the distinctions are to be stamped out in their diversity; conversely the ground-unity is also to be posited and articulated in its own concrete self-reflection, so that all distinction-moments return and vanish in it as real semblance, as immanent [165] reflexes: the surface is to be reflected in the depth, and the depth in the surface. As now the outer manifoldness, reflected in itself, becomes **posited**, the immediate all-unity is at the same time **sublated**; the ground falls to the ground in the existing phenomena; the reflection in itself of ground-identity vanishes as reflection in manifoldness. Here is therefore an essential transition, a **universal beginning**, by which phenomenal manifoldness sublates the indeterminate ground-unity and begins the exoteric progress. But on the other hand the reflection in itself of manifoldness through the sublated ground-identity is only the presupposition for the self-reflection of the all-unity in the sublated manifoldness. When the primal unity is **posited** according to

its concrete identity with itself, then the outer infinity of the existing phenomena has at one stroke **vanished** from the series, and the determinate distinction-reflexes must be sought in the clear depth of the ground-existence. The immanent central-existence therefore results from the return of the phenomena into the ground; it proceeds from phenomenal conditions, and thus itself has a **relative beginning**. **In the mediation of the universal and relative beginning is the thoroughgoing and true real beginning first to be posited.** a) Every existing phenomenon is burdened with the contradiction that its existence is at once infinitely conditioned by the universal mediation of the absolute, and yet in its immediate determinateness restricted to a peculiar circle of finite conditions. That every phenomenon exists in unconditioned being-for-itself thus follows from the fact that the one phenomenal circle of conditions is limited by the other; the specific ground-relations break off the mediation of the

[166] universal ground to infinity, and **the** relative, partial beginnings reduce the universal beginning to an external reflection. But precisely thereby the partial beginning becomes a self-contradiction; in the phenomenal series: ... A, B, C.... C cannot begin except on the presupposition of B; the circle of conditions in which C exists is itself conditioned by the circle of conditions in which B has its existence; B again presupposes A, and so on to infinity. Could but one single phenomenon begin its existence, then all the rest would begin at the same time: every immediately determinate beginning is therefore immediately conditioned by the universal beginning. Now as the phenomenal series is split apart into outer manifoldness, into partial beginnings in which there is no universal beginning, so the universal beginning itself is only presupposed as the veiled manifoldness of the ground-unity, in which there is no partial beginning, because no existential distinction has yet been posited. The transition from the universal to the partial beginning can nevertheless not take place by a leap; as the phenomenal series sinks as semblance into the essence of the primal ground without being able to begin, it presupposes its presupposing principle, i.e. it posits all its partial beginnings back into the concrete inwardness of the universal beginning, and presupposes the latter as predisposed to posit the specific distinction. Insofar as the determinate phenomenon begins its existence on the presupposition of separate conditions, externality and otherness go back into an infinite regress, and the conditions of the conditions flee away into the indeterminable; but insofar as this external reflection in the series of partial beginnings also has its presupposition in the predisposed universal beginning, all outer phenomenal conditions are reflected

[167] in the central-existence's own depth. The immanent reflection of the conditions in

the universal beginning and their external reflection in the partial beginnings of the series are therefore one and the same reflection. For an existence to begin, it is then required that its peculiar conditions be found present in the series of phenomena, and next that the interruption and absence lying in phenomenal otherness be integrated by the essential presence of the immanent conditions of the universal beginning, which are presupposed in existential centrality. As the conditions and the relative grounds are, so too is the central-existence in its primal ground disposed to posit the new beginning; but conversely the outer specific conditions and relative grounds are the central-existence's own presuppositions, by whose sublation it posits the unconditioned. The finite grounds and phenomenal conditions spin themselves out as a tautological continuation of the one relative existence in the other; but only when the lightning of centrality strikes down into the circle of conditions is the real beginning posited, and a new existence emerges out of the stream of mediation. The central-existence now has its contradiction in this, that it is at once to contain the universal beginning specified in itself, the mediation of all conditions in one absolute unconditionedness, and thus to subordinate the phenomenal progress to itself, while it must nevertheless also presuppose the immediate separation of the phenomena, in order by their sublation to gain in existential substance, and be disposed to continue the series of phenomena. This contradiction finds its resolution in the immanent self-movement by which the ground-existence uninterruptedly releases its otherness. The self-development of the absolute into existence is a self-continuing explication of the double content of the primal ground. As the ground-unity discloses its mystery [168] and expends its content in the cycle of the phenomena, then this content shows itself in the first place as its **own** content; for it has now become clear how it dissolves the existence of the phenomena in order to take the specified content-moments back into its own existential self-reflection; next, it is an **other** content, for it has likewise been shown that the dissolution of the determinate phenomena yields stuff and material for other phenomena in the exoteric series. The "**becoming**" of immediacy is posited in the central-existence as a moment that is sublated in the "**has been**" of reflection, while on the other hand, as regards the phenomenal progress, the essential "has been" shows itself as a vanishedness that must constantly be replaced anew in the immediate becoming of the partial beginning; when the existing phenomenon, in accordance with its pure superficiality, uninterruptedly takes its beginning from other, partly from other phenomena, and partly from the depth of the primal existence, the central-existence takes, through the presupposed sublation of otherness, i.e. through that

of the partial beginnings, its immanent real beginning from itself; what is therefore, with respect to the series, infinite regress and progress, that is, with respect to the central-existence, infinite self-deepening and self-development. By this immanent self-development the central-existence vindicates its absolute dignity, and subordinates the phenomenal series to itself, so that the dialectical pulse of centrality beats in every existing phenomenon. The double foundation of the primal ground required for its development an esoteric and exoteric mediation, a primitive and consecutive
 [169] ground-movement. By virtue of the doubleness of the content, mediation and formation have therefore become doubled, and this developed form-distinction is posited as a moment in the one absolute formation. The content shapes its own opposition out of the unity of the ground; the opposition is therefore not immediately dualistic. But the same ground-content that in formation posits its many-sidedly developed identity at the same time develops this content-identity in a double formation. The primitive and consecutive ground-movement are both absolute in their mutual reflection. By this immanent form-distinction the content becomes distinct from itself. The external form-distinction leaves the content unchanged in what is essential; the finite form presupposes a given content as stuff and material; but the immanent form, which penetrates, forms and determines all content-moments, thereby gives the content its absolute determinateness, i.e. it determines it as its determinate content, so that the one content can be separated from the other only by virtue of form. If absolute existence therefore has a formation reduplicated in itself, if its development has two immanent primal forms, then it also has, in its concrete content-identity, two opposed contents.

Only in the movement of mediation can the central-existence separate itself from the phenomenal existences; but as the many-sided existential mediation has now been carried through, immediacy returns. The central-existence exists in the mediation of all the presuppositions of the absolute, in the identity of all phenomenal and immanent conditions; it exists immediately as the absolutely unconditioned. But the same holds of phenomenal existence; it too takes its real beginning in all presuppositions of the absolute; its separate circle of conditions is likewise mediated
 [170] through all the immanent conditions of the central-existence; it too exists in its immediacy as the absolutely unconditioned. Absolute form is then, in consequence of this, posited in every content, and conversely every content is peculiarly determined by the many-sidedly determining form. Thus the double ground-content, by virtue of the one determining form, taken immediately, is one and the same content, and yet

it is just as immediately an altogether distinct content because of the innumerable form-determinations posited in absolute formation. The absolute is in all formations always identical with itself, and therefore one single unconditioned in itself; but if the exoteric content is unconditionally sublated in the esoteric by virtue of the immediate, existential unity, then the esoteric has just as unconditionally vanished in the exoteric because of the immediate, existential manifoldness and distinction. As absolute unconditionedness makes its appearance in the central-existence, it breaks through at the same stroke in all relative existences, and sparkles in innumerable centers. In this immediate identity of central and phenomenal existence **that which** exists makes its appearance, partly as the **thing in itself**, partly as the **things in their** properties.

According to its immediate being-in-itself, the central-existence is to be held fast as the abstract essence-existence, as blind transcendence, the pure negativum of all phenomena; in consequence of this it cannot then be determined more precisely either; for all determinations vanish as reflexes of an outer manifoldness that does not concern its own essential reflection in itself at all; according to this abstract being-for-itself, that which exists is therefore posited as the transcendent, as the thing in itself (“Das Ding an sich”). When it is said that the thing in itself cannot be [171] cognized, this means in other words that there is nothing at all in it to cognize, since it excludes all distinction and relation; the thing in itself is thus to be regarded as the existing tautology, by which the proposition: $A \text{ is } = A$ is transformed into: $A \text{ exists } = A$. That the thing in itself, despite this tautology, nevertheless does not altogether vanish and become no thing at all, it owes to its relation to the denied phenomena. As unity and identity belong to the thing in itself, so manifoldness and distinction, on the contrary, fall over onto the phenomena: these are then not merely distinct from the thing, but also from one another. But on the other hand the existing identity is always conditioned by the existing distinction; the thing in itself is itself determined by the fact that it excludes all phenomenal determinations. The distinguishing reflection by which the phenomena are separated from the thing in itself is therefore the very same by which they separate themselves from one another. That which gives every phenomenon existing identity, the unconditioned being-for-itself that keeps itself indifferent toward every relation to the other phenomena, that which exists in the phenomenon, which remains when we abstract from all relative determinations, is consequently also a thing in itself. If identity is to exist unconditionally in and for itself, then distinction must be excluded; but by this exclusion distinction itself is fixed

in immediate being-for-itself, and thereby comes to exist as immediate identity. The one thing in itself thus becomes at one stroke a manifoldness of things in themselves.

The reflection of the thing in its being-for-itself reflects at the same time its being in other. This other is now itself a thing; that the thing is reflected in itself as in its
[172] other will then mean that it is reflected in another thing. Insofar as those that exist are, in their manifoldness, things, they keep themselves, each one, in the extreme of distinction and opposition; but as they are determined by determining one another mutually, they at the same time identify their existential distinction: in this mutual reflection the things **have properties**.

The property is in the first place the thing's **own** determinateness: the thing's determination in relation to other comes to appearance in the property as its own immediate self-determination: as the property is, so too is the thing constituted; next, the property is an expression of the thing's determinateness in relation to the property of another thing. What holds of the things themselves then holds also of the properties: their reflection-in-other is their own reflection-in-itself. According to this double reflection, the things and the properties each by themselves have a certain independence, a relative subsistence.

Everything that exists is always a something; but not every something can for that reason be said to exist. What "something" is in immediate being, that the **thing** is as the phenomenal essence; **something** is, as such, an immediacy that has not yet run through reflection; the **thing**, on the other hand, is an essence-existence whose immediacy reflects the sublated reflection; something is, as the determinately existent, the pure negation of **other**; the **thing**, on the other hand, in identity with its constitution, is nevertheless distinct from the **property**; something **is** quality, but the thing has property; therein lies the distinction.

A more essential likeness obtains between the thing and the **phenomenon**. The existing phenomenon is the immediate unity of thing and properties; insofar as the thing is phenomenon, it can be dissolved into matters, and run through a series of
[173] finite changes: **the thing consists of matters**^{*)}; but the phenomenon nevertheless stands below the thing in existential development, for phenomenal unconditionedness has not yet reflected the **essential distinction of the thing and the properties**. Because of its pure superficiality, phenomenal existence cannot lose a single one of its determinations without being at the same time altered thereby; the phenomenon is in this respect a *Noli me tangere*; between thing and properties, on the other

^{*)}Hegel's *Logik*, 2tes Buch. p. 155 (Werke 4de Band) and J. L. Heiberg's *speculative Logik* p. 51.

hand, there obtains the separation that the thing itself is posited as the essential, while the properties in their mutual diversity show themselves as the unessential; therefore the thing can very well lose one of its properties without therefore being dissolved at once^{**}). That the thing has properties is also expressed by saying that it **subsists** in its properties, or, what is the same, that it subsists in the subsistence of the properties. Insofar as there is now a double subsistence here, the thing's existence is not exhausted in any single property whatever; but since the double subsistence is nevertheless grounded in one identity, the thing as such cannot bear a change of all its properties either, without itself having to be altered thereby at the same time.

In the sharp sundering of thing and properties the distinguishing and fixing reflection plays its very freest game. In the distinction between the things and the properties the things' own mutual distinction is held fast. In the change of the properties there does indeed take place a change in the things; but since these, by [174] subsisting in the properties, also have a separate subsistence in themselves, they are not **for one another** mutually, and consequently independent of the changes occurring in the properties. In such an extreme of independence the things can be fixed, just because they have the properties, in whose determination it lies precisely to let the things be for one another, and thereby reflect the stream of changes in which the things themselves keep unchanged. As the whole exchange of relative determinations is, for the things themselves, an indifferent and external reflection, so too are the things indifferent toward one another; they can meet in the most diverse relations without their firm subsistence suffering thereby. The changes reflected in the properties therefore do not touch the things' essence, but only their phenomenal side.

If, on the other hand, the identity of thing and properties is held fast, then the essence of the things becomes reflected in its phenomenon, and the unity of both posited as the true existence of the things. The distinction that comes to appearance between essence and phenomenon then coincides with the things' own subsistence, and as the thing itself exists in immediate unity of its essential and unessential side, so too the properties have in themselves an essential and unessential existence. By losing an unessential property the thing itself suffers an unessential change, whereas it is essentially altered when an essential property vanishes. The reflection of the things and of the properties is therefore fundamentally one and the very same, and

^{**})When a square table is changed into a round one, it becomes another phenomenon, but is nevertheless the same thing. A flower without scent is also a flower.

what is peculiar in reflection lies in this, that it both **is** sublated and yet not sublated.

If the thing's reflection-in-itself is **one** with its reflection in the properties, then the thing's concrete determinateness immediately coincides with its properties, and these
 [175] vanish as reflexes in the thing's "haecceity"; the phenomenon is then negated as a mere phenomenon, and thereby sublated in the determination of its "noumenon": the thing **makes** its appearance in its properties. But since the reflection of the properties in the thing is now also **one** with their own reflection in themselves, independence falls over onto the properties; the thing's determinate phenomenon is thus posited in its distinction from the thing itself, and the latter, on the contrary, presupposed as a "noumenon" indeterminable in itself: the thing's existence in the properties is **only** apparent. The existential antinomy, that the thing is at once both transcendent and immanent, lies in appearance **itself**.

The things in their phenomenal determinateness are immediately opposed to one another, and thus form a series of existing phenomena. Could essential existence be exhausted in phenomenal immediacy, then the thing itself would be identical with its appearance, and every illusion would vanish. But now the thing in its phenomenon is at the same time distinct from the phenomenon; it is then, in consequence of this, opposed to its own appearance, and its immediate subsistence in the phenomenon illusory. What is essential in appearance, namely the thing in itself, is therefore just **that** which does not make its appearance; thereby appearance itself sublates its own essentiality. On the other hand this essentiality is at the same time posited in its sublation; for however distinct appearance may be from the thing itself, it nevertheless lets the thing's abstract being-for-itself come to appearance; what, on the other hand, it seems to conceal is the thing's own concrete determinateness. Now it has, however, been shown that haecceity, by which the thing is determined in itself, and distinct from every other thing, is necessarily reflected in a cycle of essential and unessential
 [176] properties. Either the thing in itself must then remain an empty abstraction that lacks all existence, since it lacks appearance, or else its otherworldly existence must itself become an appearance in otherworldly phenomena. The illusion that lies in the abstract opposition between thing and phenomenon vanishes as it makes its appearance, or in other words: the antinomy of appearance is only apparent.

In appearance existential reflection culminates. That which exists is only something apparent; for it always subsists in another subsistence; this other subsistence is itself negative, and subsists at the same time in its sublation as something apparent. But since every existence, just because it is apparent, subsists in the negation of its

subsistence, and the one existent is, in relation to the other, this negation, the one existence subsists in and by the other, and thus obtains, because of appearance, a subsistence reflected in itself. α) The thing in itself suffers from the contradiction that there is to be an abstract independence without semblance of reflection, and precisely thereby becomes an abstract semblance without any independence. The thing's unity in itself is only a semblance-unity, for it exists in a manifoldness of things in themselves; but the thing's essential manifoldness is also a semblance-plurality, for it exists only in the one unreflected thing in itself. The thing's absolute essentiality is then an essence apparent in itself, and must therefore make its appearance in **its other**, i.e. in properties and phenomena. β) But by coming to appearance in the properties, the thing itself falls into a new contradiction. Its existence oscillates now between the two extremes, either to expend its independence in the subsistence of the properties, or to absorb the properties in its subsistence. If the first happens, then the ground-existence is exhausted in the existing phenomena, and since the phenomena [177] negate every opposition between an essential and unessential existence, the things themselves vanish in the changing forms of matter; if the latter happens, then the indeterminable *Noumena* of the things fall back into a merely apparent essentiality, and flow away as non-independent moments in the absolute central-existence. γ) This contradiction dissolves in the phenomena's own apparent being; for this too subsists in the reflection of abstract independence and non-independence. As the things first come to appearance in themselves by making their appearance in the phenomena, so conversely the phenomena, by making their appearance in one another, become the things' own appearances. Appearance is the **posited** unity of the identity and distinction of existence. Distinction exists, for every existence has its particular subsistence; its determinate form and content separate it from other contents in other forms; its independence excludes every other independence; it is, as such, immediate and positive. In absolute negativity there therefore exists an innumerability of positive contents; in absolute independence innumerable independents subsist: existential plurality **is** the form in which **unity makes its appearance**. But in the positivity of plurality lies its negativity; the existing distinction is in itself apparent; therefore identity comes to existence. Since the opposition between the distinct contents is in itself apparent, it must **make its appearance, as a manifoldness** of distinction-moments, in the absolute content-identity; there exists therefore only one absolute content in all relative contents, only one absolute form in all relative forms, only one absolute positivity in all negativity, only one absolute independence

- [178] in all independents. Now as both forms of all-existence are in appearance posited with the same unconditioned validity, the existential opposition between the depth of centrality and the superficial phenomena has ceased to be a contradiction. As the immanent and essential appearance subsists in mediation, whose all-unity is the depth, so the unessential appearance exists in immediacy, whose phenomenal distinction is superficial. Appearance is itself identity of mediation and immediacy. The things in their phenomena are immediate existences; they come to appearance as determinately existent. The thing's determinate being also lies in its appearance; for what is to make its appearance must already have gone through its becoming. But this determinate being is at the same time essential, and as becoming is reflected in determinate being, origin comes to appearance. The thing's opposition to its phenomenon and immediate appearance is hereby reflected as an essential distinction between its **determinate existence** and its **origin**. According to the immediacy of appearance, the one thing seems to originate from the other, and yet origin itself does not come to appearance; for mediation, which here shows itself as the restless, superficial turnover of distinct contents and forms, uninterruptedly wrestles with immediacy, and is as such merely apparent. As the phenomenal existence of the things is to go together with itself into absolute subsistence, it repels itself from itself. But by making its appearance in its own otherness, i.e. in its merely apparent originality, it at the same time lets its **essential origin**, the absolute other by which it is itself posited, come to appearance, and subsists in its existential manifoldness as a result that presupposes
- [179] its presupposing principle, i.e. **the depth of centrality**. In the central-existence immediacy is conversely a reflected semblance of mediation. The existential depth cannot immediately come to appearance, for thereby it would itself be transformed into a superficial phenomenon; just as little can it be a thing in itself, since the thing's distinction from the phenomenon is itself a reflex of the essentiality reflected in itself: the central-existence therefore exists in the form of essential mediation. According to this mediation its immediate independence is its own infinite negativity; hereby its content is presupposed as the absolute originality of the ground; but since this originality is apparent in itself, it gives the things their origin, and posits the outer existential manifoldness as the medium in which it makes its appearance; as negative existence it therefore subsists in its own negation, i.e. in the positive immediacy of distinction and manifoldness; but since this outer immediate existence now also subsists in its negativity, since it is itself only an appearance of the apparent unity, its independence is posited in its sublation. By subsisting in outer existence, the central-

existence subsists in the sublation of existential manifoldness; as it hereby negates its own negation, it therefore exists in the appearance of all immediate existences as the identity affirmative in itself and totalized. When the central-existence then subsists in the positive unity of mediation which in its content sublates all distinction-moments as negative and apparent, then the content of phenomenal-existence subsists in an immediate distinction whose unity in itself is apparent and negative. By positing this double subsistence in one many-sided appearance, absolute existence passes over into totality.

[180]

c) Totality.

§ 26.

Inner and Outer, Force and Product, Preformation.

In appearance all existential moments come to appearance, both in their immediacy and in their mutual transition and immanent reflection, whereby all-existence is posited as *totality*. According to its essential side, totality is determined as a realm of laws, according to its immediacy, on the other hand, as a world of phenomena: an abstract opposition that is sublated in the essential relationship, i.e. in the reflection of the reflected and the immediate totality. According to the totalized form-distinction, which is at the same time a distinction in content, the essential relationship presupposes the totality reflected in the inwardness of mystery and the depth of selfhood on the one side, and the immediacy-totality unfolded in an external series (whole and parts) on the other, and thereby determines itself into a relationship between the inner and the *outer*. Inwardness, incommensurable with its outer forms, expresses itself in inexhaustible productivity; the identity of inner and outer is reflected in force, and totality develops into a relationship between force and *product*. As the formation of a new shape presupposes the producing force, so the specific productivity of force presupposes produced shapes in the infinite, so that every real formation reflects [181] its **preformation**. According to the reflection of appearance, every moment in the existence of the absolute is thus thoroughly

clarified that the ground-existence can be posited as the medium for the infinite progress of phenomenal-existence, just as phenomenal existence is conversely posited as the medium through which the ground-existence gains its self-deepening: the esoteric and exoteric content shine through each other. As, therefore, nothing is lost when only the ground-existence is held fast, since it itself contains all the moments

of phenomenal-existence, and posits them out of itself in order to affirm its own independence in their negativity, so no essential term of absolute existence is lost either if phenomenal-existence is posited in its self-reflection. For as it is posited by other, it reflects its absolute otherness from all sides, and is thus so penetrated by the content of the ground-existence that the unity of the depth makes its appearance in its superficial manifoldness. By being posited in the form of appearance, all-existence has developed into **totality**.

Totality is then now the most adequate form for the identity of the absolute in all independent distinctions. It lies in totality that every existence has its subsistence, that the sundering and separation are carried through; but it also follows, on the other hand, from the essence of totality that no existence can be isolated into abstract being-for-itself and fall outside the wholeness. Both demands of totality are fulfilled in appearance, which at once posits every independence as infinitely **negative** and [182] infinitely **positive**. But insofar as totality can be developed from any existence whatever, it is as yet, according to appearance, entirely formal, and lacks the peculiar determinateness. In pure appearance all existences are sublated: they are thereby all equally finite and infinite, equally mediate and immediate, equally central and peripheral. The point of departure for the totality-development is, in consequence of this, entirely indifferent. The category of appearance presents itself as a transparent totality-form; but totality itself requires a more precise determination.

The pure extremes of totality are: on the one side the immanent essence of appearance, an identity that sublates every phenomenal distinction and affirms totality as the all-embracing and all-determining unity of the things; on the other side the self-separation of appearance into the concrete immediacy of the phenomena, whereby the sundering is consummated, and totality shows itself in the whole manifoldness of particular existences. Since, further, each of these sides with all its independence is a moment of appearance, and consequently itself has only an apparent independence, they are not externally compounded, nor is a third needed to form their union: the own reflection of appearance makes up their true subsistence. The reflected subsistence of both sides is now to be determined more precisely as the **law** and **haecceity**.

a) In the totality of its essential and unessential properties, i.e. in its immediately determinate appearance, the thing is posited with its haecceity; but as **this** thing (hæc res) it is thereby at the same time limited and distinct from all other determinate things, [183] each of which expresses its haecceity. The whole totality stamps itself out in the outer, infinite manifoldness of haecceities. In the immediate determinateness and essential

delimitation of the things lies their finitude; one thing arises and passes away after another: haecceity is perishable and mutable. But as the immediate independence of the things is apparent, so their changeability and mutability is also apparent; however many things arise and pass away, there will nevertheless always remain an innumerability of determinate things. The amount of subsisting things is infinite; the amount of them that arise and pass away is consequently also infinite: it is the whole totality that incessantly arises, and the whole totality that incessantly passes away; for in essence quantity is sublated; absolute reflection reckons with infinite magnitudes. Since the outer manifoldness and distinction of haecceity is thus transformed to infinity into an indifferent and unessential semblance, the changeability of the things is negated and at the same time taken up into their positive unchangeability, and the law posited as their **essential foundation**, as their **immanent subsistence**.

By being posited as the foundation of the things the law acquires a certain likeness to the essential thing, to the “thing in itself”, since both present themselves as the true, universal essence of the determinate things. Nevertheless the law cannot be hypostatized into a thing, since it negates every independent immediacy. When the “**thing in itself**” is determined as the foundation **that is**, which relates itself indifferently to the phenomena of existence, the “**law**”, on the other hand, has its subsistence in **the** subsisting things; the “**thing in itself**” rejects appearance, and shows itself thereby as the **transcendent** essence; the “**law**”, on the other hand, makes [184] its appearance in the appearance of the things, and holds only as the **immanent** essence. What the “**thing in itself**” is in the form of **sublated** reflection, the **law** is in the form of **posited** reflection; when the thing in itself, by an otherworldly abstract immediacy, pushes the phenomenal determinations away from itself, the law itself comes openly forward as the essentiality in the exchange of the phenomena.”) When the changing manifoldness of the things is posited as reflex in their immanent unity, it is hereby at the same time presupposed that this essence-identity is absorbed as reflex in the determinate immediacy. Since now the law itself is the essence of the things, and since the independent immediacy of the things proceeds precisely from their own essentiality, haecceity springs from the law’s own positing reflection. This contradiction, that haecceity at once proceeds from the law and yet falls outside the law, is at once determined by the law and yet indifferent to the law, at one

)Although Kant demonstrated that we cannot cognize “das Ding an sich” (the transcendent essence), he was nevertheless convinced that we can investigate the laws of things; for the law (the transcendental, i.e. apparent and immanent essence) holds not of *Noumena* but of *Phænomena*.

stroke is posited and sublated by the law, is expressed in the proposition that **the thing is subject to the law**. The subsistence of the thing and of the law is hereby doubled: appearance is the thing's truth; it therefore lets the essence of the law come to appearance as the otherness in which it itself subsists; nevertheless it does

[185] not subsist as law, but as immediate independence. As regards the law, it too has haecceity as the other in which it comes to existence, but nevertheless does not subsist as **this** thing,^{*)} but as its negation. Both principal sides are thus, according to the reflection of appearance, equally positive and equally negative, but according to the immediate distinction between law and haecceity abstractly opposed to each other. If now the thing's subsistence in the law is posited as the positive, then haecceity is a vanishing semblance, a negativum through which the **unity** of totality is affirmed; if, on the other hand, the thing's subsistence in immediate independence is posited as the positive, then the law is the negation by which haecceity is determined, and the **allness** of totality is affirmed. While the law, therefore, in the first respect is presupposed as the foundation of the things, in the latter respect it is posited as the things' **immanent and essential limit**. The determinateness of the things is their finitude reflected in the law, which is thus posited in a double form. In the form of essential identity the finitude of the things comes to appearance as a common

[186] vanishing in the essence of the law, as in their pure infinity and universality: **they are all equal before the law**; in the form of essential distinction finitude comes to appearance as the limit that the thing cannot overstep without its subsistence being altered; the law sunders and separates the things: **thus far and no further!** is the commandment that holds for each single existence. The separation of the things and their transition into one another make them sides in the immanent relation that is determined as their law. But the things are at the same time more than mere sides in the law of the relationship; they are haecceities whose immediate independence shows itself indifferent toward the mutual relation. — The medium between law and haecceity is the essential property. As **property**, namely, it is a moment in haecceity, a determination in the for-itself immediacy by which the thing itself falls outside the law and the relationship; as **essential** property it is itself indifferent toward haecceity, reflects its unchangeability in the latter's changeability, and shows the

^{*)}The stone is heavy; it therefore has an essential subsistence in its gravity, for however it may otherwise be constituted, it is nevertheless subject to the law of gravity. Yet it does not exist as gravity, but as stone, i.e. as the other in which the law of gravity can come to appearance. If someone sees a human being die merely as this human being, then he senses only a fact; if, on the other hand, his thought sees humanity die in this human being's death, he cognizes the law of mortality.

thing's determinateness by, and dependence on, the law. Since now the same thing has a plurality of properties, since every property shows that the thing's reflection in itself is posited as its reflection in other things, and the thing's independence as a side in the immanent reflection, every property can by itself be posited as essential, while the rest are sublated as unessential, whereby the thing's haecceity shows itself to be subject to a plurality of distinct laws.^{*)} By reflecting its essential unity in the immediate distinction of the things, the law comes to appearance in a **manifoldness of distinct laws**. [187]

c) In the immediate diversity of the things the essential distinction of the laws comes to appearance; as the essential relations of the things express the manifoldness of the laws, so the outer, unessential relations, on the other hand, present the indifference of haecceity toward the law itself. Both relations are, however, appearances, and consequently moments in one and the same reflection. If the determinate law is to come to appearance, it presupposes a concurrence of given conditions; it reflects its essentiality in indifferent relations. From this follows the **thetic** and **hypothetical** character of the law.^{*)} α) The law is abstractly thetic; as, being the things' own essence, it lacks all inner reflection in itself, it at the same time lacks all mediation, and gives no ground for its validity. Nevertheless the law is an essentiality; it is the immanent reflection of unchangeability in the changeability of the things, and in consequence of this cannot be broken off. If the law is once given as presupposition, then at the same time all its consequences are given. The development of the laws from the law thus has an **analytic** character. β) But as the apparent essence the law has no validity outside its appearance, and outside the existence of the things no fulfillment whatever. As the immediate determinateness of the things is essentially determined and limited by the law, so conversely the determinateness of the law is in turn determined by the immediacy of the things, and its fulfillment infinitely conditioned. The opposed sides in the law-determined relationship must be factually given; they are not posited by the law itself; but they are presupposed in order that the law can be posited. Therefore the manifold laws come to appearance sporadically in the existential manifoldness of the things; the one law cannot immediately be deduced from the other; but the leading back of the laws to the law must take place by the **synthetic** way.^{*)} γ) [188]

^{*)}Man is rational, and as such subject to the laws of duty; man is bodily, and according to this property subject to the laws of gravity.

^{*)}In experimental physics the point is precisely to hit upon the right conditions, so that the law can come to appearance in its pure universality.

^{*)}Mathematical cognition is at once analytic and synthetic.

Nevertheless the thetic and hypothetical determinateness of the law is in what is essential one and the same reflection. That the law comes to appearance in thetic form stems from its lack of self-deepening; its reflection in itself, by which it levels every immediate distinction, is immediately its reflection in the existing things, by which it itself passes over into plurality and distinction. With the one thetic law, then, there is given a manifoldness of thetic law-determinations. All theses here immediately coincide, for they are at one stroke. The one law therefore cannot fetch its meaning from the other; the one has no validity to lend the other, but each has validity in itself. The separation between the ground-law and the derived laws therefore does not lie in the essence of the laws at all; for every determinate law is the ground-law itself in particular determinateness. Insofar as the one law has equal validity with the other, they show themselves mutually indifferent; the one does not seem to presuppose the other. But since the manifoldness of the laws is an appearance of the same thesis, [189] their mutual indifference itself only apparent; they presuppose one another mutually: if one law could fall away, then they could all vanish; if the one law persists, then they all subsist; by this mutual presupposing the thetic determinateness turns over into the hypothetical, and the latter into the former. Just because the thesis is thus at once both given in the hypothesis and also posited as its extreme, the mutual coherence of the laws is of itself so evident, and yet a riddle.*)

The laws are the bond of the things; what is enigmatic in the mutual coherence of the laws is at the same time the secret in the essential connection of the things. That the thing, which in its immediate independence only seems to rest on itself, must nevertheless stand and fall with other existences far removed from its outer contact and immediate surroundings, expresses the riddle of connection in the most surprising form.**) The riddle lies in the fixed separation between the essence of the laws and the existence of the things. The medium through which the distinction of the laws reflects its identity is as yet presupposed as an abstract otherness which is indeed subject to the law, but nevertheless falls outside the law. It is the immediate haecceity of the things that steps in between law and law, and thereby conceals the connection. For the same reason the law too now forms, from its side, an abstract opposition to the things; for its unity and distinction keep themselves exclusively in [190] reflection, and develop into a manifoldness of **essential** relations. The existence of

*) In the Pythagorean theorem the thesis is immediately given with the hypothesis; nevertheless a Pythagoras was needed to deduce the former from the latter.

**) Therefore a Newton's genius was required to see the law of the heavenly bodies in the fall of an apple.

the things, on the other hand, is reduced to immediacy; it is scattered and gathered in **unessential** and indifferent relations. But however essential this separation may seem from one side, just as essential is its sublation in the many-sided development of totality, whereby the riddle is solved.^{*)} Totality, formal in its pure appearance, has through the opposition of the laws and the things gradually gained a concrete content. Each of its principal sides makes its appearance in a peculiar form, and since the form on both sides **is** essential and immanent, its content too has an essential determinateness. As the realm of laws is the calm prototype of the phenomenal world, beheld in the mirror of reflection, so the phenomenal world is conversely the restless copy of the laws, regarded in the light of immediacy. It remains to show how these two sides relate to one another. If they are, each by itself, only sides, where then is the medium in which they have their independence? If they are each by itself totalities, if the one totality has in its development separated itself into two equally independent totalities, how will it then be possible to lead so absolute a dualism back to the original ground-unity? a) Totality is in the first place determined as phenomenal-existence, and the law is its own essential side. As the foundation of the things, the essence of the law

coincides with existence's own immanent subsistence. The content-determinations that vanish as sides in the law-determined relationship **are** reflexes of the things' [191] own immediate determinateness, essence-moments in haecceity itself. Since now the things are thus not merely sublated as sides in the law, but also posited as independent phenomena in haecceity, the phenomenal world has not only the content of the law in itself, but besides this a manifoldness of unessential determinations indifferent to the law, hence the whole content doubled in itself. Thus phenomenal-existence becomes what overreaches; it subsists in the totality of the laws, as in its otherness; this subsistence is nevertheless its own reflection-in-itself; it has otherness itself in itself, and subsists in essential reflection. But as phenomenal-existence, through its own otherness, returns into itself as reflected world, it becomes from the opposite side *eo ipso* alien to itself; for the immediacy with which it was identical from the first has now become its otherness; in order to subsist in this otherness, it sublates its reflected subsistence again, and comes to appearance in the outer manifoldness of the things. b) Totality must next be determined as reflected totality, so that phenomenal-existence becomes a side of the law's own overreaching content. Since all things subsist by virtue of the law, which posits their immanent limit, the subsistence by which they

^{*)}It goes without saying that we are not thinking here of the empirical but of the logical solution.

fall outside one another is reflected as a moment in the subsistence according to which they fall together with one another, and are identified with the essence of the law. From the standpoint of the phenomenal world the former is the positive, the latter the negative subsistence; from the standpoint of the law, on the other hand, the relation [192] is the reverse. Now as this distinction between the positive and negative vanishes again in the law's own dialectic, the content of the law itself becomes posited as the whole totality. The immediate existence of the things is their positive determinate being in the form of finitude. But since the law is hereby posited as the immanent limit, the thing's positive determinateness is at the same time an expression of the law's own negative determination; by coming to appearance in the thing as in an immediate other, it becomes to itself an other, i.e. it separates itself into a plurality of determinate laws. The law hereby takes up otherness as an integrating moment in its own essence. The one thing is in its subsistence dependent on the other, for the law is their foundation; it is at the same time distinct from the other, for the law is their limit. Now as the one thing subsists in itself by subsisting in the other's subsistence, it subsists in the giving up of its independence and transition into another existence; but since every other existence to which the transition takes place again subsists in its otherness, the immediate independence of the things returns uninterruptedly through its negation; it therefore has its immediacy in reflection and its reflection in immediacy, so that this immanent transition and return is the self-movement of the law. Besides its own essential content, the realm of laws then also comprises the changing manifoldness of phenomenal-existence, and only gains the rest of essentiality in the unrest of movement. c) Insofar as the **immediate totality**, by virtue of its own reflection, fixes itself in the form of immediacy, a for-itself realm of laws is an unessential abstraction: **only the phenomenal world exists**. Insofar as the

[The text breaks off here, at the end of p. 192 and of the Third Fascicle; Fascicle 4 is not in the scanned volume.]

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in Its Main Outlines

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